COMPLEXITY OF DEEP COMPUTATIONS VIA TOPOLOGY OF FUNCTION SPACES

EDUARDO DUEÑEZ[1] JOSÉ IOVINO[1] TONATIUH MATOS-WIEDERHOLD[2]
LUCIANO SALVETTI[2] FRANKLIN D. TALL[2]

[1]Department of Mathematics, The University of Texas at San Antonio
[2]Department of Mathematics, University of Toronto

Abstract. We bring Shelah's theory of independence and Todorčević's classification of Rosenthal compacta to bear on limits of computations beyond the continuous case. The first paper of this series characterized computability, in a framework for arbitrary-precision computation, by the continuous extendibility of computations to limit states. Limits of computations along ultrafilters, the deep computations, may nevertheless be discontinuous, as familiar iterative algorithms show. For countably many real-valued features, and for computations that extend continuously to the limit states, we prove that the absence of the independence property, feature by feature, on bounded regions that the computations preserve is equivalent to the requirement that all limits of the extended computations be of the first Baire class on the closures of these regions in the space of types. Every such limit is then, on each of these closures, the pointwise limit of a sequence of extended computations. For countable families of continuous maps of a compact metrizable state space, the regime so characterized is the tame regime of topological dynamics, whose hierarchy Glasner and Megrelishvili derived from Todorčević's trichotomy. We carry the hierarchy over to computation structures and realize every level by a rotation of the circle and by classical algorithms: the power method, the planar and spatial Bresenham algorithms, and the action on the projective line of the group generated by the steps of the Euclidean algorithm; Newton's method for the square roots of unity on the Riemann sphere lies beyond the tame regime. For arbitrary families of features, a measure-theoretic counterpart characterizes the absence of the independence property by the universal measurability, feature by feature, of all limits of the extended computations. For every Radon probability measure on the inputs, each output feature of such a limit is then a uniform limit of polynomials in the input features outside a set of arbitrarily small probability.

Introduction

This paper brings Shelah's theory of independence and Todorčević's classification of Rosenthal compacta to bear on the complexity of deep computations, the

Date: November 3, 2026.

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* Primary 68Q15, 03C45, 54H30; Secondary 03C98, 03D15, 05D10, 26A21, 37B05, 54C35, 68T07.

Key words and phrases. Deep computations, limit computations, complexity classes, deep learning, recurrent neural networks, deep equilibrium models, compositional computation structures, independence property, NIP, model theory, Rosenthal compacta, Baire class 1 functions, Todorčević's trichotomy, Argyros–Dodos–Kanellopoulos heptachotomy, Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem, tame dynamical systems, infinite Ramsey theory.

This version: November 3, 2026. The most recent version of this paper is available at `https://utsa-quantum-math.github.io/resources/deep-computations-nip/`; it may supersede the version deposited on arXiv.

limits of computations along ultrafilters; with these tools we determine when a deep computation is the limit of a sequence of computations, and we stratify deep computations into a strict hierarchy of complexity classes. The distinction between tame and wild behavior is a central concern of *classification theory*, the branch of model theory that studies theories through structural dividing lines, and Shelah's independence property supplies the dividing line used here. The first paper of this series characterized, within a framework for arbitrary-precision computation, the families of computations all of whose limits are continuous; here we proceed to limits that may be discontinuous. A pointwise limit of continuous computations may be discontinuous and still belong to the first Baire class, that is, still be the pointwise limit of a sequence of continuous maps. We call *tame* the regime in which every limit is of this kind; the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem identifies the tame regime, and Todorčević's structure theory distinguishes levels within this regime.

The illustrations are drawn from familiar algorithms of numerical analysis, computer graphics and arithmetic: Newton's method, the power method, Bresenham's line algorithm and the Euclidean algorithm. Newton's method for square roots on the real projective line and the power method have discontinuous limiting maps that are nevertheless attained sequentially. Newton's method on the Riemann sphere, by contrast, has limits beyond the first Baire class for each of the polynomials treated here. These examples, developed in Sections 4 and 5, place the failure of continuity within a classification of limiting computations.

Limits also enter the recurrent, equilibrium and continuous-depth architectures of deep learning. A recurrent network repeatedly applies a layer with fixed weights, while the deep equilibrium models of Bai, Kolter and Koltun [BKK] seek a fixed point of such a layer by root finding. The neural ordinary differential equations of Chen, Rubanova, Bettencourt and Duvenaud [CRBD] replace discrete layers by continuous evolution of the hidden state. In a related direction, the physics-informed neural networks of Raissi, Perdikaris and Karniadakis [RPK19] incorporate differential equations into training. These architectures motivate a framework in which limits, as well as finite compositions, are objects of mathematical analysis.

Alva, Dueñez, Iovino and Walton introduced compositional computation structures in the first paper of this series [ADIW26], to appear in *Mathematical Structures in Computer Science*. Computations act on states whose real-valued *features* are observed and manipulated to finite precision. The *type* of a state records the values of all the features at the state; adjoining the limits of these records gives the *space of types*. The analysis takes place on *shards*, the sets of states on which each feature obeys a prescribed bound. The closure of a shard in the space of types is the corresponding *type shard*, which adds the limit states to the actual states of the shard. The *Extendibility Axiom* of the first paper requires every computation to extend continuously to each type shard. A *deep computation* is a pointwise limit of computations along an ultrafilter, evaluated on actual states, whereas an *ultracomputation* is such a limit taken after the computations have been extended to the type shards. Our classification concerns these limits of extended computations; for the compact dynamical structures used in the algorithmic examples, every type is realized and the two notions coincide.

Stable sets of computations, whose limits remain continuous on the type shards, are the subject of the first paper. The principal tool there is Grothendieck's double limit exchange condition [Gro52]. For a uniformly bounded family of continuous

functions on a compact space, Grothendieck's theorem characterizes continuity of every pointwise limit by this condition: the two iterated limits over sequences of functions and points agree whenever both exist. For countably many features, the double limit condition yields polynomial approximability, the notion of computability defined in the first paper: on each shard, every output feature of a limiting computation is a uniform limit of polynomials in the input features. The passage from continuous to Baire-class-1 limits retains approximation by sequences of computations while admitting the discontinuities that arise in natural algorithms. The analysis of this passage calls for the structure theory of Rosenthal compacta in place of Grothendieck's double limit condition.

Beyond stability, the dividing line that concerns us is the *independence property*, which Shelah isolated in 1971 [She71, Definition 4.1] and which occupies a central place in his classification theory [She90]. A formula has the independence property when, for every natural number n, there are n parameters on which every pattern of truth and falsity of the formula is realized by some tuple of elements of a model. A theory none of whose formulas has the independence property is called *NIP*, or *dependent*. Between 1968 and 1972 the same dividing line appeared independently in two other fields, as a dichotomy between polynomial and exponential growth. A family of sets *shatters* a finite set when every subset of the finite set is a trace of the family, that is, the intersection of the finite set with a member of the family. In these terms, either a family shatters arbitrarily large finite sets, or the number of traces of the family on every finite set is bounded by a polynomial in the size of the set. In statistical learning, Vapnik and Chervonenkis announced this dichotomy in 1968 [VC68] and published a proof in 1971 [VC71], in their study of the uniform convergence of relative frequencies to probabilities. In combinatorics, Sauer [Sau72] and Shelah [She72] proved the dichotomy independently in 1972, and the result is now known as the Sauer–Shelah lemma. The largest size of a finite set shattered by a family is called the *Vapnik–Chervonenkis dimension*, or *VC dimension*, of the family.

The distinction between tame and wild behavior also animates infinite Ramsey theory, where partition and subsequence theorems extract coherent structure from arbitrary configurations. Rosenthal's dichotomy gives this distinction an analytic form: a uniformly bounded sequence of real-valued functions on a set has either a pointwise convergent subsequence or an independent subsequence. Here independence means that there are a lower and an upper threshold such that, for any two disjoint finite sets of indices, some point makes the functions indexed by the first fall below the lower threshold and those indexed by the second exceed the upper one. This dichotomy lies at the heart of Rosenthal's ℓ_1-theorem of 1974 [Ros74]: every bounded sequence in a Banach space has a subsequence that is either weakly Cauchy or equivalent to the unit vector basis of ℓ_1, the space of absolutely summable sequences. In 1977 Rosenthal made the compact sets of functions of the first Baire class on Polish spaces, with the topology of pointwise convergence, the subject of a study of their own [Ros77]. Godefroy named them *Rosenthal compacta* in 1980 [God80], and they have since been studied intensively in functional analysis, especially in the theory of Banach spaces.

The Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem [BFT78] of 1978 carries this analysis from sequences to pointwise closures of families of functions. For pointwise bounded families of continuous functions on a Polish space, that is, on a separable

completely metrizable space, Bourgain, Fremlin and Talagrand characterized the requirement that every function in the pointwise closure belong to the first Baire class (see Theorem 1.4); the pointwise closure is then a Rosenthal compactum. On a compact metrizable space, their condition is exactly the absence of the independence property for the family of functions (see Theorem 1.6). The first Baire class thus becomes the natural domain of the tame alternative.

The classification of Rosenthal compacta took a decisive form in 1999, when Todorčević [Tod99] proved his trichotomy. Every separable Rosenthal compactum that is not metrizable contains a copy of one of four canonical compacta: the split Cantor set, the Alexandroff duplicate of the Cantor set, the extended duplicate of the split Cantor set, or the one-point compactification of a discrete set of the cardinality of the continuum. Which of these copies occurs is governed by hereditary separability and first countability (see Theorem 3.3), and the trichotomy thereby classifies the ways in which such a compactum can fail to be metrizable. Todorčević's proof combines infinite Ramsey theory with set-theoretic forcing: Rosenthal compacta are analyzed through their interpretations in forcing extensions, and absoluteness arguments carry the conclusions of this analysis back to the ground universe, whence the structural alternatives are theorems of ZFC. Todorčević's methods continue to be analyzed and exploited [Tod23, HT19].

Glasner and Megrelishvili [GM22] brought this structure theory into topological dynamics. The *enveloping semigroup* of a system of continuous maps on a compact metrizable space is the pointwise closure of the family of maps, and the system is *tame* [Köh95, Gla06] exactly when every map in this closure is of the first Baire class. The Glasner–Megrelishvili hierarchy distinguishes tame systems by metrizability, hereditary separability and first countability of their enveloping semigroups. This dynamical meaning of tameness governs our use of the term for computations.

Model theory provides the connection between these function spaces and computation structures. The passage from states to types places computations and their limits in spaces of functions with the topology of pointwise convergence, the setting of $\mathrm{C_p}$*-theory*. In this setting Shelah's independence property becomes a condition on the finite patterns of high and low output values that computations realize on suitable inputs. The same patterns connect the framework with VC dimension and with PAC (probably approximately correct) learning [VC71, VC74, Val84]: finiteness of the VC dimension of a family of sets implies NIP, the two notions coincide for first-order formulas, and, under a mild measurability condition, finiteness of the VC dimension characterizes PAC learnability [BEHW89] (see Section 1.5).

The first main result, Theorem 3.1, concerns computation structures that satisfy the Extendibility Axiom and have countably many features. Fix a collection of shards that covers the actual states and that every computation of the family under consideration preserves. Applying the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem, we characterize NIP on these shards, feature by feature, by the requirement that every limit of the extended computations be of Baire class 1 on the corresponding type shards. The pointwise closures of these families of extended computations are then Rosenthal compacta, and every member of such a closure is the pointwise limit of a sequence of extended computations on the type shard in question. The classification of Rosenthal compacta thereby becomes available beyond stability. For countable families of computations these compacta are separable, so Todorčević's trichotomy applies. We distinguish the levels NIP_3, NIP_2 and NIP_1 by metrizability, hereditary

separability and first countability, respectively (see Definition 3.2). Together with stability and NIP, these levels form the hierarchy

$$\text{stable} \Rightarrow \text{NIP}_3 \Rightarrow \text{NIP}_2 \Rightarrow \text{NIP}_1 \Rightarrow \text{NIP}.$$

For the compact metrizable dynamical structures of Section 5.1, the hierarchy coincides with the Glasner–Megrelishvili hierarchy (see Proposition 5.1); the type shards carry the same analysis over to the general computation framework.

The topological distinctions admit a precise interpretation in terms of observations (see Proposition 3.4). A *test* consists of an input state type and a feature evaluated at the output. At the metrizable level, a single countable collection of tests separates all the deep computations on a type shard. For these separable Rosenthal compacta, hereditary separability excludes a family of the cardinality of the continuum in which each member can be isolated from the other members by finitely many tests and a positive separation margin. First countability, the weakest of the three properties, requires only that each deep computation be separated from all the others by a countable collection of tests chosen for the computation. The hierarchy therefore measures how the observations needed to tell deep computations apart are organized, as well as how regular the deep computations are as maps.

The algorithms introduced above, together with a rotation of the circle, realize the distinctions throughout the hierarchy. In Section 5 we analyze the associated dynamics and show that every implication in the hierarchy is strict. An irrational rotation of the circle is stable, whereas the power method is NIP_3 but not stable. Bresenham's planar line algorithm, represented by the Sturmian shift, is NIP_2 but not NIP_3. The corresponding construction in three dimensions is NIP_1 but not NIP_2. The action on the projective line of the group generated by the steps of the Euclidean algorithm is NIP but not NIP_1, and the deep computations of this action include exact equality tests. The logistic family supplies further examples within and beyond the hierarchy, while Newton's method on the Riemann sphere lies beyond NIP for the polynomials considered here. The level is a property of the space of deep computations, not of the formula for a single step: Newton's method for $z^2 - 1$ is NIP_3 on the real projective line but not NIP on the Riemann sphere, although the step is given by the same formula on both spaces.

The examples also distinguish the canonical compacta of the second alternative of Todorčević's trichotomy. At the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2, the deep computations of the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm contain a copy of the extended duplicate of the split Cantor set and no copy of the Alexandroff duplicate of the Cantor set. At the same level, a countable family of compositions of Euclidean steps and their inverses realizes the other alternative, the Alexandroff duplicate (see Proposition 5.13). Our two examples at the level NIP but not NIP_1, the Euclidean action and free reduction in the free group on two generators, are actions of groups with two generators. Whether a single iterated continuous map can reach the level NIP but not NIP_1 remains open, as does the realization of the Alexandroff duplicate by a single iterated map at the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2 (see Questions 7.2 and 7.3).

For families indexed by the binary tree, we also use the Argyros–Dodos–Kanellopoulos heptachotomy of 2008 [ADK08], a refinement of Todorčević's structure theory. The seven canonical minimal families of the heptachotomy retain the tree indexing in the comparison of pointwise closures. In Section 3.3 we describe these families and read their constituent prefix and threshold tests as primitives of

binary search. A family of iterates of the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm is equivalent to the seventh of these families (see Remark 5.9).

Finally, in Section 6 we pass from topology to measure and dispense with the countability of the family of features. Through the measure-theoretic form of the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem, the second main result, Theorem 6.7, characterizes NIP by the universal measurability, feature by feature and with respect to every Radon probability measure, of all limits of extended computations on the type shards preserved by the computations. For each such measure and each output feature, Luzin's theorem gives continuity on a closed subset whose complement has arbitrarily small measure, and the Stone–Weierstrass theorem then gives uniform approximation by polynomials in the input features on the subset. Universal Monte Carlo computability, the notion that we introduce, asks for an extension of a deep computation that is universally measurable, feature by feature, on every type shard; the approximation just described is the content of the notion. The same conclusion follows from universal Talagrand stability, a measure-theoretic condition introduced by Talagrand in his study of Pettis integration [Tal84]. For countable families of computations, this condition coincides with NIP in ZFC (see Corollary 6.19), whereas for countable families of measurable functions the corresponding implication depends on the axioms of set theory, by theorems of Talagrand [Tal84] and of Fremlin and Shelah [FS93].

The paper presupposes no acquaintance with advanced topology, model theory or the theory of computation. The topological, combinatorial and model-theoretic background is assembled in Section 1, beginning from undergraduate topology and measure theory, and the framework of compositional computation structures is recalled in Section 2. The purpose of this development is to make the structural results available in their natural generality while keeping their computational applications in view.

Organization of the paper. In Section 1 we present the topological and combinatorial preliminaries, including five canonical Rosenthal compacta (Section 1.4) and the role of NIP in model theory, combinatorics and learning (Section 1.5). In Section 2 we recall compositional computation structures, the source of the structural and model-theoretic viewpoint of the paper, and their stable sets of computations; the section ends with two motivating examples, Newton's method for square roots and Newton's method on the Riemann sphere, whose different behaviors the classification is designed to separate (Section 2.5). Section 3 contains the first main theorem, the levels of NIP defined through Todorčević's trichotomy, and the canonical families of Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos read as primitives of binary search. In Section 4 we work out Newton's method on the Riemann sphere and on the real projective line. Next, in Section 5, we place classical algorithms at every level of the hierarchy, and chaotic ones outside the class NIP. In Section 6 we replace topology by measure, prove the second main theorem and compare NIP with universal Talagrand stability. We intend to develop this measure-theoretic viewpoint further in future research. Section 7 contains the questions that remain open. In Appendix A we give a proof, self-contained apart from the structure theorem for tame minimal systems, of the observation of Glasner and Megrelishvili [GM18] that the shift on the Thue–Morse subshift generates an action of $\mathbb{Z}$ that is not tame, a fact used in Section 5.6.

Contents

Introduction 1
Organization of the paper 6
1. Topological preliminaries: From continuity to Baire class 1 8
1.1. From Rosenthal's dichotomy to the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy to Shelah's NIP 9
1.2. Rosenthal compacta 12
1.3. The special case $\mathrm{B}_1(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$ with $\mathcal{P}$ countable 12
1.4. Five canonical Rosenthal compacta 14
1.5. NIP in model theory, combinatorics and learning: polynomial versus exponential growth 16
Historical remarks 18
2. Compositional Computation Structures: A structural approach to arbitrary-precision computations 19
2.1. Computation States Structures 19
2.2. Compositional Computation Structures 21
2.3. Computability of deep computations and the Extendibility Axiom 22
2.4. Stability 23
2.5. Two motivating examples 24
3. Classifying deep computations 24
3.1. NIP, Rosenthal compacta, and deep computations 25
3.2. Todorčević's trichotomy and levels of NIP 26
3.3. Canonical families and binary search 28
4. Examples of Compositional Computation Structures 30
4.1. Example: The Newton CCS for the cubic $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$ 31
4.2. Example: The Newton CCS for the cubic $u(z) = z^3 - 1$ 32
4.3. Example: Square roots 33
5. Computations across the hierarchy 34
5.1. Iterative algorithms and tame dynamics 34
5.2. Stable and metrizable 36
5.3. Hereditarily separable but not metrizable 38
5.4. First countable but not hereditarily separable 41
5.5. NIP but not first countable: the Euclidean algorithm 43
5.6. Beyond NIP 51
5.7. Summary 55
6. Randomized versions of NIP and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations 55
6.1. NIP and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations 55
6.2. Talagrand stability and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations 59
7. Open questions 63
Appendix A. The Thue–Morse system is not tame 64
References 66

1. Topological preliminaries:

From continuity to Baire class 1

In this section we assemble the topology of function spaces on which the rest of the paper rests. The paper has two themes: the approximation of a deep computation by a sequence of computations, and the complexity of the set of all deep computations. Deep computations are pointwise limits of computations along ultrafilters, and under the Extendibility Axiom the computations extend to continuous maps on compact spaces of states and limit states; both themes therefore belong to the theory of spaces of functions with the topology of pointwise convergence. We first recall Polish spaces, Baire category and the first Baire class; we then turn to Rosenthal's dichotomy and the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy, from which the NIP emerges. The Rosenthal compacta come next, and five of them serve as yardsticks for the classification. In the last subsection we trace the NIP back to model theory, combinatorics and statistical learning. All spaces are assumed to be Hausdorff unless explicitly stated otherwise.

We write $\mathbb{N}$ for the set $\{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$ of natural numbers, so that the semigroups of iterates considered below contain the identity. A subset of a topological space is F_σ if it is a countable union of closed sets, and G_δ if it is a countable intersection of open sets. In a metric space every open set is F_σ, and, equivalently, every closed set is G_δ.

A *Polish space* is a separable topological space whose topology is induced by a complete metric. Countable products of Polish spaces, with the product topology, are Polish and furnish classical examples besides the real line. They include the Cantor space $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ of all infinite binary sequences, the Baire space $\mathbb{N}^{\mathbb{N}}$ of all infinite sequences of natural numbers, and the space $\mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{N}}$ of all sequences of real numbers.

Fact 1.1. [Eng89, 4.3.24] *A subset of a Polish space is itself Polish in the subspace topology if and only if it is a G_δ set. In particular, closed subsets and open subsets of Polish spaces are also Polish spaces.*

A subset A of a topological space X is *nowhere dense* if the closure of A has empty interior. Sets contained in a countable union of closed nowhere dense sets are of the *first category*, or *meager*; all other sets are of the *second category*, and the complements of meager sets are called *comeager*. Since the closure of a nowhere dense set is again nowhere dense, the meager subsets of X are exactly the members of the σ-ideal generated by the nowhere dense subsets of X. A topological space X is *Baire* if every comeager subset of X is dense or, equivalently, if every countable intersection of dense open subsets of X is dense. The Baire category theorem states that compact Hausdorff spaces and completely metrizable spaces, Polish spaces in particular, are Baire.[1]

For topological spaces X and Y, we denote by $\mathrm{C_p}(X, Y)$ the set of all continuous functions $f\colon X \to Y$ with the topology of pointwise convergence, and we abbreviate $\mathrm{C_p}(X, \mathbb{R})$ to $\mathrm{C_p}(X)$. The topology of pointwise convergence is the one that $\mathrm{C_p}(X, Y)$ inherits as a subspace of the product Y^X, in which X serves merely as an index set.

A function $f\colon X \to Y$ between topological spaces is of *Baire class 1* if there is a sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ of continuous functions from X to Y such that $f(x) = \lim_{n\to\infty} f_n(x)$ for all $x \in X$. When Y is metrizable, an elementary argument shows that a function of Baire class 1 is continuous at every point outside a set of the

[1] More generally, any Čech-complete space is Baire [Eng89, Theorem 3.9.3].

first category. We denote by $\mathrm{B}_1(X,Y)$ the set of functions $X \to Y$ of Baire class 1 with the topology of pointwise convergence, and we write $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ for $\mathrm{B}_1(X,\mathbb{R})$; in the chain $\mathrm{C}_\mathrm{p}(X,Y) \subseteq \mathrm{B}_1(X,Y) \subseteq Y^X$, each space is thus a topological subspace of the next. Relatively compact subsets of $\mathrm{C}_\mathrm{p}(X)$ and of $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$, especially for Polish X, are central objects of study in functional analysis and in topological dynamics.

The classical characterization of functions of Baire class 1 given below holds in a class of spaces that contains all metrizable spaces. A normal topological space X is *perfectly normal* if every closed subset of X is a G_δ set or, equivalently, every open subset of X is an F_σ set. By the remark on metric spaces made above, every metrizable space, and in particular every Polish space, is perfectly normal.

The following characterization of Baire class 1 functions is classical; for a proof, see [Tod97, Section 10].

Fact 1.2 (Lebesgue, Hausdorff, Baire[2])**.** *If X is perfectly normal, then the following conditions are equivalent for a function $f\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$:*

(1) *The function f is of Baire class 1.*
(2) *The preimage $f^{-1}[U]$ is an F_σ subset of X whenever $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is open.*

If X is Polish, then (1) and (2) are equivalent to:

(3) *For every nonempty closed $F \subseteq X$, the restriction $f|_F$ has a point of continuity.*

Moreover, if X is Polish and $f \notin \mathrm{B}_1(X)$, then there exist nonempty countable sets $D_0, D_1 \subseteq X$ and reals $a < b$ such that

$$D_0 \subseteq f^{-1}(-\infty, a], \quad D_1 \subseteq f^{-1}[b,\infty), \quad \overline{D_0} = \overline{D_1}.$$

1.1. **From Rosenthal's dichotomy to the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy to Shelah's NIP.** In a metrizable space every point of the closure of a set is the limit of a sequence of points of the set. In spaces of functions with the topology of pointwise convergence, by contrast, the closure of a set need not admit this sequential description. Whether a deep computation is accessible to approximation, that is, whether a deep computation is the limit of a *sequence* of computations, is therefore a genuine question. The answer is given by Rosenthal's

[2]The implication (1)⇒(2) holds in every topological space. Indeed, if f is the pointwise limit of a sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ of continuous functions and a is a real number, then

$$f^{-1}(a,\infty) = \bigcup_{k\geq 1} \bigcup_{m\in\mathbb{N}} \bigcap_{n\geq m} f_n^{-1}[a + 1/k, \infty)$$

is a countable union of closed sets. The same is true of $f^{-1}(-\infty, a)$; since every open subset of $\mathbb{R}$ is a countable union of intervals $(a,b) = (a,\infty) \cap (-\infty, b)$, condition (2) follows. The reverse implication, (2)⇒(1), was established by Lebesgue for real-valued functions of finitely many real variables [Leb04] and extended by Hausdorff to real-valued functions on metric spaces [Kec95, Theorem 24.10]. The proof of (2)⇒(1) requires of X only normality and the property that every open subset be an F_σ set, that is, perfect normality. The implication (1)⇒(3) holds whenever X is Polish. If f satisfies (1) and F is a nonempty closed subset of X, then the restriction $f|_F$ is of Baire class 1, and, as noted before Fact 1.2, the points of discontinuity of $f|_F$ form a meager subset of F. Being closed in a Polish space, the set F is itself Polish, hence a Baire space that this meager set cannot exhaust; the restriction $f|_F$ therefore has a point of continuity. The reverse implication (3)⇒(1) is due to Baire, who proved this implication in his thesis for real-valued functions of real variables [Bai99]; for Polish spaces, see [Kec95, Theorem 24.15]. Finally, the last assertion of Fact 1.2 follows from the implication (3)⇒(1) together with the Baire category theorem and the separability of X.

dichotomy and the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy, which we recall in this subsection; from them the NIP emerges in the theory of function spaces.

On the Cantor space $X = 2^{\mathbb{N}}$, the n-th coordinate map $\pi_n \colon X \to \{0,1\}$ is continuous for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$; however, the sequence $(\pi_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ has *no* convergent subsequence in $\mathbb{R}^X$ (see [Tod97, Chapter 1.1]). In a sense, this sequence exhibits the most extreme failure of sequential convergence. Indeed, the closure of $\{\pi_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ in $\{0,1\}^X$, or in $\mathbb{R}^X$, is homeomorphic to the Stone–Čech compactification $\beta\mathbb{N}$ of the discrete space of natural numbers. The space $\beta\mathbb{N}$ has cardinality $2^{2^{\aleph_0}}$, the largest possible for a separable Hausdorff space, and its points correspond to the ultrafilters on $\mathbb{N}$.[3]

In 1974 Haskell Rosenthal proved the following dichotomy for pointwise bounded sequences of continuous functions on a Polish space. His theorem shows that for these sequences a copy of $\beta\mathbb{N}$, such as the closure of the coordinate maps, is the only obstruction to the existence of a convergent subsequence.

Theorem 1.3 (Rosenthal's dichotomy [Ros74, Ros77])**.** *If X is a Polish space and $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ is a pointwise bounded sequence in $\mathrm{C_p}(X)$, then the sequence (f_n) has either a convergent subsequence or a subsequence whose closure in $\mathbb{R}^X$ is homeomorphic to $\beta\mathbb{N}$.*

Rosenthal's dichotomy is the core of the proof of *Rosenthal's ℓ_1-theorem*: every bounded sequence in a Banach space has a subsequence that is either weakly Cauchy or equivalent to the unit vector basis of ℓ_1, the space of absolutely summable sequences. The connection is direct, for a bounded sequence in a Banach space is weakly Cauchy exactly when, regarded as a sequence of continuous functions on the unit ball of the dual space with the weak* topology, the sequence converges pointwise; this ball is compact, and metrizable when the Banach space is separable. In particular, a Banach space contains no isomorphic copy of ℓ_1 if and only if every bounded sequence in the space has a weakly Cauchy subsequence.

The Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem, which concerns sets rather than sequences, characterizes the relative compactness in the larger space $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ of a pointwise bounded set of continuous functions on a Polish space X. For such a set, relative compactness in $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ is the property that every function in the pointwise closure of the set be of Baire class 1. The theorem is thus a counterpart of Rosenthal's dichotomy, although usually stated as an equivalence rather than as a dichotomy (see Theorem 1.4 below).

The statement of the theorem requires the following notation. For $f \in \mathbb{R}^X$ and a real number a, define

$$X^f_{\leq a} \coloneqq f^{-1}(-\infty, a], \qquad\qquad X^f_{\geq a} \coloneqq f^{-1}[a, +\infty).$$

[3]Addition on $\mathbb{N}$ extends to an associative operation on $\beta\mathbb{N}$, whose idempotent elements, the idempotent ultrafilters, exist by the Ellis–Numakura lemma. Alva, Dueñez, Iovino and Walton [ADIW26] use idempotent ultrafilters to prove the existence of *deep equilibria* in compositional computation structures. Deep equilibria are limits of the iterates of a single computation, taken along an ultrafilter on $\mathbb{N}$, that are idempotent under composition.

For a set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ and a real number a, define, by a slight abuse of notation,

$$X^A_{\leq a} \coloneqq \bigcap_{f\in A} X^f_{\leq a} = \{x \in X : f(x) \leq a \text{ for all } f \in A\},$$
$$X^A_{\geq a} \coloneqq \bigcap_{f\in A} X^f_{\geq a} = \{x \in X : f(x) \geq a \text{ for all } f \in A\};$$

in particular, we have $X^\emptyset_{\geq a} = X = X^\emptyset_{\leq a}$. For a sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in $\mathbb{R}^X$ and a set $I \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, define $I^\complement \coloneqq \mathbb{N} \setminus I$ and $f_I \coloneqq \{f_i : i \in I\}$.

Theorem 1.4 (The Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy [BFT78])**.** *Let X be a Polish space, and let $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ be a pointwise bounded set. The following are equivalent:*

(i) The set A is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$.
(ii) For every sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in A and all reals $a < b$, there is a set $I \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$X^{f_I}_{\leq a} \cap X^{f_{I^\complement}}_{\geq b} = \emptyset.$$

(In this form, the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy is a special case of the equivalence (ii)⇔(v) of Corollary 4G of Bourgain, Fremlin and Talagrand [BFT78].)

In condition (ii) of Theorem 1.4, the set $X^{f_I}_{\leq a}$ is defined by the inequalities $f_i(x) \leq a$ with $i \in I$, and the set $X^{f_{I^\complement}}_{\geq b}$ by the inequalities $f_j(x) \geq b$ with $j \in I^\complement$. Since I or $I^\complement$ is infinite, at least one of the two sets is defined by countably infinitely many inequalities. A computation, however, can check only finitely many inequalities at a time, and the following definitions accordingly impose only finitely many.

Definition 1.5. Let X be a set. A set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ of functions has the *finitary NIP*, for *not the independence property*, if, for every sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in A and all reals $a < b$, there exist finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ such that $X^{f_I}_{\leq a} \cap X^{f_J}_{\geq b} = \emptyset$; such sets I, J are said to *witness finitary NIP for (f_n) and a, b.*

A set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ has the *finitary Independence Property (IP)* if finitary NIP fails for A.

Explicitly, a set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ has finitary IP when there exist a sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in A and reals $a < b$ such that $X^{f_I}_{\leq a} \cap X^{f_J}_{\geq b} \neq \emptyset$ for every pair of finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$. If the word "finite" is omitted in these definitions, we obtain *countable* NIP and *countable* IP. Countable NIP is weaker than finitary NIP, and countable IP is accordingly stronger than finitary IP. If, in addition, the witnesses are required to satisfy $J = I^\complement$, we obtain the properties that we call *BFT-NIP* and *BFT-IP*. Theorem 1.4 thus states that, on a Polish space X, a pointwise bounded set $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ if and only if the set A has BFT-NIP.

From now on, IP and NIP mean *finitary* IP and NIP unless otherwise specified.

Theorem 1.6. *Let X be a compact metrizable space. For every pointwise bounded set $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$, the following are equivalent:*

(i) the set A is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$;
(ii) the set A has BFT-NIP;
(iii) the set A has countable NIP;
(iv) the set A has finitary NIP.

Proof. The equivalence (i)⇔(ii) is Theorem 1.4. The implications (iv)⇒(iii) and (ii)⇒(iii) are trivial. The converse (iii)⇒(ii) holds because witnesses I and J of countable NIP satisfy $J \subseteq I^{\complement}$, whence I and $I^{\complement}$ witness BFT-NIP. To prove (ii)⇒(iv), suppose that (f_n) and $a < b$ witness finitary IP, and let $I \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be given. The closed sets $X^{f_n}_{\leq a}$ $(n \in I)$ and $X^{f_m}_{\geq b}$ $(m \in I^{\complement})$ have the finite intersection property; by compactness, therefore, we obtain $X^{f_I}_{\leq a} \cap X^{f_{I^{\complement}}}_{\geq b} \neq \emptyset$. Since I is arbitrary, the set A does not have BFT-NIP, and (ii) fails. □

A compact metrizable space is Polish, and Theorem 1.4 therefore applies in the proof above. Two of the equivalences hold more generally: (ii)⇔(iv) holds for every set of continuous functions on a compact space, even without the assumption of pointwise boundedness, and (ii)⇔(iii) holds for every set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ on an arbitrary set X. Theorem 1.6 can be cast as a dichotomy: on a compact metrizable space X, every pointwise bounded set $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ either is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ or has IP in the finitary and, equivalently, in the countable sense.

The name comes from model theory, where Saharon Shelah isolated the independence property of a formula in 1971 [She71, Definition 4.1] as one of the dividing lines of his classification of first-order theories [She90]. In Section 1.5 we compare the NIP of Definition 1.5 with the model-theoretic independence property and with the corresponding notions in combinatorics and in statistical learning.

1.2. **Rosenthal compacta.** The Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand dichotomy leads to the Rosenthal compacta, the compact spaces within which the deep computations of this paper are classified. By Theorem 1.4, if a pointwise bounded set of continuous functions on a Polish space has BFT-NIP, then the pointwise closure of the set is a compact set of functions of the first Baire class. Rosenthal made compact sets of this kind the subject of a study of their own in 1977 [Ros77], and Godefroy [God80] named them after Rosenthal in 1980.

Definition 1.7. A *Rosenthal compactum* is a topological space homeomorphic to a compact subset of $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ for some Polish space X.

Rosenthal compacta are remarkably well behaved with respect to sequences: every point in the closure of a subset of a Rosenthal compactum is the limit of a sequence of points of the subset [BFT78, Theorem 3F]. In this paper Rosenthal compacta serve as spaces of deep computations. In Theorem 3.1 below we show that, for countably many features and under the Extendibility Axiom, the limits of the extended computations of an NIP set of computations that preserves a prescribed collection of shards form a Rosenthal compactum on each type shard. Here a type shard is a compact set of states and limit states on which every feature obeys a prescribed bound (see Section 2.1.1).

1.3. **The special case $\mathrm{B}_1(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$ with $\mathcal{P}$ countable.** A state is described by the values that the features take at the state, and a computation is therefore a map with values in a product of copies of the real line indexed by the features. In this subsection we reduce the study of such maps to that of real-valued functions. Fix a countable set $\mathcal{P}$, whose elements we call *predicate symbols* or *formal predicates* and which play the role of the features; in this paper, "countable" means finite or countably infinite. Our goal is to characterize the relatively compact subsets of $\mathrm{B}_1(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$, where X is a perfectly normal space, typically a Polish space.

Whenever $\mathcal{P}$ is regarded as a topological space, the topology of $\mathcal{P}$ is the discrete one, and the product $X \times \mathcal{P}$ is regarded either as a set or as a topological product, depending on the context. The spaces $\mathrm{C_p}(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}) \subseteq \mathrm{B}_1(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$ are subspaces of the ambient space $(\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^X$, which can be described in two other ways, through the natural homeomorphisms

$$(\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^X \cong \mathbb{R}^{X \times \mathcal{P}} \cong (\mathbb{R}^X)^{\mathcal{P}},$$

given by

$$\mathbb{R}^{X \times \mathcal{P}} \to (\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^X : \Phi \mapsto \check{\Phi}$$
$$\mathbb{R}^{X \times \mathcal{P}} \to (\mathbb{R}^X)^{\mathcal{P}} : \Phi \mapsto \Phi\hat{},$$

where

$$\check{\Phi}(x) \coloneqq \Phi(x, \cdot) \in \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}, \qquad \Phi\check{}(P) \coloneqq \Phi(\cdot, P) \in \mathbb{R}^X.$$

These identifications treat X and $\mathcal{P}$ as mere sets; in particular, the topology of X plays no role in them.

The following proposition reduces the study of continuous functions, and of functions of Baire class 1, from X to $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ to the case of real-valued functions.

Proposition 1.8. *The identification* $(\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^X \cong \mathbb{R}^{X \times \mathcal{P}} \cong (\mathbb{R}^X)^{\mathcal{P}}$ *induces identifications*

$$\mathrm{C_p}(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}) \cong \mathrm{C_p}(X \times \mathcal{P}) \cong \mathrm{C_p}(X)^{\mathcal{P}}, \quad \mathrm{B}_1(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}) \cong \mathrm{B}_1(X \times \mathcal{P}) \cong \mathrm{B}_1(X)^{\mathcal{P}}.$$

(The cardinality of $\mathcal{P}$ plays no role here.)

Proof. The identification of the $\mathrm{C_p}$-spaces follows from the definition of the product topology and the discreteness of $\mathcal{P}$. By the former, a continuous map $X \to \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ is precisely a $\mathcal{P}$-indexed family of continuous functions $X \to \mathbb{R}$; by the latter, such families correspond to continuous functions $X \times \mathcal{P} \to \mathbb{R}$. For the spaces of functions of Baire class 1, recall that membership in the first Baire class is defined through pointwise limits of sequences of continuous functions. Since a sequence of $\mathcal{P}$-indexed families of continuous functions is the same as a $\mathcal{P}$-indexed family of sequences of continuous functions, the identification of these spaces follows as well. □

For $A \subseteq Y^X$ and $K \subseteq X$, we write $A|_K \coloneqq \{f|_K : f \in A\}$ for the set of restrictions to K of the functions in A. Similarly, for $A \subseteq (\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^X$ and $P \in \mathcal{P}$, we write $\pi_P \circ A \coloneqq \{\pi_P \circ f : f \in A\}$, where $\pi_P \colon \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}} \to \mathbb{R}$ is the projection onto the coordinate P. A set $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$ is *pointwise bounded* if the set $\pi_P \circ A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ is pointwise bounded for every $P \in \mathcal{P}$. The following theorem extends Theorem 1.6 to $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$-valued functions.

Theorem 1.9. *Assume that* $\mathcal{P}$ *is countable,* X *is a Polish space, and* $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$ *is pointwise bounded. The following are equivalent for every compact* $K \subseteq X$*:*

(i) the set $A|_K$ *is relatively compact in* $\mathrm{B}_1(K, \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$*;*
(ii) the set $\pi_P \circ A|_K$ *has NIP for every* $P \in \mathcal{P}$*.*

Proof. By Proposition 1.8 and Tychonov's theorem, condition (i) holds if and only if $\pi_P \circ A|_K$ is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(K)$ for every $P \in \mathcal{P}$. Since K is compact metrizable, Theorem 1.6 shows that this is equivalent to (ii). □

In the applications, the NIP is verified on a set of states, whereas compactness is available only on the closure of this set. The following lemma shows that the NIP survives the passage to the closure.

Lemma 1.10. *Assume that X is Hausdorff and that $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$. The following are equivalent for every $L \subseteq X$:*

(i) the set $A|_L$ satisfies the NIP;
(ii) the set $A|_{\overline{L}}$ satisfies the NIP.

Proof. The implication (ii)⇒(i) is trivial. Conversely, suppose that a sequence (f_n) in A and reals $a < b$ witness the IP on $\overline{L}$, and choose a' and b' with $a < a' < b' < b$. For finite disjoint $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, the open set $\bigcap_{n\in I} f_n^{-1}(-\infty, a') \cap \bigcap_{n\in J} f_n^{-1}(b', \infty)$ contains a point of $\overline{L}$, namely a point at which $f_n \leq a$ for $n \in I$ and $f_n \geq b$ for $n \in J$; hence the open set meets L. Therefore the sequence (f_n) and the reals $a' < b'$ witness the IP on L. □

1.4. **Five canonical Rosenthal compacta.** Here we fix the notation for five Rosenthal compacta, all built on the Cantor set, that are the canonical members of the classes of Todorčević's trichotomy (see Theorem 3.3 below). By the trichotomy, the space of deep computations of each non-metrizable NIP example of Section 5 contains a copy of one of these compacta. The five compacta are distinguished from one another by three topological properties. Recall that a topological space is *separable* if it has a countable dense subset and *hereditarily separable* if each of its subspaces is separable. Finally, a topological space is *first countable* if each of its points has a countable base of neighborhoods.

Let $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ carry the product topology and the lexicographic order $<$, whose order topology is the product topology. The set of finite binary words is denoted $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, and the length of a word $t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ is denoted $|t|$. For $a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we write $a{\restriction}n$ for the word formed by the first n bits of a. Two words are *comparable* if one extends the other, and an *antichain* is a set of pairwise incomparable words. For a finite word $t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, let $t^\frown 0^\infty$ and $t^\frown 1^\infty$ be the sequences that begin with t and continue with all 0's and with all 1's, respectively. The set of sequences extending t is then the clopen interval $[t^\frown 0^\infty, t^\frown 1^\infty]$. Copies of the binary tree within itself index a countable dense subset of the last of the five compacta below, and the families of Section 3.3 are compared along these copies. These copies are the dyadic subtrees: a *dyadic subtree* of $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ is a subset isomorphic to $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ under the order of extension. We write a dyadic subtree as $\{w_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$, indexed through the canonical isomorphism, which preserves extension and the lexicographic order. A dyadic subtree is called *regular* if each level of the subtree is contained in a level of $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$. A sequence $(u_k)_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$ of words *converges* to $a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$ if, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, all but finitely many of the words u_k extend $a{\restriction}n$.

Double brackets denote truth values: $[\![\ldots]\!]$ is 1 if the statement inside the brackets is true and 0 if it is false. We introduce the following functions $2^{\mathbb{N}} \to \{0, 1\}$:

- the *prefix test* $v_t := [\![\cdot{\restriction}|t| = t]\!]$, the characteristic function of the set of sequences extending a fixed word $t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$;
- the *equality test* $\delta_a := [\![\cdot = a]\!]$, the characteristic function of the singleton $\{a\}$ for fixed $a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$;
- the *threshold tests* $\chi_{[a} := [\![a \leq \cdot]\!]$ and $\chi_{(a} := [\![a < \cdot]\!]$, the characteristic functions of the final intervals $\{x : a \leq x\}$ (closed) and $\{x : a < x\}$ (open), for fixed $a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$; the special case $\mathbf{0} := \chi_{(1^\infty}$ is the identically zero function.

Prefix tests are continuous, and so are the threshold tests $\chi_{[t^\frown 0^\infty}$ and $\chi_{(t^\frown 1^\infty}$, since the value of each of these functions depends only on the first $|t|$ bits of the argument. By contrast, equality tests and threshold tests at all other points are discontinuous functions of Baire class 1. All closures below are taken in the topology of pointwise convergence.

(1) The *Alexandroff compactification* $A(2^{\mathbb{N}}) = \{\delta_a : a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}\} \cup \{\mathbf{0}\}$. Each δ_a is isolated, and every neighborhood of $\mathbf{0}$ contains all but finitely many of the functions δ_a. Since the isolated points δ_a are uncountably many, the Alexandroff compactification is neither separable nor first countable at $\mathbf{0}$.

(2) The *extended Alexandroff compactification* $\hat{A}(2^{\mathbb{N}}) = \overline{\{v_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}} = \{v_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\} \cup A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$. As $n \to \infty$, the prefix tests $v_{a\restriction n}$ converge to δ_a; along an antichain they converge to $\mathbf{0}$. Hence the extended Alexandroff compactification is separable but not first countable.

(3) The *split Cantor set* $S(2^{\mathbb{N}}) = \{\chi_{[a}, \chi_{(a} : a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}\}$. The continuous thresholds $\chi_{[t^\frown 0^\infty}$, together with the isolated point $\mathbf{0} = \chi_{(1^\infty}$, form a countable dense subset: thresholds approaching a from below converge to $\chi_{[a}$, and from above to $\chi_{(a}$. The split Cantor set is therefore separable; it is, moreover, first countable and hereditarily separable, but not metrizable.

(4) The *Alexandroff duplicate* $D(2^{\mathbb{N}}) = \{(\mathbf{0}, a), (\delta_a, a) : a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}\} \subseteq A(2^{\mathbb{N}}) \times 2^{\mathbb{N}}$. The points (δ_a, a) are isolated, whereas every neighborhood of $(\mathbf{0}, a)$ contains, for all b in some neighborhood of a, the point $(\mathbf{0}, b)$ and, with finitely many exceptions, the point (δ_b, b). As V runs through a countable base of neighborhoods of a in $2^{\mathbb{N}}$, the sets of points $(\mathbf{0}, b)$ and (δ_b, b) with $b \in V$, the point (δ_a, a) excepted, form a base of neighborhoods of $(\mathbf{0}, a)$. Consequently, the Alexandroff duplicate is first countable; having uncountably many isolated points, the duplicate is not separable. The Alexandroff duplicate is contained in the separable compactum $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}}) = \overline{\{(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty) : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}} = D(2^{\mathbb{N}}) \cup \{(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty) : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$.

(5) The *extended duplicate of the split Cantor set*. Following Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos [ADK08, 4.3.7], we define this compactum along a regular dyadic subtree $\{s_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ of $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, fixed once and for all. This subtree is required to satisfy $s_t\widehat{\ }0^\infty \neq s_{t'}\widehat{\ }0^\infty$ and $s_t\widehat{\ }1^\infty \neq s_{t'}\widehat{\ }1^\infty$ for all distinct $t, t' \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, and the extended duplicate is then

$$\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}})) = \overline{\{(v_{s_t}, \chi_{[s_t\widehat{\ }0^\infty}) : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}} \subseteq \hat{A}(2^{\mathbb{N}}) \times S(2^{\mathbb{N}}).$$

Call a sequence $a \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$ a *branch* of the subtree if each of its initial segments $a\restriction n$ is extended by some word s_t; the branches form a perfect subset of $2^{\mathbb{N}}$. The compactum $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ consists of the isolated points $(v_{s_t}, \chi_{[s_t\widehat{\ }0^\infty})$ and, for each branch a, of the point $(\delta_a, \chi_{[a})$ and of at most two points with first coordinate $\mathbf{0}$ [ADK08, 4.3.7]. The point $(\mathbf{0}, \chi_{[a})$ belongs to the compactum exactly when some sequence (u_k) of pairwise incomparable words of the subtree converges to a with $u_k\widehat{\ }0^\infty$ increasing in k. Likewise, the point $(\mathbf{0}, \chi_{(a})$ belongs to the compactum exactly when some such sequence converges to a with $u_k\widehat{\ }0^\infty$ decreasing in k. The points $(\delta_a, \chi_{[a})$ are reached along the branches. Indeed, if a is a branch and $u_1, u_2, \ldots$ are the words of the subtree that are initial segments of a, listed by increasing length, then the sequences $u_k\widehat{\ }0^\infty$ increase strictly to a. The points $(v_{u_k}, \chi_{[u_k\widehat{\ }0^\infty})$ then converge to $(\delta_a, \chi_{[a})$ as $k \to \infty$. As the closure of a countable set,

the extended duplicate of the split Cantor set is separable. This compactum is also first countable, since the compactum embeds into the Helly space of nondecreasing functions from $[0,1]$ into itself, which is first countable [ADK08, 4.3.7]. For each branch a, the point $(\delta_a, \chi_{[a})$ is the only point $(\delta_b, \chi_{[b})$, with b a branch, whose first coordinate takes the value 1 at a. The points $(\delta_a, \chi_{[a})$, with a a branch, therefore form a discrete subspace, which has the cardinality of the continuum because the branches form a perfect set. Hence the extended duplicate of the split Cantor set is not hereditarily separable.

Figure 1 shows the five compacta as patterns of convergence of words of the binary tree $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$.

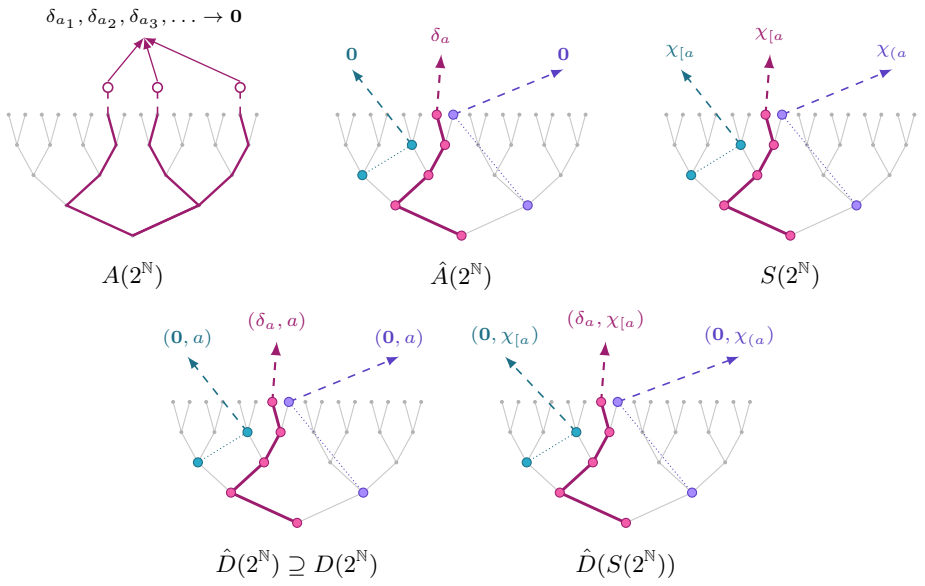


FIGURE 1. The five compacta of Section 1.4, drawn as patterns of convergence of words of the binary tree $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, with the dashed arrows ending at the limits.

The constructions of the Alexandroff compactification and of the Alexandroff duplicate make sense with $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ replaced by any compact metric space K; the resulting spaces are denoted $A(K)$ and $D(K)$, respectively. The space $A(K)$, being the one-point compactification of a discrete space of the cardinality of K, depends up to homeomorphism only on this cardinality; for instance, $A([0,1])$ is homeomorphic to $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.

1.5. **NIP in model theory, combinatorics and learning: polynomial versus exponential growth.** We now relate the NIP of Definition 1.5 to the corresponding notions in model theory, combinatorics and statistical learning. This relation is used in Section 5, where a bound on a Vapnik–Chervonenkis dimension yields the NIP of Bresenham's algorithm. For families of $\{0,1\}$-valued functions, that is, for families of sets, a combinatorial dividing line closely related to the NIP appeared independently in the three fields between 1968 and 1972, some years before

the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem (see Theorem 1.4). In each field the line separates the "tame" families of sets from the "wild" ones. The number of traces of a tame family on an n-element set, that is, of intersections of the set with members of the family, is bounded by a polynomial in n, whereas in a wild family, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, some n-element set has all 2^n possible traces.

In model theory: Among the dividing lines of Shelah's classification theory [She90], the independence property is detected by counting types over finite sets of parameters. Let T be a complete first-order theory, and let $\varphi(x;y)$ be a formula of the language of T, in which x and y are finite tuples of variables of lengths $|x|$ and $|y|$. Finally, let B be a finite set of $|y|$-tuples of elements of a model M of T. A *φ-type* over B is a maximal set of formulas $\varphi(x;b)$ and $\neg\varphi(x;b)$, with $b \in B$, that is consistent with the theory of M with constants for the elements of M. Since B is finite, every φ-type over B is realized by an $|x|$-tuple a of elements of M, and the type is determined by the set $\{b \in B : M \models \varphi(a;b)\}$. Hence the set $S_\varphi(B)$ of φ-types over B is in bijection with the traces on B of the family of sets $\{b : M \models \varphi(a;b)\}$, with a ranging over $|x|$-tuples of elements of M. This bijection gives the bound $|S_\varphi(B)| \le 2^{|B|}$. The formula φ has the *independence property* (IP) if, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, some set B of n tuples satisfies $|S_\varphi(B)| = 2^n$. Otherwise the formula is *NIP*, or *dependent*, and the theory T is NIP if every formula of the language of T is NIP. Since T is complete, these notions do not depend on the model M.

If φ is NIP, the Sauer–Shelah lemma below bounds $|S_\varphi(B)|$ by a polynomial in $|B|$. For a set A of parameters, we write $S_\varphi(A)$ for the set of φ-types over the set of $|y|$-tuples of elements of A. If φ has IP, then for every n some set A of at most $n|y|$ parameters satisfies $|S_\varphi(A)| \ge 2^n$ [Sim15, Section 2.3.4]. Consequently, φ is NIP if and only if $|S_\varphi(A)|$ is bounded by a polynomial in $|A|$ as A ranges over the finite sets of parameters. Over infinite sets of parameters, counting φ-types does not separate NIP from IP without further set-theoretic hypotheses. Indeed, every unstable formula, NIP or not, already has 2^κ φ-types over some set of κ parameters whenever κ is infinite and $2^\kappa = \kappa^+$ [Sim15, Section 2.3.4].

In combinatorics: Sauer [Sau72] and Shelah [She72] proved independently the following dichotomy, now known as the *Sauer–Shelah lemma*. Let $\mathscr{F} = \{C_i : i \in I\}$ be a family of subsets of a set Ω, indexed by a set I. Then either for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ there is a set $B \subseteq \Omega$ with $|B| = n$ such that $|\{C_i \cap B : i \in I\}| = 2^n$, or there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that, for every $B \subseteq \Omega$ with $|B| \ge N$,

$$|\{C_i \cap B : i \in I\}| \le \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \binom{|B|}{j}.$$

In the first case $\mathscr{F}$ is said to have "exponential complexity", and in the second case "polynomial complexity"; every family of subsets of a *finite* set Ω has polynomial complexity. The name "polynomial complexity" is justified by the following estimate, valid for fixed $N > 0$ and for $|B| = m >$

0, which bounds the number of traces by a polynomial in m:

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \binom{m}{j} \leq \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \frac{m^j}{j!} \leq \left(\sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \frac{1}{j!} \right) \cdot m^{N-1} < e \cdot m^{N-1}.$$

In statistical learning: The Sauer–Shelah lemma is also the dichotomy that Vapnik and Chervonenkis had announced in 1968 [VC68], in their study of the uniform convergence of relative frequencies to probabilities. Their proof of the dichotomy appeared in 1971 [VC71], a year before the papers of Sauer and Shelah (see also [VC74]). The largest size of a set $B \subseteq \Omega$ with $2^{|B|}$ traces $C_i \cap B$ is called the *VC dimension* of $\mathscr{F}$; equivalently, the VC dimension is $N-1$ for the least integer N as in the Sauer–Shelah lemma, and the VC dimension is infinite if no such integer exists. Through the Vapnik–Chervonenkis theorem, the Sauer–Shelah lemma bounds the sample size needed to learn a concept class $\mathscr{F}$ of finite VC dimension up to a preset error and with a preset confidence. Learning in this sense was formalized by Valiant in 1984 as *probably approximately correct* (PAC) learnability [Val84]. The Fundamental Theorem of Statistical Learning states that a class of $\{0,1\}$-valued functions satisfying a mild measurability condition is PAC-learnable if and only if the VC dimension of the class is finite [BEHW89]; see also [SSBD14, Theorem 6.7].

For first-order formulas the three dichotomies coincide. To see why, fix a formula $\varphi(x;y)$ and consider the family of sets $\{b : M \models \varphi(a;b)\}$, with a ranging over the $|x|$-tuples of elements of a model M of T. By the description of φ-types given above, the formula φ has IP exactly when this family has infinite VC dimension, and for an NIP formula the Sauer–Shelah lemma gives the polynomial bound on the number of φ-types. For an arbitrary family of sets, finiteness of the VC dimension implies that the characteristic functions of the members of the family have the NIP of Definition 1.5. Indeed, suppose that the characteristic functions of a sequence of members of the family have IP, and let $m \in \mathbb{N}$ be given. Index 2^m terms of the sequence as C_S, with S ranging over the subsets of $\{1,\ldots,m\}$; by IP, for each $i \in \{1,\ldots,m\}$ there is a point x_i that belongs to C_S exactly when $i \in S$. The sets C_S then cut out every subset of $\{x_1,\ldots,x_m\}$, whence the VC dimension of the family is at least m. The NIP does not, however, imply finite VC dimension: the finite subsets of $\mathbb{N}$ form a family of infinite VC dimension whose characteristic functions have the NIP.

Historical remarks. The Baire hierarchy of functions was introduced by René-Louis Baire in his 1899 doctoral thesis, *Sur les fonctions de variables réelles* [Bai99]. The theory of spaces of continuous functions with the topology of pointwise convergence, C_p-theory, was pioneered by A. V. Arhangel'skiĭ and his students in the 1970s and 1980s [Ark92]. The theory has since found applications in model theory and in functional analysis; Tkachuk's problem book [Tka11] develops the subject systematically, through problems with complete solutions.

2. Compositional Computation Structures:

A structural approach to arbitrary-precision computations

Compositional computation structures were introduced by Alva, Dueñez, Iovino and Walton in the first paper of this series [ADIW26] as a framework for computation with real-valued quantities known only to finite precision. In the present section we recall this framework, within which the theory of function spaces assembled in Section 1 is brought to bear on computation. States are observed through real-valued features, and each state is accordingly described by the family of values of all the features at that state, which is called the type of the state. Computations act on states and compose with one another. The limits of computations along ultrafilters, taken pointwise in the space of types, are the deep computations, which thereby become points of a function space endowed with the topology of pointwise convergence. Finally, we recall the stable sets of computations, studied in the first paper of this series, and close the section with two examples that motivate the classification of Section 3.

2.1. **Computation States Structures.** The framework begins with the states on which computations act and with the real-valued features through which these states are observed. A *computation states structure* is a pair $(L, \mathcal{P})$ consisting of a set L, whose elements are called *states*, and a collection $\mathcal{P}$ of real-valued functions on L, called *predicates* or *features*. The predicates are the primitives of a computation, the quantities that are given and accepted as computable. For $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $v \in L$, the number $P(v)$ is the value of the (observable) feature P at the state v. Maps $f\colon L \to L$ are called *transitions* of $(L, \mathcal{P})$; the computations of Definition 2.4 below are transitions.

The *type* of a state $v \in L$ is the indexed family[4]

$$\mathrm{tp}(v) = (P(v))_{P\in\mathcal{P}} \in \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$$

of its features.

We assume that distinct states have distinct types, that is, that the type map $v \mapsto \mathrm{tp}(v)$ is injective. The state space L may then be identified with the image $\mathrm{tp}[L] \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ of the type map and endowed with the topology that $\mathrm{tp}[L]$ inherits from the product $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$. The resulting topology is the topology of pointwise convergence on the features; in particular, for each $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the map $v \mapsto P(v)$ is continuous on L.

The principal examples are the state space $L = \mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{N}}$ with the predicates $P_i(v) = v_i$ for $i \in \mathbb{N}$ and, for a positive integer n, the state space $L = \mathbb{R}^n$ with the predicates $P_i(v) = v_i$ for $0 \le i < n$. Their subspaces are the state spaces of primary interest in this paper. Every computation states structure with countably many predicates is of this form: once the predicates are enumerated, the identification of states with types makes the state space a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{N}}$ or of some $\mathbb{R}^n$, with the predicates as coordinate functions.

---

[4]As in Proposition 1.8, where $\mathcal{P}$ is merely a set of symbols, we regard each predicate as named by a formal label P, a *predicate symbol*. The meaning of this symbol in the computation states structure is the real function $P(\cdot)\colon v \mapsto P(v)$ on L. The symbol P thus names an observable feature, whose value at a state $v \in L$ is $P(v)$. Whenever $\mathcal{P}$ is used as an index set, as in the product $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ below, it is regarded as a set of symbols. The distinction between a symbol and its meaning is usually suppressed in mathematics, but the model-theoretic framework requires awareness of it. When necessary, we write $P(\cdot)$ for the function on L and P for the symbol; when no confusion can arise, we also write P for the function.

Definition 2.1. Let $(L, \mathcal{P})$ be a computation states structure. The type $\mathrm{tp}(v) \in \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ of a state $v \in L$ is called a *realized* (state) type. The closure of the set of realized types in $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$, with the topology of pointwise convergence, is called the *space of (state) types* of $(L, \mathcal{P})$ and is denoted $\mathcal{L}$. The elements $\mathbf{v} \in \mathcal{L}$ are called *state types*, and those in $\mathcal{L} \setminus L$ are called *unrealized* state types.

State types formalize the intuitive notion of a limit state, and the predicates extend to them continuously. Indeed, for each $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the restriction to $\mathcal{L}$ of the P-th coordinate map $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}} \to \mathbb{R}$ given by $\mathbf{v} = (\mathbf{v}_Q)_{Q \in \mathcal{P}} \mapsto \mathbf{v}_P$ is a continuous extension of the predicate $P(\cdot)$ on L. Abusing notation, we still denote this extension by $P(\cdot)$, or just P.

Remark 2.2. One may regard unrealized state types as "hyper-states", and those among them that are limits of sequences of realized state types as "deep states". Every state type, by contrast, is the limit of a family of realized state types along a suitable ultrafilter, since $\mathcal{L}$ is the closure of the set of realized types. For readers versed in model theory we note that, as far as the realization of state types with parameters in L is concerned, the type space $(\mathcal{L}, \mathcal{P})$ serves as a "poor man's" ultraproduct of $(L, \mathcal{P})$: by the very definition of $\mathcal{L}$, every state type $\mathbf{v}$ is realized in this type space by the point $\mathbf{v}$ itself, whose features take the values that $\mathbf{v}$ prescribes.

2.1.1. *Bounds on precision and magnitude. Shards.* The analysis of this paper takes place on shards, the sets of states on which each feature obeys a prescribed bound; before defining them, we explain why actual computation imposes such bounds. Computation states structures are designed to model actual computation, in which operations on real-valued quantities can be carried out only approximately, to a preset degree of precision. A bound on the magnitude of the quantities involved is no less important in practice, for no machine can store, let alone compute with, arbitrarily large numbers. An actual computation therefore fixes at the outset bounds on the errors and on the absolute magnitudes of the quantities involved, even when the collection $\mathcal{P}$ of predicates is infinite, possibly uncountable. Moreover, different parts of a computation may require different error bounds and may deal with quantities of very different sizes. Focusing on magnitudes, we fix in advance a bound on the values of each predicate, the bound depending on the predicate. We are thereby led to the notion of *shard*, introduced in the first paper of this series [ADIW26]. As before, the state space L of a computation states structure $(L, \mathcal{P})$ is identified with the set $\mathrm{tp}[L] \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ of realized types.

Definition 2.3. Let $(L, \mathcal{P})$ be a computation states structure. A *sizer* is a family $r_\bullet = (r_P)_{P \in \mathcal{P}}$ of positive real numbers indexed by $\mathcal{P}$. For a sizer $r_\bullet$, let $\mathbb{R}[r_\bullet] := \prod_{P \in \mathcal{P}} [-r_P, r_P]$, and define the $r_\bullet$-*shard* of the state space L by

$$L[r_\bullet] = L \cap \mathbb{R}[r_\bullet].$$

The $r_\bullet$-*type shard* is the closure $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] = \overline{L[r_\bullet]}$ of $L[r_\bullet]$ in $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$.

The union of all type shards, as the sizer $r_\bullet$ varies, is denoted $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ and called the space of *shard-supported types*.

By Tychonov's theorem, the box $\mathbb{R}[r_\bullet]$ is compact, and the type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$, a closed subset of $\mathbb{R}[r_\bullet]$, is compact as well. We have $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}} \subseteq \mathcal{L}$, and the inclusion may be proper; equality holds in the important special case when $\mathcal{P}$ is countable (see [ADIW26]).

2.2. **Compositional Computation Structures.** In this subsection we recall the compositional computation structures of the first paper of this series [ADIW26], within which deep computations are defined. Computations transform states, and two computations performed one after the other form a computation. The computations of a system therefore form a semigroup under composition, which we take to contain the identity, the computation that does nothing. Deep computations are limits of computations along ultrafilters; to give them a meaning, we topologize the set L^L of transitions of a computation states structure $(L, \mathcal{P})$ as a subspace of the product $\mathcal{L}^L \subseteq (\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^L$. In these products, as usual, the exponent L serves merely as an index set, whereas the base, a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$, carries the topology of pointwise convergence on the features; the product $\mathcal{L}^L$ is closed in $(\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})^L$, since $\mathcal{L}$ is closed in $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$. Since an actual computation keeps the magnitudes of the quantities involved within bounds, the shards of Section 2.1.1 enter the definition through the notion of confinement.

Definition 2.4. A *compositional computation structure* (CCS) is a triple $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$, where

- the pair $(L, \mathcal{P})$ is a computation states structure, and
- the set $\Gamma \subseteq L^L$ is a semigroup under composition that contains the identity map id of L.

The elements of Γ are called the *computations* of $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$. The elements ξ of the closure $\overline{\Gamma}$ of Γ in $\mathcal{L}^L$ are called (real-valued) *deep computations*, and the elements of the closure $\overline{\Delta}$ in $\mathcal{L}^L$ of a set $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ are called the deep computations of Δ.[5]

A collection $\mathscr{R}$ of sizers is *exhaustive* if $L = \bigcup_{r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}} L[r_\bullet]$. A computation $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is *$\mathscr{R}$-confined* if γ maps $L[r_\bullet]$ into itself for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, and a subset $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ is *$\mathscr{R}$-confined* if each $\gamma \in \Delta$ is.

The set Γ of computations is thus a monoid of transformations of L. We regard the computations in Γ as finitary computations, and the deep computations as possibly infinitary limits of finitary computations. Unlike L^L, which is a semigroup under composition, the space $\mathcal{L}^L$ has no natural semigroup structure; deep computations are therefore not composable in general.

Proposition 2.5. *If $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ is confined by an exhaustive collection of sizers, then its closure $\overline{\Delta}$ is a compact subset of $\mathcal{L}^L_{\mathrm{sh}}$.*

Proof. Let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers that confines Δ, and choose, for each $v \in L$, a sizer $r_\bullet^{(v)} \in \mathscr{R}$ with $v \in L[r_\bullet^{(v)}]$. Since every $\gamma \in \Delta$ maps v into $L[r_\bullet^{(v)}]$, the set Δ lies in the space $\prod_{v \in L} \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet^{(v)}] \subseteq \mathcal{L}^L_{\mathrm{sh}}$, which is compact by Tychonov's theorem, hence closed in $\mathcal{L}^L$, and therefore contains $\overline{\Delta}$. □

Remarks 2.6. (For readers versed in model theory.)[6]

[5] In the first paper of this series [ADIW26], the deep computations of Δ are the accumulation points of Δ that satisfy a confinement condition. Counting the members of Δ among them affects none of the properties studied in this paper. Indeed, under the Extendibility Axiom of Section 2.3, the members of Δ are continuous on the type shards, and those that are not accumulation points of Δ are isolated points of $\overline{\Delta}$.

[6] The real-valued structures used here are those of Keisler's model theory for real-valued structures [Kei23]; see also [DnI17, Section 6] for an introduction.

(1) Compositional computation structures, as defined above, are not literally real-valued structures, since their computations are maps on L rather than elements of a sort of the structure. However, as in their original definition [ADIW26], they may be regarded as real-valued structures $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma, \circ, \mathrm{ev})$, where
   - the pair $(L, \mathcal{P})$ is a computation states structure,
   - the pair $(\Gamma, \circ)$ is a semigroup,
   - the map $\mathrm{ev} : \Gamma \times L \to L : (\gamma, v) \mapsto \mathrm{ev}(\gamma, v)$ is a semigroup action of Γ on L (i.e., $\mathrm{ev}(\gamma \circ \delta, v) = \mathrm{ev}(\gamma, \mathrm{ev}(\delta, v))$ for $\gamma, \delta \in \Gamma$ and $v \in L$).

   The two definitions are reconciled by identifying each $\gamma \in \Gamma$ with the map $v \mapsto \mathrm{ev}(\gamma, v)$. Nothing in a structure of the second kind forces this identification to be injective, that is, to realize Γ as a subset of the product space L^L.

(2) Regarded as real-valued structures in this sense, the compositional computation structures with a fixed collection $\mathcal{P}$ of predicate symbols form an elementary class. The notion of state type introduced above is essentially that of a quantifier-free type with parameters of sort L only. This notion may be enriched by further formulas, for instance with parameters in Γ or with quantifiers, and extended to types of sort Γ ("transform-types"). As usual, all types over a structure $\underline{C} = (L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma, \circ, \mathrm{ev})$ are realized in some ultrapower $\underline{C}^{(\mathcal{U})}$ of $\underline{C}$, constructed as in the references above.[7] In Banach space theory, this approach to spaces of types goes back to Krivine's real-valued languages [Kri72, Kri74] and to the work of Krivine and Maurey on stable Banach spaces [KM81].

2.3. **Computability of deep computations and the Extendibility Axiom.** The rest of the paper depends on two notions recalled in this subsection, the computability of transforms and the Extendibility Axiom. A machine evaluates only sums and products of finitely many observed features, and only to within a preset error on a preset range of magnitudes; computability is accordingly defined by uniform approximation on shards by polynomials in the features. The Extendibility Axiom, in turn, requires every computation to have an extension that is continuous on each type shard. Let $(L, \mathcal{P})$ be a computation states structure. A map $f\colon L \to \mathcal{L}$ from the state space to the space of types is called a *transform*. In the two definitions that follow, and in the characterization of computability after them, the collection $\mathcal{P}$ of predicates is assumed to be *countable*.

(1) A *computable predicate* is a function from L to $\mathbb{R}$ whose restriction to each shard is a uniform limit of polynomials, with real coefficients, in the features $P(\cdot)$.
(2) A transform $f\colon L \to \mathcal{L}$ is *computable* if, for each $Q \in \mathcal{P}$, the output feature $Q \circ f\colon L \to \mathbb{R}$ is a computable predicate.

Alva, Dueñez, Iovino and Walton [ADIW26] showed that a transform $f\colon L \to \mathcal{L}$ is computable if and only if f extends to a continuous map $\tilde{f}\colon \mathcal{L} \to \mathcal{L}$. This characterization motivates the following definition, in which continuity is required on each type shard.

[7] By contrast, no ultrapower is needed to realize state types in a computation states structure (see Remark 2.2).

Let $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ be a compositional computation structure. A computation $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is *extendable* if γ has an extension $\tilde{\gamma}\colon \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}} \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ such that, for every sizer $r_\bullet$, there is a sizer $s_\bullet$ for which the restriction $\tilde{\gamma}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}\colon \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \to \mathcal{L}[s_\bullet]$ is continuous. Such an extension is unique, since any two such extensions are continuous on each type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ and agree on the dense subset $L[r_\bullet]$ of $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$. For a set $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ of extendable computations, we write $\tilde{\Delta}$ for the set $\{\tilde{\gamma}\colon \gamma \in \Delta\}$.

Extendibility Axiom. *Every computation $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is extendable.*

The Extendibility Axiom is discussed at length in the first paper of this series [ADIW26]. *From now on, all compositional computation structures are assumed to satisfy the Extendibility Axiom.*

The following lemma, used in Theorems 3.1 and 6.7, extends deep computations to the type shards.

Lemma 2.7. *Let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers and let $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be $\mathscr{R}$-confined. Every deep computation $f \in \overline{\Delta}$ has an extension $\tilde{f} : \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}} \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ that, for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, maps $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ into itself and satisfies $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]} \in \overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$.*

Proof. Write $f = \lim_{i,\mathcal{U}} \gamma_i$, where $(\gamma_i)_{i\in I}$ is a family in Δ and $\mathcal{U}$ is an ultrafilter on the index set I, and let $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$ be given. Each $\tilde{\gamma}_i$ maps $L[r_\bullet]$ into itself and is continuous on $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$; hence $\tilde{\gamma}_i$ maps the closure $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ of $L[r_\bullet]$ into itself. Since $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ is compact, the limit $\tilde{f}(v) \coloneqq \lim_{i,\mathcal{U}} \tilde{\gamma}_i(v)$ exists and lies in $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ for every $v \in \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$; in other words, the restriction $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ equals $\lim_{i,\mathcal{U}} \tilde{\gamma}_i|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$. Since $\mathscr{R}$ is exhaustive, this defines $\tilde{f}$ on a set that contains L, and there $\tilde{f}$ agrees with f; at the remaining points of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ we let $\tilde{f}$ be the identity. □

Lemma 2.7 connects deep computations with the second notion of limit introduced in the first paper of this series [ADIW26]. In that paper, this second notion is formulated in the space of maps from the space of types to itself, endowed with the topology of pointwise convergence. An *ultracomputation* of a set $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ of extendable computations is an accumulation point of $\tilde{\Delta}$ in that space, subject to a confinement condition. Thus a deep computation sends states to types, whereas an ultracomputation sends types to types. Every deep computation is the restriction to L of an ultracomputation [ADIW26]. On the type shards $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ with $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the ultralimit $\lim_{i,\mathcal{U}} \tilde{\gamma}_i$ in the proof of Lemma 2.7 provides such an extension of the deep computation $f = \lim_{i,\mathcal{U}} \gamma_i$ considered there. The classification of Section 3 is based on the sets $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$, whose members are the restrictions to $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ of such ultralimits of extended computations. Strictly speaking, the classification therefore concerns the restrictions of ultracomputations to type shards. For the dynamical compositional computation structures of Section 5.1, in which every type is realized and every computation is its own extension, deep computations and ultracomputations coincide.

2.4. **Stability.** The highest level of the hierarchy studied in this paper is occupied by the stable sets of computations, whose deep computations, extended to the type shards, are continuous. We recall these sets here, before descending to the levels below in Section 3.

Definition 2.8. A set $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ of computations is *stable* if, for every sizer $r_\bullet$, every member of $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ is continuous.

By the theorem of Alva, Dueñez, Iovino and Walton recalled in Section 2.3, continuity on the type shards is the form that computability takes when $\mathcal{P}$ is countable; for countable $\mathcal{P}$, the deep computations of a stable set are accordingly computable. Stable sets of computations, the subject of the first paper of this series [ADIW26], are characterized there by Grothendieck's double limit condition and identified with stability in the sense of model theory.

2.5. **Two motivating examples.** Before developing the classification, we describe two algorithms whose deep computations differ sharply in character, for the contrast between them indicates what the classification must distinguish. Both algorithms are treated in detail in Section 4.

Square roots. Newton's method for $p(x) = x^2 - a$, with $a > 0$, acts on the real projective line $\mathbb{RP}^1 = \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\}$ by the map $N_p(x) = (x^2 + a)/(2x)$, with $N_p(0) = N_p(\infty) = \infty$. The iterates of N_p are continuous and converge pointwise to a map $\mathfrak{f}$. This map sends every positive number to $\sqrt{a}$, every negative number to $-\sqrt{a}$, and both 0 and ∞ to ∞ (see Figure 2). The deep computations of the set of iterates are the iterates themselves together with $\mathfrak{f}$. Being discontinuous, the map $\mathfrak{f}$ is not computable, and the set of iterates is not stable. Nevertheless, the map $\mathfrak{f}$ is the limit of a *sequence* of computations, and the space of deep computations is countable.

Newton's method on the Riemann sphere. For $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$, Newton's method on the Riemann sphere $\hat{\mathbb{C}} = \mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$ displays three distinct modes of behavior, each confined to its own part of the sphere (see Figure 3 in Section 4.1). The iterates converge on the basins of the three roots. On the basin of the cycle $0 \mapsto 1 \mapsto 0$, by contrast, the iterates do not converge, although the even iterates and the odd iterates converge there separately to different limits. Finally, on the common boundary of these basins, a fractal set, the iterates are chaotic. For the simpler polynomial $z^2 - 1$, chaos of this kind produces deep computations that are not even limits of sequences of computations (see Proposition 5.15 and Theorem 3.1).

The classification of Section 3 is designed to separate such behaviors. In Theorem 3.1 below we characterize, for countably many features, the sets of computations whose deep computations, extended to the type shards of an exhaustive collection of sizers that confines them, are of the first Baire class there. For these sets every deep computation is, on each such shard, the limit of a sequence of computations, as in the case of square roots. Todorčević's trichotomy, which we recall in Section 3.2, then measures the complexity of the space of such deep computations.

3. Classifying deep computations

The first main theorem of the paper, proved in this section with the tools of the topology of function spaces, characterizes the sets of computations whose deep computations are of the first Baire class on the type shards. The classification built on this theorem stratifies such sets into a new hierarchy of complexity classes. The examples of Section 2.5 show why such a classification is needed: some natural algorithms have discontinuous deep computations that are nevertheless limits of sequences of computations, whereas others have deep computations that are not even limits of sequences. The topological tools are the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem (see Theorem 1.4), which identifies the tame regime, and Todorčević's trichotomy for Rosenthal compacta [Tod99], which distinguishes levels within that

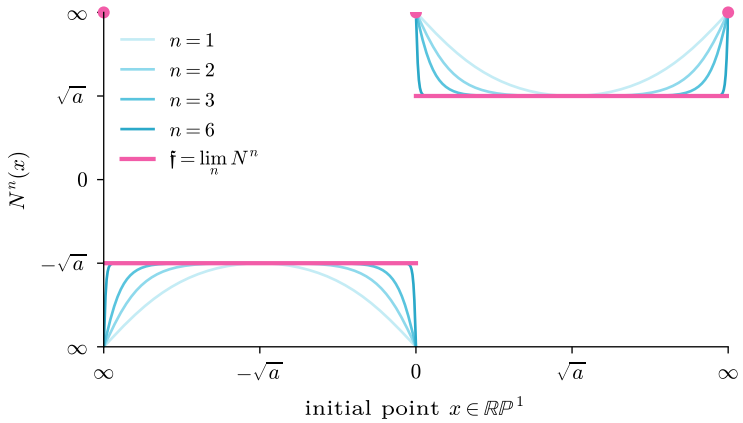


FIGURE 2. Newton iterates N_p^n for $p(x) = x^2 - a$, with $a > 0$, on the real projective line (each axis runs from ∞ through 0 back to ∞), converging pointwise to the deep computation $\mathfrak{f}$.

regime. Our model is the work of Glasner and Megrelishvili on tame semigroups in topological dynamics [GM22].

3.1. **NIP, Rosenthal compacta, and deep computations.** The classification rests on Theorem 3.1, which we prove in this subsection. The theorem characterizes, by a finitary condition and for countably many features, the sets of computations whose deep computations, extended to the type shards of an exhaustive collection of sizers that confines them, are of the first Baire class there. In the first paper of this series [ADIW26], the sets of computations whose deep computations are continuous were characterized analogously, by Grothendieck's double limit condition.

Theorem 3.1. *Let $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ be a compositional computation structure satisfying the Extendibility Axiom, with $\mathcal{P}$ countable. Let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers, and suppose that $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ is $\mathscr{R}$-confined. Then the following conditions are equivalent:*

(i) the inclusion $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}} \subseteq \mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet], \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$ holds for all $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$;
(ii) for all $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the set $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$ satisfies the NIP.

Furthermore, if these conditions hold, then every deep computation $f \in \overline{\Delta}$ has an extension $\tilde{f}\colon \mathcal{L}_{sh} \to \mathcal{L}_{sh}$ such that $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]} \in \mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet], \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$ for all $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, and, for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the restriction $f|_{L[r_\bullet]}$ is the pointwise limit of a sequence $(\gamma_n|_{L[r_\bullet]})_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ with $\gamma_n \in \Delta$.

In condition (ii), $\pi_P\colon \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}} \to \mathbb{R}$ is the projection onto the coordinate P, as in Theorem 1.9. Explicitly, condition (ii) requires that, for all $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, all reals $a < b$ and all sequences $(\gamma_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in Δ, there be finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$L[r_\bullet] \cap \bigcap_{n\in I} (\pi_P \circ \gamma_n)^{-1}(-\infty, a] \cap \bigcap_{n\in J} (\pi_P \circ \gamma_n)^{-1}[b, \infty) = \emptyset.$$

Proof. Since $\mathcal{P}$ is countable, each type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ is a compact metrizable, hence Polish, subspace of $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$. Let $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$ be given; by the Extendibility Axiom and

confinement, every $\tilde{\gamma}$ with $\gamma \in \Delta$ maps $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ continuously into itself (see the proof of Lemma 2.7). Hence, for every $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ consists of continuous functions and is pointwise bounded. By Theorem 1.9 and Lemma 1.10, condition (ii) holds at $r_\bullet$ if and only if $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}} \subseteq \mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet], \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}})$, which (i) implies. Conversely, suppose that this inclusion holds. Recall that a topological space is *Fréchet–Urysohn* if every point in the closure of a subset is the limit of a sequence of points of that subset. For a Polish space X, every compact subset of $\mathrm{B}_1(X)$ is Fréchet–Urysohn (see [BFT78, Theorem 3F] or [Deb13, Theorem 4.1]). By Proposition 1.8, the closure $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ may be regarded as a compact subset of $\mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \times \mathcal{P})$, where the space $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \times \mathcal{P}$ is Polish because $\mathcal{P}$ is countable and discrete. Every member of this closure is therefore the pointwise limit of a sequence of maps $\tilde{\gamma}_n|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ with $\gamma_n \in \Delta$, which are continuous maps from $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ to itself; hence (i) holds at $r_\bullet$. Finally, if (i) holds, then the extension $\tilde{f}$ of Lemma 2.7 satisfies $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]} \in \overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}} \subseteq \mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet], \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$ for all $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$. For each $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the argument just given provides a sequence $(\gamma_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in Δ such that the maps $\tilde{\gamma}_n|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ converge pointwise to $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$; restricting to $L[r_\bullet]$, where $\tilde{f}$ agrees with f and each $\tilde{\gamma}_n$ agrees with γ_n, we obtain the last assertion. □

3.2. **Todorčević's trichotomy and levels of NIP.** Todorčević's trichotomy now enables us to stratify the NIP sets of computations into three levels. The trichotomy concerns separable Rosenthal compacta. Under the hypotheses of Theorem 3.1, suppose that the set Δ is countable and satisfies condition (ii) of the theorem. For each $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the set $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$, whose members are the restrictions to $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ of ultralimits of extended computations of Δ, is then a Rosenthal compactum, separable because Δ is countable. We measure the complexity of such a compactum by three topological properties: metrizability, hereditary separability and first countability. The three properties form a chain: every compact metrizable space is hereditarily separable, and R. Pol proved that every hereditarily separable Rosenthal compactum is first countable (see [Deb13, Section 10]). These properties define three levels of NIP.

Definition 3.2. Let $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ be a CCS satisfying the Extendibility Axiom, with $\mathcal{P}$ countable, and let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers. Let $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be an $\mathscr{R}$-confined countable set of computations that satisfies condition (ii) of Theorem 3.1. We say that:

(i) the set Δ is NIP_1 if $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ is first countable for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$;
(ii) the set Δ is NIP_2 if $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ is hereditarily separable for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$;
(iii) the set Δ is NIP_3 if $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ is metrizable for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$.

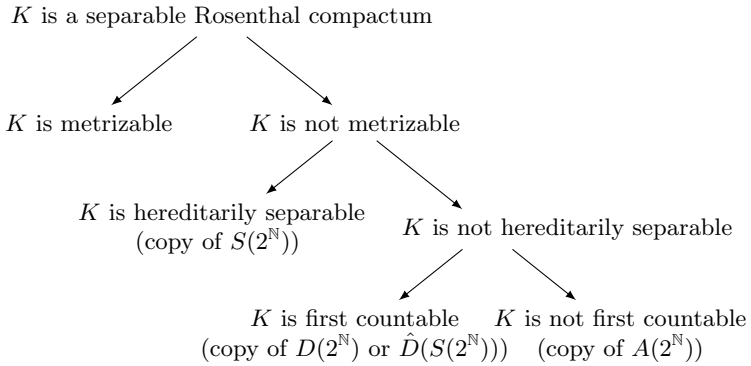
By the chain of properties above, the levels satisfy $\mathrm{NIP}_3 \Rightarrow \mathrm{NIP}_2 \Rightarrow \mathrm{NIP}_1 \Rightarrow$ NIP. Moreover, a countable stable set of computations (see Definition 2.8) that is confined by an exhaustive collection $\mathscr{R}$ of sizers has the NIP by Theorem 3.1, and is NIP_3. Indeed, on each type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ with $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the extended deep computations of such a set form a separable compact subset of a countable product of spaces $\mathrm{C_p}(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$, that is, a separable Eberlein compactum. Separable Eberlein compacta, in turn, are metrizable [Ark92]. The five compacta of Section 1.4 show that none of the implications between the three topological properties can be reversed for separable Rosenthal compacta. Specifically, the extended Alexandroff compactification $\hat{A}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ is separable but not first countable. The extended duplicate $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ of the split Cantor set and the compactum $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ that contains the Alexandroff duplicate

are separable and first countable but not hereditarily separable. Finally, the split Cantor set $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ is hereditarily separable but not metrizable. Todorčević proved that these examples are canonical [Tod99], in the following sense.

Theorem 3.3 (Todorčević's trichotomy [Tod99]; see also [ADK08, Theorem 3])**.** *Let K be a separable Rosenthal compactum.*

(i) If K is hereditarily separable but non-metrizable, then the split Cantor set $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ embeds into K.
(ii) If K is first countable but not hereditarily separable, then either the Alexandroff duplicate $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ or the extended duplicate $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ of the split Cantor set embeds into K.
(iii) If K is not first countable, then the Alexandroff compactification $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ embeds into K.

Together with the chain of properties above, the trichotomy yields the following classification of separable Rosenthal compacta:



The three levels admit a second description, in terms of the tests required to distinguish deep computations from one another. Let Δ and $\mathscr{R}$ be as in Definition 3.2, fix $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, and write $K_{r_\bullet} = \overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$. We identify each $f \in K_{r_\bullet}$ with the real-valued function $(x, P) \mapsto P(f(x))$ on $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \times \mathcal{P}$, whose points we call *tests*: the test (x, P) applies the feature P to the output on the input x. The topology of pointwise convergence on $K_{r_\bullet}$ is then the topology of pointwise convergence on tests. A set $\mathcal{T}$ of tests *separates* a set of deep computations if any two distinct members of the set differ on some test in $\mathcal{T}$. A member f of $K_{r_\bullet}$ is *countably determined* if there is a countable set $\mathcal{T}_f$ of tests such that every other member of $K_{r_\bullet}$ differs from f on some test in $\mathcal{T}_f$. A set $E \subseteq K_{r_\bullet}$ is *finitely separated* if each $f \in E$ admits finitely many tests and some $\varepsilon_f > 0$ such that every $g \in E \setminus \{f\}$ differs from f by at least ε_f on one of these tests.

Proposition 3.4. *Let Δ and $\mathscr{R}$ be as in Definition 3.2, let $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$ be given, and let $K_{r_\bullet} = \overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$.*

(i) The compactum $K_{r_\bullet}$ is metrizable if and only if one countable set of tests separates $K_{r_\bullet}$.
(ii) The compactum $K_{r_\bullet}$ is first countable if and only if every member of $K_{r_\bullet}$ is countably determined.
(iii) The compactum $K_{r_\bullet}$ is hereditarily separable if and only if no finitely separated subset of $K_{r_\bullet}$ has cardinality $2^{\aleph_0}$.

Proof. (i) If a countable set $\mathcal{T}$ of tests separates $K_{r_\bullet}$, then restriction to $\mathcal{T}$ is a continuous injection of the compact space $K_{r_\bullet}$ into the metrizable space $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{T}}$. This injection is therefore a homeomorphism onto its image. Conversely, if $K_{r_\bullet}$ is metrizable, then the square $K_{r_\bullet} \times K_{r_\bullet}$ is second countable, and hence its open subset $\{(f,g) : f \neq g\}$ is Lindelöf. This open set is covered by the open sets $\{(f,g) : f(t) \neq g(t)\}$ for tests t, and a countable subcover gives the required set $\mathcal{T}$. (ii) If f is countably determined, the singleton $\{f\}$ is a countable intersection of open sets, and in a compact Hausdorff space such a point has a countable base of neighborhoods. Conversely, let $(U_k)_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$ be a countable base of neighborhoods of f, and choose in each U_k a basic neighborhood of f defined by a finite set F_k of tests. The union $\mathcal{T}_f = \bigcup_k F_k$ then separates f from every other member of $K_{r_\bullet}$. (iii) A set is finitely separated exactly when it is a discrete subspace, and, by Theorem 3.1, the compactum $K_{r_\bullet}$ is a separable Rosenthal compactum. A hereditarily separable space has no uncountable discrete subspace, since a separable discrete space is countable. Conversely, suppose that $K_{r_\bullet}$ is not hereditarily separable; then Theorem 3.3 provides a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ or of $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ inside $K_{r_\bullet}$. Each of these three compacta contains a discrete subspace of cardinality $2^{\aleph_0}$ (see Section 1.4). The same equivalence for separable Rosenthal compacta is stated in [GM22, Theorem 0.4]; see also [ADK08]. □

In the language of tests, the set Δ is NIP_3 when, on each type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ with $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, a single countable set of tests separates all the deep computations of Δ. The level NIP_2 requires that no such type shard carry a finitely separated set of deep computations of the cardinality of the continuum. The weakest of the three levels, NIP_1, requires only that, on each such type shard, each deep computation be separated from all the others by a countable set of tests chosen for that deep computation.

In Section 5 we exhibit computations at each level of the hierarchy and show that every implication between the classes stable, NIP_3, NIP_2, NIP_1 and NIP is strict. The definitions of NIP_1, NIP_2 and NIP_3 are topological, and the descriptions of Proposition 3.4 still involve infinitely many tests. The existence of a finitary, combinatorial characterization of the three levels, like that of NIP in Theorem 3.1, is the subject of Question 7.1.

3.3. **Canonical families and binary search.** Todorčević's trichotomy organizes the hierarchy of the preceding subsection. For a finer interpretation of the canonical compacta of the trichotomy, we turn to the seven tree-indexed families studied by Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos [ADK08]. The prefix and threshold functions from which these families are built admit a direct reading as primitives of binary search, and the closures of the families illustrate distinct patterns of limiting behavior. Recall from Section 1.4 that a dyadic subtree of the binary tree $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, a subset isomorphic to $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ under the order of extension, is written $\{w_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$, indexed through the canonical isomorphism, which preserves extension and the lexicographic order.

Definition 3.5. Let X and Y be Polish spaces.

(1) If I is countable and $\{f_i : i \in I\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$, $\{g_i : i \in I\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^Y$ are two families indexed by I, we say that they are *equivalent* if the map $f_i \mapsto g_i$ extends to a homeomorphism from $\overline{\{f_i : i \in I\}}$ to $\overline{\{g_i : i \in I\}}$.

(2) If $\{f_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ is a pointwise bounded family, we say that it is *minimal* if, for every dyadic subtree $\{w_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ of $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, the family $\{f_{w_t} : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is equivalent to $\{f_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$.

The seven canonical minimal families in the classification of Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos [ADK08] are described below. We retain their notation and the tree indexing, which distinguishes families even when their closures are homeomorphic. The description is carried out along the regular dyadic subtree $\{s_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ fixed in Section 1.4 for the definition of the extended duplicate of the split Cantor set. This subtree satisfies $s_t^\frown 0^\infty \neq s_{t'}^\frown 0^\infty$ and $s_t^\frown 1^\infty \neq s_{t'}^\frown 1^\infty$ whenever $t \neq t'$. The families are built from the prefix tests v_t and the threshold tests $\chi_{[a}$, $\chi_{(a}$ of Section 1.4. Two further conventions are taken from the paper of Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos [ADK08]. First, a point $\sigma \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$, identified with a point of the Cantor set in $[0,1]$, is regarded as the constant function on $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ with value σ. Second, a pair (f,g) of functions on $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ is regarded as a single function on the disjoint union $2^{\mathbb{N}} \sqcup 2^{\mathbb{N}}$.

(1) The family $D_1 = \{\frac{1}{|t|+1} v_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ has closure $D_1 \cup \{\mathbf{0}\}$, the one-point compactification of a countable discrete set.
(2) The family $D_2 = \{s_t^\frown 0^\infty : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_2}$, which Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos denote by $2^{\leq\mathbb{N}}$. The closure $\overline{D_2}$ is compact and metrizable, and the accumulation points of D_2 form a copy of $2^{\mathbb{N}}$.
(3) The family $D_3 = \{\chi_{[s_t^\frown 0^\infty} : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_3}$, a closed subspace of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.
(4) The family $D_4 = \{\chi_{(s_t^\frown 1^\infty} : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_4}$, a closed subspace of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.
(5) The family $D_5 = \{v_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_5} = \hat{A}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.
(6) The family $D_6 = \{(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty) : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_6} = \hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.
(7) The family $D_7 = \{(v_{s_t}, \chi_{[s_t^\frown 0^\infty}) : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is a discrete subspace of the closure $\overline{D_7} = \hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$.

Proposition 3.6 (Canonical minimal families [ADK08, Section 4.3])**.** *The families $D_1, \ldots, D_7$ are relatively compact in the first Baire class on their respective Polish domains, minimal, and pairwise nonequivalent.*

The building blocks of the families $D_1, \ldots, D_7$ admit a computational interpretation as primitives of binary search on $2^{\mathbb{N}}$, the space of binary expansions. A node $t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ determines the dyadic interval $[t^\frown 0^\infty, t^\frown 1^\infty]$, the set of inputs that round to t at precision $|t|$. The prefix test v_t asks whether the input rounds to t, and the point $t^\frown 0^\infty$ is the rounded value itself. The comparison $\chi_{[t^\frown 0^\infty}$ asks whether the input lies at or to the right of the left endpoint of the interval. Likewise, the comparison $\chi_{(t^\frown 1^\infty}$ asks whether the input lies strictly to the right of the right endpoint. The resulting reading of the seven families is recorded in Table 1.

To bring these families to bear on a concrete computation, one first fixes the bounds on magnitudes within which the computation operates, that is, a sizer $r_\bullet$. Let $\{\gamma_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ be a family of computations in a CCS satisfying the Extendibility Axiom and having countably many features, and suppose that the family preserves

Family	Function at node t	Limits
D_1	prefix test weighted by $1/(\lvert t\rvert + 1)$	the test that never succeeds: confidence vanishes with depth
D_2	return the rounded value $t^\frown 0^\infty$	the exact input: successive approximation
D_3	compare with the left endpoint	comparison with a limit of left endpoints, with ties broken upward and, at limits approached from above, also downward
D_4	compare with the right endpoint	comparison with a limit of right endpoints, with ties broken downward and, at limits approached from below, also upward
D_5	prefix test	exact equality, or no match
D_6	prefix test and rounded value	a dictionary lookup that returns its key
D_7	prefix test and comparison	a three-way comparison: below, inside or above

TABLE 1. The minimal families of Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos as primitives of binary search.

the shard $L[r_\bullet]$ and has NIP there for every feature. For a chosen feature P, the argument of Theorem 3.1 shows that the family $\{P\circ\tilde{\gamma}_t|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]} : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ of real-valued functions on the type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ is relatively compact in $\mathrm{B}_1(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$. Restriction to a shard and observation through a single feature may merge distinct computations into one function; a constant feature, for example, turns every family into a constant family. Accordingly, the seven families serve here as canonical patterns of observable limit behavior, and the occurrence of one of them in a particular computation must be established separately.

4. Examples of Compositional Computation Structures

The classification of Section 3 was designed to separate the behaviors of concrete algorithms, and in this section we study three of them as compositional computation structures, including the two announced in Section 2.5. The three are Newton's method on the Riemann sphere for two cubic polynomials (Sections 4.1 and 4.2) and Newton's method for square roots on the real projective line (Section 4.3). For each of them we describe the behavior of the iterates of the Newton map and, where the dynamics permits, the deep computations themselves. On the Julia sets of the two cubic examples the iterates are chaotic, and in Section 5.6 we show that this chaos places both examples beyond NIP. In Section 5 we place the square-root example, together with other classical algorithms, at the levels of the hierarchy of Section 3.

Applied to a rational function, the Newton–Raphson root-finding method of numerical analysis (see [Gal00] and [BFB16, Section 2.3]) acts on the extended complex plane, and we first fix the predicates through which the states of the method are observed. Let $\hat{\mathbb{C}} = \mathbb{C} \cup \{\infty\}$ be the extended complex plane, that is, the Alexandroff (one-point) compactification of $\mathbb{C}$. We identify $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$ with the unit sphere $S^2 \subseteq \mathbb{R}^3$, the Riemann sphere, through the inverse stereographic projection.

This projection is the homeomorphism $\hat{\mathbb{C}} \to S^2$ given by $z \mapsto (P_1(z), P_2(z), P_3(z))$, where $(P_1(\infty), P_2(\infty), P_3(\infty)) = (0, 0, 1)$ and, for $z \neq \infty$,

$$P_1(z) = \frac{2\,\Re z}{|z|^2+1}, \qquad P_2(z) = \frac{2\,\Im z}{|z|^2+1}, \qquad P_3(z) = \frac{|z|^2-1}{|z|^2+1}.$$

The extended complex plane $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$ thus carries the real predicates P_1, P_2, P_3 with values in $[-1, 1]$, and under the same identification the topology of $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$ is metrized by the pullback of the Euclidean metric of S^2.

Newton CCSs: steps and fractals. Here we describe the compositional computation structure generated by the Newton map, the single step that Newton's method iterates to approximate a root of a function. The structure so obtained is the common setting of the three examples that follow. We then recall the Fatou and Julia sets, on which the iterates of the Newton map behave regularly and chaotically, respectively. Let $p = p(z)$ be a nonconstant rational function with complex coefficients, regarded as a nonconstant meromorphic map $\hat{\mathbb{C}} \to \hat{\mathbb{C}}$. The *Newton step*, or *Newton map*, of p is the rational map

$$N_p : z \mapsto z - \frac{p(z)}{p'(z)}. \tag{4.1}$$

Let $\Gamma_p \coloneqq \{N_p^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ be the semigroup of iterates, or compositional powers, of the Newton map (4.1). The natural predicates on the state space $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$ are the coordinates P_1, P_2, P_3 of the inverse stereographic projection, since the real and imaginary parts $z \mapsto \Re z$ and $z \mapsto \Im z$ are not defined at $z = \infty$. The CCS $(\hat{\mathbb{C}}, (P_1, P_2, P_3), \Gamma_p)$ is called *Newton's method for* $p(z)$, or the *Newton CCS for* $p(z)$. Since the predicates embed the compact state space $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$ into $\mathbb{R}^3$, every type is realized, and since the Newton map N_p is continuous on $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$, every Newton CCS satisfies the Extendibility Axiom. Newton's method succeeds at an initial estimate $z_0 \in \hat{\mathbb{C}}$ when the sequence $(z_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ of Newton steps, where $z_n \coloneqq N_p^n(z_0)$, converges to a root of p.
Fatou and Julia sets. Recall that the *Fatou set* $\mathcal{F}_g$ of a rational map $g\colon \hat{\mathbb{C}} \to \hat{\mathbb{C}}$ is the set of points near which the iterates of g behave regularly. More precisely, a point belongs to $\mathcal{F}_g$ if it has a neighborhood on which every sequence of iterates of g has a subsequence that converges uniformly with respect to the spherical metric. The complement $\mathcal{J}_g \coloneqq \hat{\mathbb{C}} \setminus \mathcal{F}_g$ of the Fatou set is the *Julia set* of g, a closed set that is typically a fractal. The Julia set of the Newton map N_p is called the *Newton fractal* of p.

4.1. **Example: The Newton CCS for the cubic** $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$**.** Our first example is the second motivating example of Section 2.5, a cubic polynomial whose Newton map has, besides the three roots, an attracting cycle. Newton's method therefore fails on an open set of initial estimates, on which the iterates of the Newton map do not converge, and two distinct limits of these iterates along ultrafilters appear among the deep computations of the method. The polynomial $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$ has Newton map

$$N_q : z \mapsto z - \frac{z^3-2z+2}{3z^2-2} = \frac{2z^3-2}{3z^2-2}.$$

Denote the real root of q by r_0, and the roots in the upper and the lower half plane by r_+ and r_-. Starting from $z_0 = 0$, the Newton steps alternate $0, 1, 0, 1, \ldots$, and neither 0 nor 1 is a root of q.

Let B_0, B_+, B_- be the basins of the roots r_0, r_+, r_-, and let B_{01} be the basin of the superattracting cycle $\{0, 1\}$. The critical points of N_q are the three roots of q and the point 0, which lies on the cycle. The argument given in Section 4.2 for the polynomial u therefore shows that the Fatou set of N_q is $B_{01} \cup B_0 \cup B_+ \cup B_-$, and each of these four sets is nonempty and open. Since B_{01} is nonempty, the iterates N_q^n do not converge pointwise. Fix nonprincipal ultrafilters $\mathcal{U}_0$ and $\mathcal{U}_1$ on $\mathbb{N}$ that contain the even and the odd numbers, respectively. The limits of the iterates N_q^n along $\mathcal{U}_0$ and along $\mathcal{U}_1$ are deep computations, which we denote by f_0 and f_1, respectively. On the Fatou set the even and the odd iterates converge pointwise, whence the two limits, on that set, do not depend on the choice of the ultrafilters. Both limits send each basin of a root to that root; on B_{01}, by contrast, they take only the values 0 and 1 and exchange them. The exchange of the two values follows from the identity $f_1 = N_q \circ f_0$, which holds on the Fatou set by the continuity of N_q. In particular, the two deep computations are distinct.[8] Figure 3 depicts f_0 and f_1, together with the Newton fractal of q, on which the iterates behave chaotically.

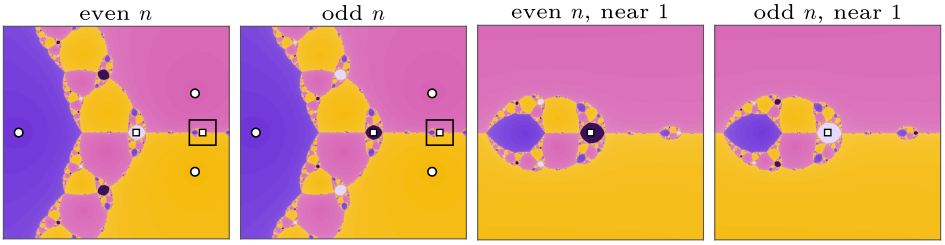


FIGURE 3. The deep computations f_0 and f_1 of Newton's method for $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$, the limits of the iterates along $\mathcal{U}_0$ and along $\mathcal{U}_1$, on the whole plane and near the point 1, with the basins of the real root and of the roots in the upper and lower half planes (white circles) in purple, orchid and gold, and the basin of the superattracting cycle $0 \mapsto 1 \mapsto 0$ (white squares) in lilac or plum according as the iterate is near 0 or near 1.

4.2. **Example: The Newton CCS for the cubic $u(z) = z^3 - 1$.** For contrast, we turn to $u(z) = z^3 - 1$, whose roots are the cube roots of unity $r_0 = 1$ and $r_\pm = \exp(\pm 2\pi i/3)$. The Newton map of u is

$$N_u : z \mapsto z - \frac{z^3 - 1}{3z^2} = \frac{2z^3 + 1}{3z^2}.$$

The critical points of this rational map of degree three are the three roots of u, which are superattracting fixed points, and the point 0. The map N_u sends the

[8]The point ∞ is a repelling fixed point of N_q: if $|z|$ is large, then $N_q(z) = \frac{2}{3}z + O(1)$. Hence the point ∞ lies on the Newton fractal of q, and the two deep computations satisfy $f_0(\infty) = \infty = f_1(\infty)$.

point 0 to ∞, a repelling fixed point of multiplier $3/2$. The immediate basin of every attracting or parabolic cycle contains a critical point whose orbit converges to that cycle [Mil06, Sections 8 and 10]. Since the critical orbits of N_u end at the three roots and at ∞, the map N_u, unlike N_q, has no attracting cycle other than the three roots of u and no parabolic cycle. The boundary of a Siegel disk or of a Herman ring, moreover, is infinite and lies in the closure of the critical orbits [Mil06, Sections 11 and 15]. Since every critical orbit of N_u is finite, the map N_u has no such domain. Sullivan's theorem excludes wandering domains, and the classification of periodic Fatou components then shows that the Fatou set of N_u is the union of the basins of the three roots [Mil06, Section 16 and Appendix F]. On each of these basins, the iterates of N_u converge to the corresponding root. Figure 4 depicts Newton's method for u. To render the iterates themselves, and not merely their limits, we color each point z_0 by blending the colors of the three roots with relative weights $|z_n - r|^{-3}$ for $r \in \{r_0, r_+, r_-\}$, where $z_n := N_u^n(z_0)$. For each n this coloring is a continuous function of z_0, and for small n the picture is blurred. As n increases, the coloring sharpens into large regions of nearly constant color, separated by narrow regions in which the color varies so rapidly that the coloring is nearly discontinuous.

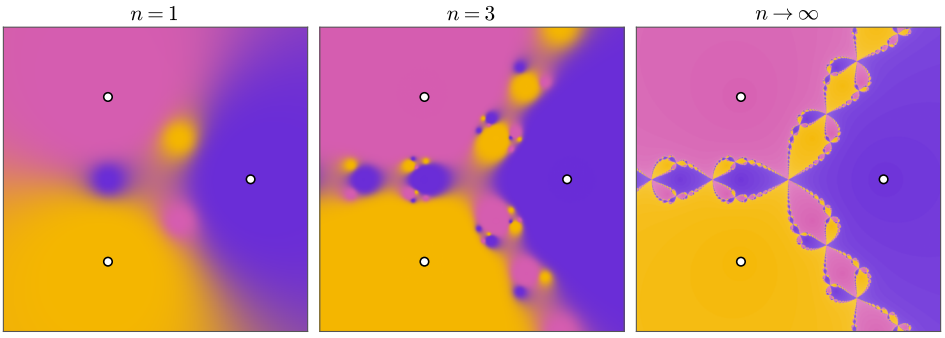


FIGURE 4. Newton's method for $u(z) = z^3 - 1$ after one and three iterations, and the limit of its iterates on the Fatou set, colored by blending the colors of the three cube roots of unity (white circles) according to the distance of $N_u^n(z)$ to each of them.

The chaos of the iterates of the Newton map on the Julia set is visible to the predicates P_1, P_2, P_3. In Section 5.6 we show that, for the polynomials $z^2 - 1$, q and u, this chaos prevents the Newton CCS on the Riemann sphere from being NIP (see Propositions 5.15 and 5.16).

4.3. **Example: Square roots.** We return to the first motivating example of Section 2.5, Newton's method on the real projective line for the polynomial $p(x) = x^2 - a$ with real $a > 0$, whose iterates approximate the square roots $\pm\sqrt{a}$. The deep computations of this method, which we now work out, place the method at the level NIP_3 (see Section 5.2). Since p has real coefficients, the Newton map N_p sends the real projective line $\mathbb{RP}^1 = \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\}$ into itself, as does the Newton map of every rational function with real coefficients. The Newton CCS for p may therefore be regarded as having state space $\mathbb{RP}^1$.

Let $\mathbb{R} \to S^1$, $x \mapsto (P_1(x), P_3(x))$, be the inverse stereographic projection of the real line onto $S^1 \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$, given by

$$P_1(x) = \frac{2x}{x^2+1}, \qquad P_3(x) = \frac{x^2-1}{x^2+1},$$

and extended to a homeomorphism of $\mathbb{RP}^1$ onto S^1 by $\infty \mapsto (P_1(\infty), P_3(\infty)) = (0,1)$. These coordinates are the restrictions to $\mathbb{RP}^1$ of the predicates P_1 and P_3 of the Riemann sphere, whose names they keep. As predicates, the two coordinates make $(\mathbb{RP}^1, (P_1, P_3))$ a computation states structure with a compact state space. The Newton map N_p is

$$x \mapsto x - \frac{x^2-a}{2x} = \begin{cases} \frac{x^2+a}{2x}, & x \neq 0, \infty; \\ \infty, & x = 0, \infty. \end{cases}$$

From every initial point $x_0 \neq 0, \infty$, the Newton steps converge to one of the square roots $\pm\sqrt{a}$. More precisely, the iterates of N_p converge pointwise to the map $\mathfrak{f}\colon \mathbb{RP}^1 \to \mathbb{RP}^1$ given by

$$\mathfrak{f}(x) = \lim_{n\to\infty} N_p^n(x) = \begin{cases} \sqrt{a}, & x \in (0, \infty); \\ -\sqrt{a}, & x \in (-\infty, 0); \\ \infty, & x = 0, \infty. \end{cases}$$

The map $\mathfrak{f}$ is therefore discontinuous at 0 and at ∞ (see Figure 2). In Proposition 5.2 below we show that the deep computations of the method are the iterates of N_p together with $\mathfrak{f}$.

5. Computations across the hierarchy

The hierarchy of Section 3 descends from the stable sets of computations through the classes NIP_3, NIP_2 and NIP_1 to the class NIP. The implications of the hierarchy hold for countable sets of computations in compositional computation structures with countably many features. Although the levels are defined through the topology of the space of deep computations, each of them is attained by a classical algorithm, and some familiar algorithms lie beyond the hierarchy altogether. In this section we establish both facts, and with them the strictness of every implication. In each example the computations are compositions of the steps of an algorithm. At all levels but one, these computations are the powers of a single step map. At the level NIP but not NIP_1 they form instead a group generated by two steps, both in the Euclidean algorithm and in free reduction in the free group on two generators. Moreover, a countable family of elements of the group generated by the steps of the Euclidean algorithm provides a second example at the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2. In every example the steps are continuous maps of a compact metrizable space of states, and for computations of this kind our hierarchy coincides with the Glasner–Megrelishvili hierarchy of tame dynamical systems [GM22]. The level of each algorithm is thereby a theorem about the closure of the semigroup generated by the steps of the algorithm. We begin with this coincidence (see Proposition 5.1), and Table 2 at the end of the section summarizes the examples.

5.1. **Iterative algorithms and tame dynamics.** The algorithms of this section act by continuous steps on a compact space of states. Within this setting, which we now isolate, our hierarchy coincides with the Glasner–Megrelishvili hierarchy of tame dynamical systems. The coincidence allows the results of Glasner and

Megrelishvili to be brought to bear on the examples that follow. A *dynamical CCS* is a compositional computation structure $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ in which L is a compact metrizable space and the predicates in $\mathcal{P}$ are continuous and separate the points of L. Moreover, the family $\mathcal{P}$ and the semigroup Γ are countable, and the members of Γ are continuous maps $L \to L$, among them the identity. A dynamical CCS is a *cascade CCS* if $\Gamma = \{\gamma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is the semigroup of iterates of a single continuous map $\gamma\colon L \to L$. Since $\mathcal{P}$ separates the points of the compact space L, the map $v \mapsto \mathrm{tp}(v)$ is a homeomorphism of L onto the space of types. Consequently a single shard covers L, every type is realized, and the Extendibility Axiom holds with $\tilde{\gamma} = \gamma$ for every $\gamma \in \Gamma$. The deep computations of a dynamical CCS form the pointwise closure

$$E(L, \Gamma) = \overline{\Gamma} \subseteq L^L,$$

which is the *enveloping semigroup*, introduced by Ellis, of the dynamical system (L, Γ); for a cascade CCS we write $E(L, \gamma)$. The system (L, Γ) is called *tame* if, for every continuous function $f\colon L \to \mathbb{R}$, the family $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ has the NIP of Definition 1.5 [Köh95, Gla06]. We say that a dynamical CCS is *stable* when its set Γ of computations has the property of Definition 2.8. Similarly, the CCS is called NIP when Γ satisfies condition (ii) of Theorem 3.1 with respect to a single sizer $r_\bullet$ with $L[r_\bullet] = L$. With respect to the same sizer, it is called NIP_1, NIP_2 or NIP_3 when Γ has the corresponding property of Definition 3.2.

A map $\xi\colon L \to L$ is *of Baire class* 1 if $f \circ \xi$ is of Baire class 1 for every continuous $f\colon L \to \mathbb{R}$. It suffices that $P \circ \xi$ be of Baire class 1 for every $P \in \mathcal{P}$. Indeed, since the type map embeds L into $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ with $\mathcal{P}$ countable, every open subset of L is a countable union of finite intersections of sets $P^{-1}(U)$ with $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ open. By Fact 1.2, the preimage of every open set under ξ is then an F_σ set, and so is the preimage of every open set under $f \circ \xi$. A second appeal to Fact 1.2 shows that the function $f \circ \xi$ is of Baire class 1. In general, the definition of Baire class 1 given above for maps from L to L is less restrictive than the one adopted in Section 1. The latter requires a map from L to L to be the pointwise limit of a sequence of continuous maps from L to L. For example, if $L = [0, 1] \cup \{2\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}$, then the map that sends $[0, 1/2]$ to 0 and the rest of L to 2 is of Baire class 1 in the sense defined above. This map, however, is not the pointwise limit of a sequence of continuous maps from L to L, because each such map sends the connected set $[0, 1]$ into $[0, 1]$ or to 2. For the deep computations of a dynamical CCS, by contrast, the two definitions agree. If every deep computation is of Baire class 1 in the sense defined above, then the CCS is NIP, as we show in Proposition 5.1 below. In that case the last assertion of Theorem 3.1, applied to the single sizer $r_\bullet$ with $L = L[r_\bullet]$, shows that every deep computation is the pointwise limit of a sequence of computations. Since computations are continuous maps from L to L, every deep computation is then of Baire class 1 in the sense of Section 1 as well.

Proposition 5.1. *A dynamical CCS is NIP if and only if the dynamical system (L, Γ) is tame, and if and only if every deep computation is of Baire class* 1*. In that case the CCS is NIP_1, NIP_2 or NIP_3 if and only if $E(L, \Gamma)$ is first countable, hereditarily separable or metrizable, respectively.*

Proof. The single sizer $r_\bullet$ with $L = L[r_\bullet]$ forms an exhaustive collection that confines Γ. If (L, Γ) is tame, the CCS is NIP: take $f = P$ for $P \in \mathcal{P}$. If the CCS is NIP, then Theorem 3.1 and Proposition 1.8 show that the function $P \circ \xi$ is of Baire

class 1 for every $\xi \in E(L,\Gamma)$ and $P \in \mathcal{P}$. Every deep computation is therefore of Baire class 1. Finally, suppose that every deep computation is of Baire class 1, and let $f\colon L \to \mathbb{R}$ be continuous. The map $\xi \mapsto f \circ \xi$ is continuous on L^L, so the closure of $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ is the compact set $\{f \circ \xi : \xi \in E(L,\Gamma)\}$, which lies in $\mathrm{B}_1(L)$. By Theorem 1.6, the family $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ has the NIP, so (L,Γ) is tame. The last statement is Definition 3.2, since $\overline{\tilde{\Gamma}|_L} = E(L,\Gamma)$. □

For systems on compact metrizable spaces, Glasner and Megrelishvili call a tame system *tame*$_1$ when the enveloping semigroup of the system is first countable and *tame*$_2$ when the enveloping semigroup is hereditarily separable. Hereditary non-sensitivity, a condition formulated directly in terms of the action, is equivalent for such systems to metrizability of the enveloping semigroup [GM22]. Glasner and Megrelishvili prove the inclusions between these classes [GM22, Proposition 0.6] and show by examples that the inclusions are proper. It follows from Proposition 5.1 that a dynamical CCS is NIP_1, NIP_2 or NIP_3 exactly when the dynamical system (L,Γ) is tame_1, tame_2 or hereditarily non-sensitive, respectively.

The simplest iterative methods are those whose iterates converge pointwise. In Proposition 5.2 we show that all of them are NIP_3, and that the continuity of the limit decides whether they are stable.

Proposition 5.2. *Let $(L,\mathcal{P},\Gamma)$ be a cascade CCS, with $\Gamma = \{\gamma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ for a continuous map $\gamma\colon L \to L$, and suppose that the iterates γ^n converge pointwise to a map $\gamma_\infty\colon L \to L$. Then $E(L,\gamma) = \{\gamma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\} \cup \{\gamma_\infty\}$, and the CCS is NIP$_3$. Moreover, the CCS is stable if and only if γ_∞ is continuous.*

Proof. Every neighborhood of γ_∞ in L^L contains all but finitely many iterates, and the set $\{\gamma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\} \cup \{\gamma_\infty\}$ is therefore compact. As a compact subset of the Hausdorff space L^L, this set is closed, and the enveloping semigroup $E(L,\gamma)$ therefore consists of the iterates and γ_∞. For each $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the function $P \circ \gamma_\infty$ is the pointwise limit of the continuous functions $P \circ \gamma^n$ and is therefore of Baire class 1. Since the iterates are continuous, every deep computation is of Baire class 1, and the CCS is NIP by Proposition 5.1. The space $E(L,\gamma)$ is a countable compact Hausdorff space, hence metrizable, and the CCS is therefore NIP_3. The members of $E(L,\gamma)$ other than γ_∞ are continuous, and the statement about stability follows. □

5.2. **Stable and metrizable.** Our descent through the hierarchy starts at the two top levels, stable and NIP_3, at which the deep computations form a metrizable space. At these two levels we place a rotation of the circle, Newton's method for square roots, the power method and the logistic map for $0 < r \leq 3$. By Proposition 5.2, every cascade CCS whose iterates converge pointwise lies at one of these two levels. Convergence, however, is not necessary for stability, as the first example shows.

A stable example: rotation. Let the space of states be the circle $L = \mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$, with the predicates $\cos 2\pi x$ and $\sin 2\pi x$, and let the step be the rotation $\gamma(x) = x+\alpha$ by an irrational number α. Since a pointwise limit of rotations is a rotation and the points $n\alpha$ with $n \in \mathbb{N}$ are dense in $\mathbb{T}$, the deep computations are all the rotations $x \mapsto x + c$ with $c \in \mathbb{T}$. These rotations are continuous, and the rotation CCS is therefore stable; the space of deep computations is the circle group, a metrizable compactum.

Square roots: NIP$_3$ but not stable. For $a > 0$, the iterates of the Newton map N_p of the polynomial $p(x) = x^2 - a$ on the real projective line converge pointwise

to the map $\mathfrak{f}$ defined in Section 4.3. Since this limit is discontinuous at 0 and ∞, Proposition 5.2 shows that the square-root CCS is NIP_3 but not stable.

The power method: NIP_3 but not stable. The power method computes a dominant eigenvector of a matrix by repeated multiplication and normalization. Let $d \geq 2$ be an integer, and let $A = \mathrm{diag}(\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_d)$ be a diagonal matrix with $\lambda_1 > \lambda_2 > \cdots > \lambda_d > 0$. The space of states is the real projective space $L = \mathbb{RP}^{d-1}$ of lines through the origin in $\mathbb{R}^d$, in which $[v]$ denotes the line spanned by a nonzero vector v. The family $\mathcal{P}$ consists of the predicates $P_{ij}([v]) = v_i v_j / \|v\|^2$ with $1 \leq i, j \leq d$, which are the entries of the orthogonal projection onto the line $[v]$. These predicates are continuous and separate the points of L, and with the step $\gamma([v]) = [Av]$ of the algorithm they form a cascade CCS. Let $e_1, \ldots, e_d$ be the standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^d$. For $[v] \in \mathbb{RP}^{d-1}$, let $i(v)$ be the least index i with $v_i \neq 0$, and define $\ell([v]) = [e_{i(v)}]$.

Proposition 5.3. *The deep computations of the power method form the set $E(L, \gamma) = \{\gamma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\} \cup \{\ell\}$. The power method is NIP_3 but not stable.*

Proof. For $i = i(v)$, we have $\lambda_i^{-n} A^n v = v_i e_i + \sum_{j>i} (\lambda_j/\lambda_i)^n v_j e_j \xrightarrow{n\to\infty} v_i e_i$. Hence $\gamma^n([v]) \xrightarrow{n\to\infty} \ell([v])$ for every $[v] \in L$, and Proposition 5.2 gives the description of $E(L, \gamma)$ and the level NIP_3. The map ℓ is discontinuous at every $[v]$ with $i(v) > 1$, since $[v + te_1] \xrightarrow{t\to 0} [v]$, whereas $\ell([v + te_1]) = [e_1] \neq \ell([v])$ for $t \neq 0$. By Proposition 5.2, the power method is therefore not stable. □

The deep computation ℓ sends each input to the eigenline of the largest eigenvalue whose eigenvector has a nonzero component in the input. Being discontinuous on the space of types L, the map ℓ is not computable in the sense of Section 2. This deep computation is nevertheless the limit of the sequence of iterates of γ, hence of Baire class 1, and the enveloping semigroup $E(L, \gamma)$ that contains ℓ is countable and metrizable.

Both levels: the logistic map. The logistic map $f_r(x) = rx(1-x)$, with $0 < r \leq 4$, maps $[0, 1]$ into itself. The logistic CCS, a cascade CCS, has states $L = [0, 1]$, the single predicate $x \mapsto x$, and the semigroup of iterates of f_r (see Figure 5). For $0 < r \leq 1$, let ℓ_r be the constant map 0; for $1 < r \leq 3$, let ℓ_r be the map with $\ell_r(x) = 1 - 1/r$ for $0 < x < 1$ and $\ell_r(0) = \ell_r(1) = 0$.

Proposition 5.4. *For $0 < r \leq 3$, the iterates of f_r converge pointwise to ℓ_r. Consequently the logistic CCS is stable for $0 < r \leq 1$, and NIP_3 but not stable for $1 < r \leq 3$.*

Proof. Write $f = f_r$ and $x^* = 1 - 1/r$, and note that $f(x)/x = r(1 - x)$ for $x > 0$. If $r \leq 1$, then $f(x) < x$ for $0 < x \leq 1$, so every orbit decreases to a fixed point of f, and 0 is the only fixed point in $[0, 1]$.

Suppose that $1 < r \leq 2$, in which case $0 < x^* \leq \frac{1}{2}$. The inequality $f(x) > x$ holds for $0 < x < x^*$, and the reverse inequality for $x^* < x \leq 1$. For $0 < x < 1$ we have $f(x) \in (0, \frac{r}{4}] \subseteq (0, \frac{1}{2}]$, and the function f, which fixes x^*, is increasing on $[0, \frac{1}{2}]$. Hence the orbit of $f(x)$ is increasing and bounded by x^* if $f(x) < x^*$, and decreasing and bounded below by x^* if $f(x) > x^*$. In both cases, as well as trivially when $f(x) = x^*$, the orbit of $f(x)$ converges to a fixed point of f in $(0, \frac{1}{2}]$, namely to x^*.

Suppose that $2 < r \leq 3$, and write $c = \frac{r}{4}$ for the maximum of f and $b = f(c)$. We have $x^* < c$, since $c - x^* = (r - 2)^2/(4r)$, and therefore $b < f(x^*) = x^*$, since

$\frac{1}{2} < x^* < c$ and f is strictly decreasing on $[\frac{1}{2}, 1]$. We also have $b \geq 1/r$, because $b - 1/r = (r^3(4-r) - 16)/(16r)$ and the polynomial $r^3(4-r)$ increases from 16 on $[2, 3]$. The concave function f takes the value x^* at $1/r$ and at x^*, so $f \geq x^*$ on $[1/r, x^*]$. Hence the function f maps $J_- = [b, x^*]$ into $J_+ = [x^*, c]$, and, being decreasing on J_+, the function maps J_+ onto J_-. Fix x with $0 < x < 1$; the orbit of $f(x)$ then lies in $(0, c]$, and this orbit meets $J_- \cup J_+ = [b, c]$. Indeed, if the orbit did not meet $[b, c]$, all the points of the orbit would lie in $(0, b)$, where $f(y) > y$ because $b < x^*$. The orbit would then increase to a fixed point of f in $(0, b]$. No such fixed point exists, since the only positive fixed point of f is x^*, which exceeds b. Since f maps $J_- \cup J_+$ into itself, it remains to be shown that the orbit of every $y \in J_- \cup J_+$ converges to x^*. The points of period 2 of f that are not fixed are the roots of $r^2y^2 - r(r+1)y + (r+1)$, whose discriminant $r^2(r+1)(r-3)$ is negative for $r < 3$; for $r = 3$ the only root is x^*. Hence the function $f(f(y)) - y$ vanishes on $[0, 1]$ only at 0 and x^*, and the function is negative on $(x^*, 1]$, since $f(f(1)) - 1 = -1$. For $y \in J_+$ with $y > x^*$, the point $f(f(y))$ lies in J_+, so $x^* \leq f(f(y)) < y$. The sequence $(f^{2n}(y))_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ therefore decreases to a fixed point of $f \circ f$ in $[x^*, y]$, that is, to x^*, whence $f^{2n+1}(y) \xrightarrow{n \to \infty} f(x^*) = x^*$. Every $y \in J_-$ satisfies $f(y) \in J_+$, and the orbit of y therefore converges to x^* as well.

Finally, the equalities $f(0) = f(1) = 0$ account for the endpoints, and in all cases the iterates therefore converge pointwise to ℓ_r. The map ℓ_r is continuous for $r \leq 1$, and discontinuous at 0 for $r > 1$, so Proposition 5.2 gives the remaining statements. □

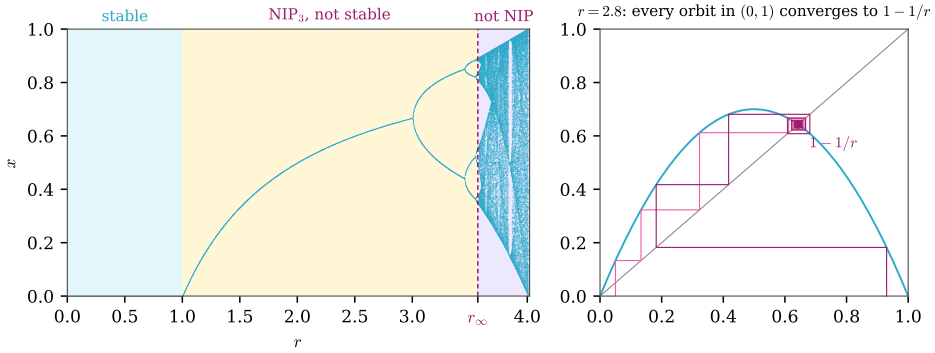


FIGURE 5. The logistic family $f_r(x) = rx(1-x)$: the long-run values of the orbit of 0.3 under f_r for each r (left), and two orbits converging to the fixed point $1 - 1/r$ for $r = 2.8$ (right).

We return to the logistic family for $3 < r \leq 4$ at the end of the section, where we complete its classification (see Proposition 5.18 and Remark 5.19).

5.3. **Hereditarily separable but not metrizable.** Bresenham's line algorithm in the plane, which we analyze in this subsection, lies at the level NIP_2 but not NIP_3, immediately below the metrizable level. At this level no countable set of tests separates the deep computations (see Proposition 3.4), a test being a pair of an input and a feature (see Section 3.2). In Bresenham's algorithm the source

of this phenomenon is rounding: the algorithm takes a discrete decision at each step, and the limits of these decisions along ultrafilters retain two opposite ways of breaking ties.

Drawing a line. Fix an irrational number α with $0 < \alpha < 1$. To draw the line $y = \alpha x + \rho$ on a screen, Bresenham's algorithm [Bre65] moves one pixel to the right at each step and decides whether to move one pixel up. The n-th decision is $b_n(\rho) = \lfloor (n+1)\alpha + \rho \rfloor - \lfloor n\alpha + \rho \rfloor = [\![\{n\alpha + \rho\} \in [1-\alpha, 1)]\!]$, where $\{\cdot\}$ denotes the fractional part, and the state of the algorithm is the error term ρ modulo 1. The step $\rho \mapsto \rho + \alpha$ is a rotation of the circle $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$, but the decision bit is not a continuous function of ρ. The standard remedy [MH40, Lot02] is to take the decision sequences themselves as states.

Let $\mathcal{O} = \{-k\alpha : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} \subseteq \mathbb{T}$, a countable dense set containing both endpoints 0 and $1-\alpha$ of the decision interval. The *split circle* $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ is obtained from $\mathbb{T}$ by replacing each $t \in \mathcal{O}$ by two points $t^- < t^+$, with the circular order topology. The split circle is a compact metrizable space, homeomorphic to the Cantor set. The rotation by α preserves $\mathcal{O}$ and lifts to a homeomorphism R of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ that preserves the labels $\pm$. The decision interval becomes clopen in $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$, and the coding map $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}} \to 2^{\mathbb{Z}}$, $y \mapsto ([\![R^n y \in [1-\alpha, 1)]\!])_{n \in \mathbb{Z}}$, is a homeomorphism onto the *Sturmian shift* X_α that conjugates R to the shift σ. The *Bresenham CCS* has states $L = X_\alpha$, the coordinate predicates $P_j(y) = y_j$ for $j \in \mathbb{Z}$, and the semigroup $\Gamma = \{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$. The coordinate predicates are continuous and separate the points of X_α, and the Bresenham CCS is therefore a cascade CCS in the sense of Section 5.1.

A point of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ lies *over* $t \in \mathbb{T}$ if the natural projection $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}} \to \mathbb{T}$ maps the point to t. For $c \in \mathbb{T}$, let R_c^+ (respectively R_c^-) be the map of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ that sends a point over t to $(t+c)^+$ (respectively $(t+c)^-$) when $t + c \in \mathcal{O}$, and to $t + c$ otherwise. Through the coding map, we regard R_c^+ and R_c^- as maps of X_α. The *double arrow circle* $\mathbb{D}$ is $\mathbb{T} \times \{-, +\}$ with the order topology of the lexicographic circular order, and we also write c^- and c^+ for the points $(c, -)$ and $(c, +)$ of $\mathbb{D}$. The double arrow circle is compact, first countable, hereditarily separable and not metrizable, as the arguments given by Engelking for the double arrow space show without change [Eng89, 3.10.C].

Theorem 5.5. *The Bresenham CCS is NIP. The space of deep computations of this CCS is*

$$E(X_\alpha, \sigma) = \{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\} \cup \{R_c^+, R_c^- : c \in \mathbb{T}\},$$

in which each iterate σ^n is isolated, and the map $c^\pm \mapsto R_c^\pm$ is a homeomorphism of $\mathbb{D}$ onto $\{R_c^+, R_c^- : c \in \mathbb{T}\}$. In particular, the Bresenham CCS is NIP$_2$ but not NIP$_3$.

Proof. To prove that the CCS is NIP, note that the predicates $P_j \circ \sigma^n$ are $\{0,1\}$-valued. Moreover, the j-th coordinate of $\sigma^n y$ is 1 exactly when $R^{n+j} y$ lies in the clopen arc $[1-\alpha, 1)$ of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$, that is, when y lies in an arc of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$. A family of arcs of a circularly ordered set has VC dimension at most 3. By the remark at the end of Section 1.5, the characteristic functions of the members of such a family therefore have the NIP.

For the deep computations, let γ be the limit of the iterates σ^n along an ultrafilter $\mathcal{U}$ on $\mathbb{N}$, and let $c = \lim_{n,\mathcal{U}} n\alpha$ in $\mathbb{T}$. If $\mathcal{U}$ is principal, then γ is a power of σ. Otherwise, since the points $n\alpha$ are distinct, the ultrafilter $\mathcal{U}$ decides whether $n\alpha$ approaches c from the right or from the left. In the first case, for every point y

over t, the points $R^n y$ over $t + n\alpha$ approach $t + c$ strictly from the right along $\mathcal{U}$. These points converge along $\mathcal{U}$ in $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ to $(t+c)^+$ if $t+c \in \mathcal{O}$ and to $t+c$ otherwise, whence $\gamma = R_c^+$; the second case gives $\gamma = R_c^-$. Conversely, for every N, every c is approached from both sides by the points $n\alpha$ with $n \geq N$; hence every $R_c^{\pm}$ is a deep computation. The maps R_c^+ and R_c^- are distinct, since they differ at the points over $d - c$ with $d \in \mathcal{O}$. The same argument shows that, for every net $(c_i^{\varepsilon_i})_{i \in I}$ in $\mathbb{D}$ that converges to c^+, the maps $R_{c_i}^{\varepsilon_i}$ converge pointwise to R_c^+, and symmetrically for c^-. The map $c^{\pm} \mapsto R_c^{\pm}$ is therefore a continuous bijection from the compact space $\mathbb{D}$ onto the Hausdorff space $\{R_c^+, R_c^- : c \in \mathbb{T}\}$, hence a homeomorphism. Finally, fix $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $d \in \mathcal{O}$. The map σ^n sends the two points $(d - n\alpha)^-$ and $(d - n\alpha)^+$ of $\mathbb{T}_{\mathcal{O}}$ to the distinct points d^- and d^+, whereas every map $R_c^{\pm}$ sends both points to the same point; hence σ^n is none of the maps $R_c^{\pm}$. Nor is σ^n equal to σ^m for $m \neq n$, since R^{m-n} moves every point over t to a point over $t + (m-n)\alpha \neq t$. By the description of limits along ultrafilters given above, the closure of $\{\sigma^m : m \neq n\}$ consists of maps σ^m with $m \neq n$ and of maps $R_c^{\pm}$, and the map σ^n is therefore isolated. Thus $E(X_\alpha, \sigma)$ is the union of a countable set and a copy of $\mathbb{D}$, and the space is hereditarily separable and not metrizable; by Proposition 5.1, the Bresenham CCS is NIP_2 but not NIP_3. □

The two deep computations R_c^+ and R_c^- are the two ways of drawing the line infinitely far away, where the accumulated error has reached c. The two maps agree except at the pixels where the line passes exactly through a corner, and at those pixels they apply the two opposite rounding conventions. Figure 6 shows the two conventions.

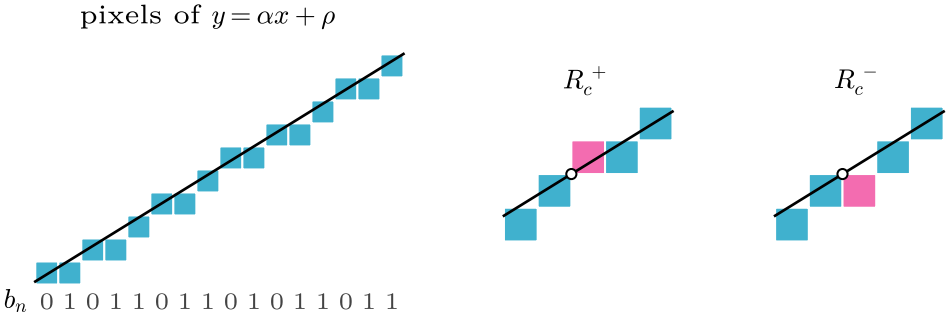


FIGURE 6. The pixels drawn by Bresenham's algorithm for $\alpha = (\sqrt{5} - 1)/2$, with the decision bits b_n (left), and the opposite tie-breaking of the deep computations R_c^+ and R_c^- where the line passes exactly through a pixel corner (right).

Since the Bresenham CCS is NIP, Theorem 3.1 shows that the space $E(X_\alpha, \sigma)$ is a Rosenthal compactum, which is separable as the closure of the countable set of iterates. Since this compactum is hereditarily separable and not metrizable, Todorčević's trichotomy (see Theorem 3.3) provides a copy of the split Cantor set $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ inside the compactum. For the action of $\mathbb{Z}$ generated by the shift, Glasner and Megrelishvili proved that Sturmian systems are tame_2 but not hereditarily

non-sensitive [GM22, Corollary 8.3]. Theorem 5.5 gives the analogue for the semigroup of forward iterates of the shift, together with an explicit description of the enveloping semigroup.

5.4. **First countable but not hereditarily separable.** When two rounding algorithms run in parallel, the level of the computation may descend once more. We establish such a descent for Bresenham's algorithm for lines in three-dimensional space, which lies at the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2. At this level each deep computation is still separated from all the others by a countable set of tests chosen for that deep computation (see Proposition 3.4). The same proposition shows, however, that some finitely separated set of deep computations has the cardinality of the continuum.

Drawing a line in space. Let α and β be irrational numbers in $(0,1)$ such that $1, \alpha, \beta$ are linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$. To draw a line in $\mathbb{Z}^3$ with direction $(1, \alpha, \beta)$, the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm runs the planar algorithm in two coordinates at once. The *three-dimensional Bresenham CCS* has states $L = X_\alpha \times X_\beta$, where X_β is the Sturmian shift defined as X_α with β in place of α, the coordinate predicates of both factors, and the semigroup generated by $\sigma \times \sigma$.

The analysis of this algorithm rests on a property of the double arrow circle $\mathbb{D}$ of Section 5.3: every subspace of $\mathbb{D}$ with a countable network is countable, and consequently every compact metrizable subspace of $\mathbb{D} \times \mathbb{D}$ is countable. Recall that a *network* of a space is a family of subsets such that every neighborhood of a point contains a member of the family that contains the point. In particular, every base is a network.

Lemma 5.6. *Every subspace of the double arrow circle $\mathbb{D}$ that has a countable network, in particular every metrizable subspace, is countable.*

Proof. A metrizable subspace of $\mathbb{D}$ is separable, since $\mathbb{D}$ is hereditarily separable, and the subspace therefore has a countable base, which is a countable network. Let $M \subseteq \mathbb{D}$ have a countable network $\{N_k : k \in \mathbb{N}\}$. For each $c \in \mathbb{T}$ with $c^+ \in M$, the open arc $[c^+, (c + \frac{1}{2})^-)$ is a neighborhood of c^+ in $\mathbb{D}$, and we may choose $k(c) \in \mathbb{N}$ with $c^+ \in N_{k(c)} \subseteq [c^+, (c + \frac{1}{2})^-)$. If $k(c) = k(c')$, then the point c'^+ lies in $[c^+, (c + \frac{1}{2})^-)$ and the point c^+ in $[c'^+, (c' + \frac{1}{2})^-)$, whence both $c' - c$ and $c - c'$ lie in $[0, \frac{1}{2})$ modulo 1, which forces $c = c'$. Thus the map $c \mapsto k(c)$ is injective, and the set M contains only countably many points c^+. The same argument, applied to the arcs $((c - \frac{1}{2})^+, c^-]$, shows that M contains only countably many points c^-. □

Corollary 5.7. *Every compact metrizable subspace of $\mathbb{D} \times \mathbb{D}$ is countable.*

Proof. Let $C \subseteq \mathbb{D} \times \mathbb{D}$ be compact and metrizable, and let $\mathcal{N}$ be a countable base of C. Since the two projections are continuous, the images of the members of $\mathcal{N}$ under each projection form a countable network of the image of C. By Lemma 5.6, both images are countable, and so is C, which is contained in their product. □

For $c' \in \mathbb{T}$, we also write $R^+_{c'}$ and $R^-_{c'}$ for the maps of X_β defined as in Section 5.3, with β in place of α. We denote by $E = E(X_\alpha \times X_\beta, \sigma \times \sigma)$ the space of deep computations of the three-dimensional Bresenham CCS.

Theorem 5.8. *The three-dimensional Bresenham CCS is NIP_1 but not NIP_2. The space E is the union of the set of iterates $(\sigma \times \sigma)^n$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and the closed subspace*

$$\{(R^\varepsilon_c, R^{\varepsilon'}_{c'}) : c, c' \in \mathbb{T},\ \varepsilon, \varepsilon' \in \{+, -\}\},$$

which is homeomorphic to $\mathbb{D}\times\mathbb{D}$. Each of these iterates is isolated in E. The space E contains a copy of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ and no copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, of $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ or of $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.

Proof. Each predicate is a coordinate of one factor, so the CCS is NIP by Theorem 5.5. Every deep computation is the limit ξ of the iterates $(\sigma\times\sigma)^n$ along an ultrafilter $\mathcal{U}$ on $\mathbb{N}$. The coordinates of ξ are then the limits along $\mathcal{U}$ of the iterates σ^n on X_α and on X_β. If $\mathcal{U}$ is principal, the deep computation ξ is an iterate; otherwise the proof of Theorem 5.5 shows that ξ is a pair $(R_c^\varepsilon, R_{c'}^{\varepsilon'})$. By Kronecker's theorem, the points $(n\alpha, n\beta)$ with $n\geq N$ are dense in $\mathbb{T}^2$ for every N. Every point (c,c') is therefore approached by these points from inside each of the four open quadrants at (c,c'). As in the proof of Theorem 5.5, it follows that every pair $(R_c^\varepsilon, R_{c'}^{\varepsilon'})$ with $\varepsilon,\varepsilon'\in\{+,-\}$ is a deep computation. By Theorem 5.5, applied to each factor, the set of these pairs is homeomorphic to $\mathbb{D}\times\mathbb{D}$, and the set is therefore compact, hence closed in E. Each iterate $(\sigma\times\sigma)^n$ is isolated in E, since σ^n is isolated in $E(X_\alpha,\sigma)$ and is the first coordinate of no other deep computation. The space E is a closed subspace of $E(X_\alpha,\sigma)\times E(X_\beta,\sigma)$, which is first countable as a product of two first countable spaces. Hence the CCS is NIP_1, and no copy of the space $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, which is not first countable, lies in E. Consider the pairs (R_c^+, R_{-c}^+), for $c\in\mathbb{T}$. For $0<\delta<\frac{1}{2}$, the set $[c^+,(c+\delta)^-)\times[(-c)^+,(-c+\delta)^-)$ is a neighborhood of $(c^+,(-c)^+)$ in $\mathbb{D}\times\mathbb{D}$ that contains $(s^+,(-s)^+)$ only if $c\leq s<c+\delta$ and $-c\leq -s<-c+\delta$, that is, only if $s=c$. These pairs therefore form an uncountable discrete subspace, and the space of deep computations is not hereditarily separable; thus the CCS is not NIP_2. A compact metrizable subspace of E meets the copy of $\mathbb{D}\times\mathbb{D}$ in a compact metrizable set, which is countable by Corollary 5.7, and the subspace itself is therefore countable. Since the non-isolated points of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ form a copy of the Cantor set, neither $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ nor the compactum $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ that contains $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ embeds into E. Finally, by Theorem 3.1 the space E, being the closure of a countable set, is a separable Rosenthal compactum that is first countable but not hereditarily separable. By Theorem 3.3, this compactum contains a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ or of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$, necessarily of the latter. □

The uncountable discrete set consists of the deep computations that break ties upward in both coordinates at points where the two accumulated errors are opposite. Each of the two planar algorithms is NIP_2, and drawing in two directions at once leaves the class. In just the same way, the Sorgenfrey plane shows that a product of two hereditarily separable spaces need not be hereditarily separable. Glasner and Megrelishvili show similarly that a product of two tame_2 systems need not be tame_2 [GM22, Proposition 4.1].[9] The Alexandroff duplicate, which the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm does not produce, appears at the same level in the Euclidean algorithm. In Proposition 5.13 below we exhibit a countable set of

[9]The double arrow space is the set of the points $p^-<p^+$, for $p\in[0,1]$, with the order topology. Glasner and Megrelishvili [GM22, Remark 4.2] assert that the square of this space contains a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, namely the set of the points $(p^+,(1-p)^+)$ and $(p^-,(1-p)^+)$ with p in the Cantor set. The set of these points is not closed, and hence not compact. For instance, if p is the limit of a decreasing sequence $(x_k)_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$ of points of the Cantor set, then the points $(x_k^-,(1-x_k)^+)$ of this set converge to $(p^+,(1-p)^-)$, a point outside the set. Moreover, the square of the double arrow space contains no copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ at all. Indeed, with intervals in place of arcs, the arguments of Lemma 5.6 and Corollary 5.7 apply to the double arrow space, and the non-isolated points of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ form an uncountable compact metrizable set. Proposition 4.1 of Glasner and Megrelishvili does not depend on their Remark 4.2.

elements of the group generated by the steps of the Euclidean algorithm whose closure is homeomorphic to $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ and therefore contains a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$. Whether a single iterated map can realize the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2 with such a copy remains open (see Question 7.3).

Remark 5.9. A copy of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ in E whose dense set of isolated points consists of iterates can be exhibited explicitly. For $t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}$, let x_t be the right endpoint of the closed interval of length $3^{-|t|}$ indexed by t in the construction of the middle-thirds Cantor set, and let $y_t = \frac{3}{2}\,3^{-|t|} - x_t$. By Kronecker's theorem, there are pairwise distinct $n_t \in \mathbb{N}$ such that, modulo 1, the point $n_t\alpha$ lies in $(x_t, x_t + 3^{-|t|-1})$ and the point $n_t\beta$ in $(y_t, y_t + 3^{-|t|-1})$. For $b \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$, let x_b be the point of the Cantor set coded by b, the limit of the points $x_{b\restriction n}$. As t runs through the initial segments of b, the iterates $(\sigma \times \sigma)^{n_t}$ converge to $(R^+_{x_b}, R^+_{-x_b})$. Along words t that converge to b, are not initial segments of b and satisfy $t^\frown 0^\infty < b$, the iterates converge to $(R^-_{x_b}, R^+_{-x_b})$. Finally, along words that converge to b and satisfy $t^\frown 0^\infty > b$, the iterates converge to $(R^+_{x_b}, R^-_{-x_b})$. The three convergences just described are the convergence patterns of the family D_7 of Section 3.3. Since the iterates are isolated in E, a lemma of Argyros, Dodos and Kanellopoulos [ADK08, Lemma 19] shows that the family $\{(\sigma \times \sigma)^{n_t} : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ is equivalent to D_7 and therefore has a closure homeomorphic to $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$. These three patterns are drawn in the left panel of Figure 8; the right panel shows the copy of $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ that maps built from the Euclidean algorithm produce in Section 5.5.

5.5. **NIP but not first countable: the Euclidean algorithm.** The last tame level, NIP but not NIP_1, is reached by the Euclidean algorithm, acting on the real projective line through the group generated by the steps of the algorithm. At this level some deep computation is determined by no countable set of tests, where a test, as in Proposition 3.4, is a pair formed by an input and a feature. A constant deep computation fails to be determined in this way whenever uncountably many *exact equality tests* are also deep computations; here an exact equality test is a map, not a test in the preceding sense, that agrees with the constant map at every input but one. Indeed, a countable set of tests involves only countably many inputs, and therefore cannot distinguish the constant map from an exact equality test whose exceptional input lies outside this countable set of inputs. Exact equality tests of precisely this kind occur among the deep computations of the Euclidean algorithm.

Let $L = \mathbb{RP}^1 = \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\}$ carry the predicates P_1, P_3 of Section 4.3, the two coordinates of the inverse stereographic projection of $\mathbb{RP}^1$ onto the unit circle, and let $\Gamma = \mathrm{PGL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ be the group of Möbius maps $x \mapsto (ax+b)/(cx+d)$ with integer coefficients and $ad - bc = \pm 1$. The group Γ is generated by the steps $x \mapsto x+1$ and $x \mapsto 1/x$ of the Euclidean algorithm, and the maps that the continued fraction algorithm composes are elements of Γ. We call $(\mathbb{RP}^1, (P_1, P_3), \Gamma)$ the *Euclidean CCS*. The Euclidean CCS is a dynamical CCS whose semigroup is a group, and whose deep computations form the enveloping semigroup $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$.

Let $\eta = [a_0; a_1, a_2, \dots]$ be an irrational number, and, for $k \geq 0$, let p_k/q_k be the convergents of η and $\eta_{k+1} = [a_{k+1}; a_{k+2}, \dots]$ the complete quotients of η, with the customary convention $p_{-1} = 1$ and $q_{-1} = 0$. For $k \geq 0$, let M_k be the Möbius map $t \mapsto (p_k t + p_{k-1})/(q_k t + q_{k-1})$, which belongs to Γ because $p_k q_{k-1} - p_{k-1} q_k = (-1)^{k+1}$. Writing $A_j(t) = a_j + 1/t$, we have $M_k = A_0 \circ A_1 \circ \cdots \circ A_k$, and hence the inverse map is $M_k^{-1} = A_k^{-1} \circ \cdots \circ A_0^{-1}$, with $A_j^{-1}(t) = 1/(t - a_j)$. Thus M_k^{-1} is

the map that the first $k+1$ steps of the continued fraction algorithm for η apply. In these terms, the classical identity $\eta = M_k(\eta_{k+1})$ states that these steps send η to the complete quotient η_{k+1}.

Lemma 5.10. *Let η be an irrational number, and let $x \in \mathbb{RP}^1$ be distinct from η. Then $M_k^{-1}(x) + q_{k-1}/q_k \xrightarrow{k\to\infty} 0$, while $M_k^{-1}(\eta) = \eta_{k+1} > 1$ for every $k \geq 0$.*

Proof. For $k \geq 1$ we have $q_{k-1} \geq 1$, and solving $M_k(t) = x$ gives $M_k^{-1}(\infty) = -q_{k-1}/q_k$ and, for real x,

$$M_k^{-1}(x) = \frac{q_{k-1}x - p_{k-1}}{p_k - q_k x} = -\frac{q_{k-1}}{q_k} \cdot \frac{x - p_{k-1}/q_{k-1}}{x - p_k/q_k},$$

where the value is ∞ if $x = p_k/q_k$. The convergents of an irrational number are pairwise distinct, so x equals p_k/q_k for at most one k, and for all larger k the formula gives a real number. The convergents p_{k-1}/q_{k-1} and p_k/q_k both tend to $\eta \neq x$; hence the second fraction tends to 1, and since $0 < q_{k-1}/q_k \leq 1$ for $k \geq 1$, we obtain $M_k^{-1}(x) + q_{k-1}/q_k \xrightarrow{k\to\infty} 0$. The identity $M_k^{-1}(\eta) = \eta_{k+1}$ is the classical one, and $\eta_{k+1} > a_{k+1} \geq 1$ because η_{k+1} is irrational. □

Let $\varphi = (1+\sqrt{5})/2$ be the golden ratio. Let G be the set of irrational numbers $\eta = [0; a_1, a_2, \dots]$ whose sequence of partial quotients is a concatenation $1^1 d_1 1^2 d_2 1^3 d_3 \cdots$, where 1^n denotes n consecutive ones and each $d_n \in \{1, 2\}$. For each $n \geq 1$, the block 1^n occupies the indices $s_n, \dots, s_n + n - 1$, where $s_n = n(n+1)/2$. Distinct choices of $(d_n)_{n\geq 1}$ give distinct numbers, by the uniqueness of continued fraction expansions, and G therefore has the cardinality of the continuum. For $\eta \in G$, let δ_η be the map that sends η to φ and every other point of $\mathbb{RP}^1$ to $-1/\varphi$, and let c be the constant map on $\mathbb{RP}^1$ with value $-1/\varphi$.

Proposition 5.11. *(i) For every $\eta \in G$, the map δ_η is a deep computation of the Euclidean CCS.*

(ii) The constant map c is a deep computation of the Euclidean CCS, and c has no countable base of neighborhoods in $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$.

Consequently, the space $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$ is not first countable.

Proof. (i) Let $\eta \in G$ be given. For each $n \geq 1$, let $k_n = s_n + \lfloor n/2 \rfloor$ be the middle index of the block 1^n, and let $m_n = \lceil n/2 \rceil - 1$. Then $a_{k_n} = a_{k_n - 1} = \cdots = a_{k_n - m_n} = 1$ and $a_{k_n+1} = \cdots = a_{k_n+m_n} = 1$, while $m_n \xrightarrow{n\to\infty} \infty$. The two quantities that occur in Lemma 5.10 are continued fractions: $q_{k-1}/q_k = [0; a_k, a_{k-1}, \dots, a_1]$ and $\eta_{k+1} = [a_{k+1}; a_{k+2}, \dots]$. Suppose that two continued fractions, finite or infinite, $[c_0; c_1, \dots]$ and $[c'_0; c'_1, \dots]$ satisfy $c_j = c'_j$ for $j < m$, with $c_1 = \cdots = c_{m-1} = 1$. Then the two continued fractions share the convergents of index at most $m-1$, and both lie between the last two of these convergents (or equal one of them). It follows that the two continued fractions differ by at most $1/(q_{m-2}q_{m-1}) \leq 1/(F_{m-1}F_m)$, whatever their remaining partial quotients are, where F_j denotes the jth Fibonacci number, with $F_1 = F_2 = 1$. The hypothesis holds with $m = m_n$ for the pair $[0; a_{k_n}, \dots, a_1]$, $[0; 1, 1, \dots]$ and for the pair $[a_{k_n+1}; a_{k_n+2}, \dots]$, $[1; 1, 1, \dots]$. Hence $q_{k_n-1}/q_{k_n} \xrightarrow{n\to\infty} [0; 1, 1, \dots] = 1/\varphi$ and $\eta_{k_n+1} \xrightarrow{n\to\infty} [1; 1, 1, \dots] = \varphi$, and Lemma 5.10 shows that the maps $M_{k_n}^{-1} \in \Gamma$ converge pointwise to δ_η, at $x = \infty$ as well.

(ii) Let $(\eta_j)_{j\in\mathbb{N}}$ be a sequence of distinct elements of G. For each $x \in \mathbb{RP}^1$, at most one j satisfies $\eta_j = x$, and therefore $\delta_{\eta_j}(x) = -1/\varphi$ for all but at most

one j. Hence $\delta_{\eta_j} \xrightarrow{j\to\infty} c$ pointwise, and c belongs to $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$ because this set is closed. Now let $(U_i)_{i\in\mathbb{N}}$ be open neighborhoods of c in $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$, and fix a metric d on $\mathbb{RP}^1$. Each U_i contains a basic neighborhood $\{f : d(f(x), c(x)) < \varepsilon_i \text{ for } x \in F_i\}$ with $F_i \subseteq \mathbb{RP}^1$ finite and $\varepsilon_i > 0$. Since the set $F = \bigcup_i F_i$ is countable, some $\eta \in G$ lies outside F; the map δ_η then agrees with c on F and hence lies in $\bigcap_i U_i$, although $\delta_\eta \neq c$. Thus no countable family of neighborhoods of c has intersection $\{c\}$. In a Hausdorff space, the intersection of a base of neighborhoods of a point is the singleton formed by the point, and c therefore has no countable base of neighborhoods. □

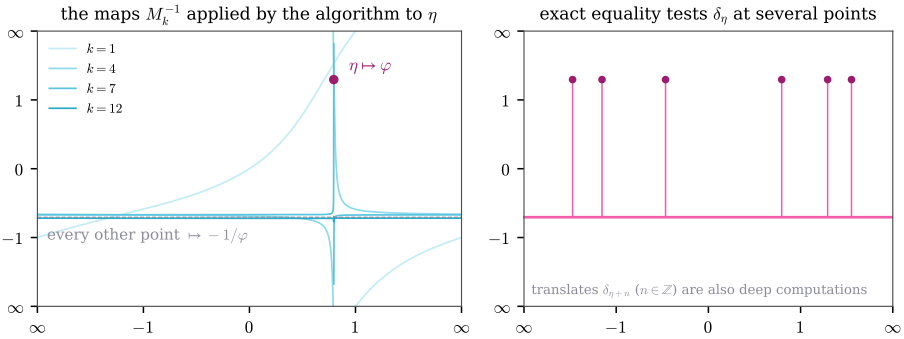


FIGURE 7. The Euclidean algorithm on the projective line (each axis runs from ∞ through 0 back to ∞): the maps M_k^{-1} that the continued fraction algorithm applies to a number η whose partial quotients contain longer and longer runs of ones (left), and their limits, exact equality tests δ_η, at several points (right).

Corollary 5.12. *The Euclidean CCS is NIP but not NIP$_1$. The space of deep computations of the Euclidean CCS contains the copy $\{\delta_\eta : \eta \in G\} \cup \{c\}$ of the Alexandroff compactification $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$.*

Proof. Ellis proved that the action of $\mathrm{GL}(2, \mathbb{R})$ on the projective line is tame [Ell93] (see [GM22, Example 5.7]). For every continuous $f\colon \mathbb{RP}^1 \to \mathbb{R}$, the family $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ is contained in the corresponding family for $\mathrm{GL}(2, \mathbb{R})$, and therefore has the NIP. Hence the action of Γ is tame, and, by Proposition 5.1, the Euclidean CCS is NIP; by Proposition 5.11, the Euclidean CCS is not NIP$_1$. Each δ_η is isolated in $\{\delta_\eta : \eta \in G\} \cup \{c\}$, since δ_η is the only member of this set that sends η near φ. Moreover, as in the proof of Proposition 5.11, every neighborhood of c contains all but finitely many of the maps δ_η. The set $\{\delta_\eta : \eta \in G\} \cup \{c\}$ is therefore the one-point compactification of a discrete set of cardinality $2^{\aleph_0}$, and hence homeomorphic to $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ (see Section 1.4). □

The deep computation δ_η is an exact equality test (see Figure 7): the map takes one value if the input is exactly η and another value otherwise. The map δ_η is the pointwise limit of maps that the continued fraction algorithm applies to η, when these maps are applied to all inputs. The mechanism is that of convergence groups, the groups of homeomorphisms of a compact space in which every sequence of

distinct elements has a subsequence converging to a constant map uniformly on the compact subsets of the complement of some point. By Lemma 5.10, the maps M_k^{-1} draw the images of all points other than η together, near $-q_{k-1}/q_k \in [-1, 0)$, while sending η itself into $(1, \infty)$. In the language of convergence groups, every irrational number η is thus a conical limit point of Γ: some sequence in Γ sends η to one limit and every other point to another. The choice of G makes the two limits the same for uncountably many η. Glasner and Megrelishvili use the same device to prove that an infinite countable uniform convergence group acting on a compact metric space with infinite limit set is tame but not tame_1 [GM22, Proposition 6.1 and Theorem 6.5]. Their theorem does not cover Γ, which contains parabolic elements and is not a uniform convergence group on $\mathbb{RP}^1$. Ellis's example, the projective action of the whole group $\mathrm{GL}(2, \mathbb{R})$, is also tame but not tame_1 [GM22, Example 5.7]. The Euclidean CCS shows that the countable group generated by the two steps of the algorithm already reaches this level.

Iterating a single element of Γ cannot produce δ_η. Indeed, for every $g \in \Gamma$, the closure of the set of powers $\{g^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ in $(\mathbb{RP}^1)^{\mathbb{RP}^1}$ is countable, hence metrizable, and does not contain δ_η, as the following cases show. If g has finite order, the set of powers of g is finite. If g is parabolic, with fixed point x_0, then $g^n \xrightarrow{n\to+\infty} \kappa$ and $g^n \xrightarrow{n\to-\infty} \kappa$ pointwise, where κ is the constant map with value x_0. If g is hyperbolic, with attracting and repelling fixed points x_a and x_r, let h_a be the map that fixes x_r and sends every other point to x_a, and let h_r be the map that fixes x_a and sends every other point to x_r; then $g^n \xrightarrow{n\to+\infty} h_a$ and $g^n \xrightarrow{n\to-\infty} h_r$ pointwise. If g reverses orientation and has infinite order, then the trace t of a matrix that represents g is nonzero, whence the square g^2, represented by a matrix of trace $t^2 + 2 > 2$, is a hyperbolic map with the same fixed points as g. The odd powers $g^{2m+1} = g \circ g^{2m}$ then have the same two limits as the even ones. In every case the closure consists of the powers of g, which are homeomorphisms, together with at most two limit maps, each of which is constant or fixes the unique point at which the map differs from a constant. The map δ_η is not a power of g, since δ_η is not injective, and δ_η is none of the limit maps, since δ_η differs from a constant only at η and $\delta_\eta(\eta) = \varphi \neq \eta$.

A copy of the Alexandroff duplicate. Among the deep computations of the Euclidean CCS, the device of Proposition 5.11 also produces a copy of the Alexandroff duplicate $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$. With this copy comes a countable set of computations at the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2. Instead of sending uncountably many irrational numbers to the same pair of values, we now let the value that a deep computation takes away from the exceptional point vary continuously with the exceptional point. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the set of irrational numbers $[0; \omega_1, \omega_2, \dots]$ with $\omega_n \in \{1, 2\}$ for every $n \geq 1$, a Cantor set homeomorphic to $\{1, 2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$ through continued fraction expansions. For $\omega = (\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots) \in \{1, 2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$ we write $[0; \omega]$ for the point $[0; \omega_1, \omega_2, \dots]$ of $\mathcal{C}$. For a finite or infinite sequence ω over the alphabet $\{1, 2\}$ and for each positive integer n not exceeding the length of ω, let $\Lambda_n(\omega)$ be the block $(\omega_n, \omega_{n-1}, \dots, \omega_1, 1^n)$, formed by the first n terms of ω in reverse order followed by n ones. For $\omega \in \{1, 2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$, let $\eta(\omega)$ be the irrational number in $(0, 1)$ whose partial quotients after the initial 0 form the concatenation $\Lambda_1(\omega)\Lambda_2(\omega)\Lambda_3(\omega)\cdots$. Since the terms $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_n$ can be recovered from $\Lambda_n(\omega)$, the map $\omega \mapsto \eta(\omega)$ is injective. For a finite word $\mathsf{w} = (\mathsf{w}_1, \dots, \mathsf{w}_k)$ of positive integers, let M_{w} be the Möbius map $x \mapsto [0; \mathsf{w}_1, \dots, \mathsf{w}_{k-1}, \mathsf{w}_k + 1/x]$, and let $M_\emptyset(x) = 1/x$ for the empty word. For an irrational number $[0; a_1, a_2, \dots]$

in $(0,1)$, the map M_k introduced before Lemma 5.10 is then $M_{(a_1,\dots,a_k)}$. Write $\{1,2\}^{<\mathbb{N}}$ for the set of finite words over $\{1,2\}$. For a word $t=(t_1,\dots,t_m)$ in this set, let $t^\sharp$ be the word $\Lambda_1(t)\cdots\Lambda_{m-1}(t)\,(t_m,t_{m-1},\dots,t_1)$ of length m^2, and let γ_t be the element $M_{t^\sharp}^{-1}$ of Γ. We denote by $\Delta_{\mathfrak{C}}$ the countable set $\{\gamma_t : t\in\{1,2\}^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ of computations of the Euclidean CCS, and we take closures in $(\mathbb{RP}^1)^{\mathbb{RP}^1}$. Finally, for $\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$, let τ_ω be the map that sends $\eta(\omega)$ to φ and every other point of $\mathbb{RP}^1$ to $-[0;\omega]$, and let c_ω be the constant map with value $-[0;\omega]$. For the constant sequence $\omega=(1,1,1,\dots)$, the map c_ω is the map c of Proposition 5.11.

Proposition 5.13. *(i) The closure of $\Delta_{\mathfrak{C}}$ is $\Delta_{\mathfrak{C}}\cup\{\tau_\omega:\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\}\cup\{c_\omega:\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\}$, and this closure is homeomorphic to $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ through a homeomorphism that maps $\{\tau_\omega:\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\}\cup\{c_\omega:\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\}$ onto $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$. In particular, the space $E(\mathbb{RP}^1,\Gamma)$ contains a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, and the set $\Delta_{\mathfrak{C}}$ is NIP_1 but not NIP_2.*

(ii) Every hereditarily separable compact subset of $E(\mathbb{RP}^1,\Gamma)$ is metrizable. In particular, the space $E(\mathbb{RP}^1,\Gamma)$ contains no copy of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ and none of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$.

Proof. (i) We use two facts from the proofs of Lemma 5.10 and Proposition 5.11. First, consider two continued fractions, finite or infinite, with positive integer partial quotients that agree in their terms of index less than m. Both lie between two consecutive convergents of index $m-2$ and $m-1$, and hence differ by at most $1/(F_{m-1}F_m)$. Second, the formula for M_k^{-1} in the proof of Lemma 5.10 uses only the terms $a_0,\dots,a_k$: if $k\geq 1$ and p_i/q_i are the convergents of $[a_0;a_1,\dots,a_k]$, the map $M(x)=[a_0;a_1,\dots,a_{k-1},a_k+1/x]$ satisfies

$$M^{-1}(x)=-\frac{q_{k-1}}{q_k}\cdot\frac{x-p_{k-1}/q_{k-1}}{x-p_k/q_k}\quad(x\in\mathbb{R}),\qquad M^{-1}(\infty)=-\frac{q_{k-1}}{q_k},\tag{5.14}$$

where $q_{k-1}/q_k=[0;a_k,a_{k-1},\dots,a_1]$.

Limits along initial segments. Let $\omega\in\{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$ be given, and write $\eta=\eta(\omega)=[0;a_1,a_2,\dots]$. For $m\geq 1$, the word $(\omega\restriction m)^\sharp$ consists of the first m^2 partial quotients of η, whence $\gamma_{\omega\restriction m}=M_{m^2}^{-1}$. The terms $a_{m^2},a_{m^2-1},\dots,a_{m^2-m+1}$ are $\omega_1,\omega_2,\dots,\omega_m$, and $a_{m^2+1}=\cdots=a_{m^2+m}=1$. By the first fact, the quotient $q_{m^2-1}/q_{m^2}=[0;a_{m^2},\dots,a_1]$ tends to $[0;\omega]$ as m tends to infinity, and the complete quotient η_{m^2+1} tends to $[1;1,1,\dots]=\varphi$. Lemma 5.10 therefore shows that $\gamma_{\omega\restriction m}\xrightarrow{m\to\infty}\tau_\omega$ pointwise.

Limits along other words. Let $(t_j)_{j\in\mathbb{N}}$ be a sequence of words that converges to ω, none of which is an initial segment of ω. For each j, let n_j be the length of the longest common initial segment of t_j and ω; since t_j converges to ω, we have $n_j\xrightarrow{j\to\infty}\infty$. To show that $\gamma_{t_j}\xrightarrow{j\to\infty}c_\omega$ pointwise, we write $t_j^\sharp=(\mathsf{w}_1,\dots,\mathsf{w}_k)$, where $k=k_j=|t_j|^2$, and we let $\ell=\ell_j=n_j(n_j+1)+1$. The blocks $\Lambda_1(t_j),\dots,\Lambda_{n_j}(t_j)$ coincide with $\Lambda_1(\omega),\dots,\Lambda_{n_j}(\omega)$, and the next term of $t_j^\sharp$ is the term of index n_j+1 of t_j. Hence $\mathsf{w}_i=a_i$ for $i<\ell$, while w_ℓ and a_ℓ are distinct elements of $\{1,2\}$. Moreover, since $t_j^\sharp$ ends with the terms of t_j in reverse order, the terms $\mathsf{w}_k,\mathsf{w}_{k-1},\dots$ begin with $\omega_1,\dots,\omega_{n_j}$, and $k-\ell\geq(n_j+1)^2-\ell=n_j$. Let $x\in\mathbb{RP}^1$ be distinct from η. The convergents of $[0;\mathsf{w}_1,\dots,\mathsf{w}_k]$ of index at least $\ell-1$ agree with η in their terms of index less than ℓ. By the first fact, the convergents of index $k-1$ and k therefore tend to η as j tends to infinity, while $q_{k-1}/q_k=[0;\mathsf{w}_k,\dots,\mathsf{w}_1]$ tends to $[0;\omega]$. Formula (5.14) then shows that

$\gamma_{t_j}(x) \xrightarrow{j\to\infty} -[0;\omega]$ for every such x. At the point η we write γ_{t_j} as the composite of the map $x \mapsto 1/x$ followed by the maps $x \mapsto 1/(x - \mathsf{w}_i)$, for $i = 1, \dots, k$ in this order, and we apply these $k+1$ factors to η one at a time. The first ℓ factors send η to the complete quotient $\eta_\ell = [a_\ell; a_{\ell+1}, \dots]$ of η, which lies in $(a_\ell, a_\ell + 1)$. The next factor sends η_ℓ to $z_j = 1/(\eta_\ell - \mathsf{w}_\ell)$, which lies in $(\frac{1}{2}, 1)$ if $(a_\ell, \mathsf{w}_\ell) = (2, 1)$ and in $(-\infty, -1)$ if $(a_\ell, \mathsf{w}_\ell) = (1, 2)$; in either case $z_j < 1$. The remaining factors form the inverse of the map $M'(x) = [\mathsf{w}_{\ell+1}; \mathsf{w}_{\ell+2}, \dots, \mathsf{w}_{k-1}, \mathsf{w}_k + 1/x]$, and therefore $\gamma_{t_j}(\eta) = M'^{-1}(z_j)$. Let p'_i/q'_i be the convergents of $[\mathsf{w}_{\ell+1}; \mathsf{w}_{\ell+2}, \dots, \mathsf{w}_k]$, the last of which has index $i = k - \ell - 1 \geq n_j - 1$. Every convergent of index at least 1 has the form $\mathsf{w}_{\ell+1} + 1/y$ with $1 \leq y \leq 3$, since all the partial quotients lie in $\{1, 2\}$. Each of these convergents is therefore at least $\frac{4}{3}$, and the distance from each of them to z_j exceeds $\frac{1}{3}$. The convergents of index $i-1$ and i differ by $1/(q'_{i-1}q'_i) \leq 1/(F_iF_{i+1})$, and $q'_{i-1}/q'_i = [0; \mathsf{w}_k, \dots, \mathsf{w}_{\ell+2}]$ tends to $[0;\omega]$, since the first $n_j - 1$ partial quotients of this continued fraction after the initial 0 are $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_{n_j-1}$. By (5.14), applied to M', we conclude that $\gamma_{t_j}(\eta) \xrightarrow{j\to\infty} -[0;\omega]$, and hence that $\gamma_{t_j} \xrightarrow{j\to\infty} c_\omega$ pointwise.

The closure. By Corollary 5.12 and Theorem 3.1, the space $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$ is a Rosenthal compactum. Consequently, every point of the closure of $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ that does not belong to $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ is the limit of a sequence (γ_{t_j}) with pairwise distinct words t_j [BFT78, Theorem 3F]. A compactness argument yields a subsequence of (t_j) that converges to some $\omega \in \{1, 2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$. A further subsequence consists either of initial segments of ω or of words that are not initial segments of ω. By the two preceding paragraphs, the corresponding maps converge to τ_ω in the first case and to c_ω in the second. Both kinds of limit occur for every ω, and the closure of $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ is therefore the set described in (i).

The homeomorphism. Identify $\{1, 2\}^{\mathbb{N}}$ with $2^{\mathbb{N}}$ and $\{1, 2\}^{<\mathbb{N}}$ with $2^{<\mathbb{N}}$ by replacing the letters 1 and 2 with 0 and 1. Under this identification, define a map Θ on $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ by $\Theta(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty) = \gamma_t$, $\Theta(\delta_\omega, \omega) = \tau_\omega$ and $\Theta(\mathbf{0}, \omega) = c_\omega$. By the preceding paragraph, the map Θ is surjective. To see that Θ is injective, note first that the constant maps c_ω are pairwise distinct, because distinct sequences ω give distinct numbers $[0;\omega]$. For the same reason, the maps τ_ω are pairwise distinct, and none of them is constant. Neither kind of map is injective, whereas the maps γ_t are homeomorphisms. Finally, the maps γ_t are pairwise distinct, because $t^\sharp$ determines t and the Möbius map M_{w} determines the word w. Indeed, a rational number in $[0, 1]$ has at most two expansions $[0; \mathsf{w}_1, \dots, \mathsf{w}_k]$, whose lengths differ by one. The number $M_{\mathsf{w}}(\infty) = [0; \mathsf{w}_1, \dots, \mathsf{w}_k]$ and the determinant $(-1)^{k+1}$ of a matrix that represents M_{w} therefore determine w. Since $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ is first countable, the continuity of Θ may be tested on sequences. A sequence that converges to a point (δ_ω, ω) consists eventually of this point and of points $(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty)$ with t an initial segment of ω, whose lengths tend to infinity. By the paragraph on limits along initial segments, the image of such a sequence under Θ converges to τ_ω. A sequence that converges to a point $(\mathbf{0}, \omega)$ consists eventually of this point and of points of at most three kinds. Points of the first kind have the form $(\mathbf{0}, \omega')$, and points of the second kind the form $(\delta_{\omega'}, \omega')$, with $\omega' \neq \omega$ and with ω' converging to ω along the sequence. Points of the third kind have the form $(v_t, t^\frown 0^\infty)$, with t converging to ω and eventually not an initial segment of ω. The images of the points of the first kind converge to c_ω because $[0;\omega']$ depends continuously on ω'. The same holds for the images of the points of the third kind, by the paragraph on limits along other

words. For the second kind, observe that the equality $\tau_{\omega'}(x) = -[0;\omega']$ fails at a given point $x \in \mathbb{RP}^1$ only if $\eta(\omega') = x$, which happens for at most one ω'. The images of the points of the second kind therefore converge to c_ω as well. Hence Θ is a continuous bijection of a compact space onto a Hausdorff space, and therefore a homeomorphism, which maps $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ onto $\{\tau_\omega : \omega \in \{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\} \cup \{c_\omega : \omega \in \{1,2\}^{\mathbb{N}}\}$. The set $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ is countable and, as a subset of Γ, has the NIP (see Corollary 5.12). The closure of $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$, a copy of $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, is first countable but not hereditarily separable (see Section 3.2), and $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ is therefore NIP_1 but not NIP_2.

(ii) We first describe the deep computations that are not computations. For $y, z, w \in \mathbb{RP}^1$, let $\zeta_{y,z,w}$ be the map that sends z to w and every other point to y. Let $\xi \in E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma) \setminus \Gamma$ be given; since $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$ is a Rosenthal compactum, the map ξ is the limit of a sequence $(g_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ of pairwise distinct elements of Γ. Represent each g_n by an integer matrix $\mathbf{G}_n$ with determinant ± 1. Since only finitely many integer matrices have norm below a given bound, the norms $\|\mathbf{G}_n\|$ tend to infinity. Passing to a subsequence, we may assume that the normalized matrices $\mathbf{G}_n/\|\mathbf{G}_n\|$ converge to a matrix $\mathbf{G}$ of norm 1. Since $\det(\mathbf{G}_n/\|\mathbf{G}_n\|) = \pm\|\mathbf{G}_n\|^{-2} \to 0$, the matrix $\mathbf{G}$ has rank one, and $\mathbf{Ge} = \langle \mathbf{e}, \mathbf{e}'\rangle\, \mathbf{e}''$ for all $\mathbf{e} \in \mathbb{R}^2$, for some nonzero vectors $\mathbf{e}', \mathbf{e}'' \in \mathbb{R}^2$. If $x \in \mathbb{RP}^1$ is the line spanned by a vector $\mathbf{e}$ with $\langle \mathbf{e}, \mathbf{e}'\rangle \neq 0$, then $\mathbf{G}_n\mathbf{e}/\|\mathbf{G}_n\| \to \langle \mathbf{e}, \mathbf{e}'\rangle\, \mathbf{e}'' \neq 0$, and $g_n(x)$ converges to the line y spanned by $\mathbf{e}''$. Thus, if z is the line orthogonal to $\mathbf{e}'$ and $w = \xi(z)$, then $\xi = \zeta_{y,z,w}$.

Now let $K \subseteq E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$ be compact and hereditarily separable, and let Z_K be the set of points $z \in \mathbb{RP}^1$ for which some map $\zeta_{y,z,w}$ with $y \neq w$ belongs to K; such a map determines z. Choose, for each $z \in Z_K$, one such map $\zeta_z = \zeta_{y_z,z,w_z} \in K$. We claim that the set $\{\zeta_z : z \in Z_K\}$ is discrete. Indeed, fix a metric d on $\mathbb{RP}^1$ and a point $z \in Z_K$, let $\varepsilon = d(y_z, w_z)/2$, and choose distinct points $x, x' \in \mathbb{RP}^1 \setminus \{z\}$. Consider the neighborhood of ζ_z formed by the maps g with $d(g(z), w_z) < \varepsilon$, $d(g(x), y_z) < \varepsilon$ and $d(g(x'), y_z) < \varepsilon$. Given $z' \in Z_K \setminus \{z\}$, one of the points x and x' differs from z', and we may suppose that x does. Then $\zeta_{z'}(z) = \zeta_{z'}(x) = y_{z'}$, since neither z nor x equals z'. Were $\zeta_{z'}$ in the neighborhood of ζ_z just described, we would have $d(y_z, w_z) \leq d(y_z, y_{z'}) + d(y_{z'}, w_z) < 2\varepsilon$, which is impossible. Since K is hereditarily separable, the discrete set $\{\zeta_z : z \in Z_K\}$ is countable, and so is Z_K. Evaluation at the points of the countable set $Z_K \cup \mathbb{Q}$ separates the members of K. To see this, note first that two members of Γ that agree on the dense set $\mathbb{Q}$ agree everywhere. A member of Γ, moreover, is injective, whereas a map $\zeta_{y,z,w}$ takes the value y at all points of $\mathbb{Q}$ but at most one. Two maps $\zeta_{y,z,w}$ and $\zeta_{y',z',w'}$ with $y \neq y'$ differ at a point of $\mathbb{Q} \setminus \{z, z'\}$. Lastly, let $\zeta_{y,z,w}$ and $\zeta_{y,z',w'}$ be two distinct maps, labelled so that the first satisfies $w \neq y$. These two maps differ at the point $z \in Z_K$, at which the second takes the value y if $z' \neq z$ and the value $w' \neq w$ if $z' = z$. Hence restriction to $Z_K \cup \mathbb{Q}$ is a continuous injection of the compact space K into the metrizable space $(\mathbb{RP}^1)^{Z_K \cup \mathbb{Q}}$, and K is metrizable.

Finally, the split Cantor set $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ is hereditarily separable and not metrizable, and the preceding paragraph therefore excludes a copy of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ from $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$. For $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$, consider the closed subspace formed by the points of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ with first coordinate $\mathbf{0}$; we show that this subspace is hereditarily separable and not metrizable, whence, by the preceding paragraph, neither the subspace nor $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ embeds into $E(\mathbb{RP}^1, \Gamma)$. The projection onto the second coordinate maps the subspace

homeomorphically onto a subspace of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, and the subspace is therefore hereditarily separable. To see that the subspace is not metrizable, let $\varpi \in 2^{\mathbb{N}}$ have infinitely many zeros, and let a be the branch of the subtree $\{s_t : t \in 2^{<\mathbb{N}}\}$ of Section 1.4 that extends the words $s_{\varpi\restriction n}$. Let $u_1, u_2, \dots$ be the words $s_{(\varpi\restriction n)^\frown 1}$ with $\varpi(n) = 0$, listed by increasing n. These words are pairwise incomparable and converge to a, and the sequences $u_k^\frown 0^\infty$ decrease, since the canonical isomorphism preserves the lexicographic order. By the description of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ in Section 1.4, the point $(\mathbf{0}, \chi_{(a})$ belongs to the subspace, and distinct sequences ϖ give distinct branches a; the subspace thus contains uncountably many points of the form $(\mathbf{0}, \chi_{(a})$. In $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, each point $\chi_{(a}$ has the neighborhoods $\{\chi_{(a}\} \cup \{\chi_{[x}, \chi_{(x} : a < x < b\}$, for $b > a$, and the argument of Lemma 5.6 shows that a metrizable subspace of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ contains only countably many of the points $\chi_{(a}$. The image of the subspace under the projection onto the second coordinate contains uncountably many such points, and the subspace is therefore not metrizable. □

Together with Corollary 5.12, Proposition 5.13 shows that the space of deep computations of the Euclidean CCS contains copies of $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ and of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, but no copy of $S(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ or of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$. At the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2, the set $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ thus realizes the alternative of Todorčević's trichotomy opposite to the one realized by the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm (see Theorem 5.8). The two alternatives are drawn side by side in Figure 8.

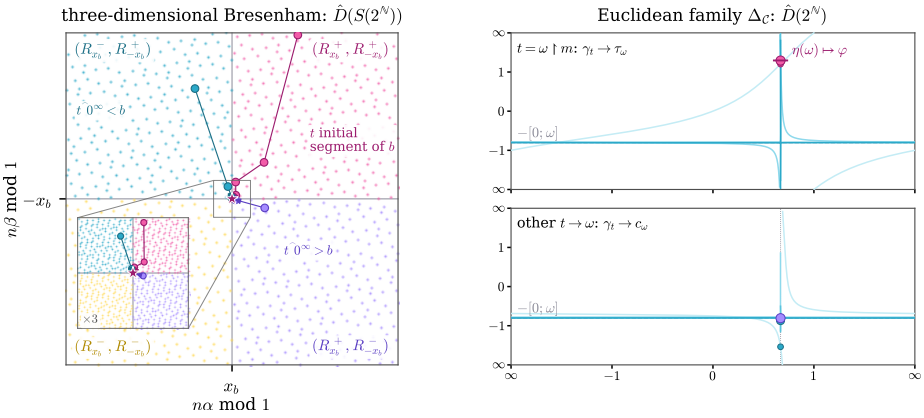


FIGURE 8. Case (ii) of Todorčević's trichotomy, realized in two ways (see Theorem 3.3): by the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm (left) and by the Möbius maps γ_t of Proposition 5.13 on the projective line (right).

Free reduction. A second example at the level NIP but not NIP_1 is the free group F_2 on two generators a, b, acting on its boundary ∂F_2. This boundary, a Cantor set, is the space of infinite reduced words in a, a^{-1}, b, b^{-1}. A generator acts on an infinite word by prepending a letter and cancelling it against the first letter of the word if the two letters are inverse, as a stack does. With the predicates $w \mapsto [\![w_n = x]\!]$, for $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and each letter x, the boundary ∂F_2 and the action of F_2 form a dynamical CCS. Glasner and Megrelishvili proved that this system is tame

but not tame$_1$ [GM22, Corollary 6.6 and Example 6.7]. By Proposition 5.1, this CCS is therefore NIP but not NIP$_1$.

An open question. Both examples at this level are actions of groups with two generators. Whether a single map can reach this level, that is, whether some cascade CCS is NIP but not NIP$_1$, is Question 7.2, after which we recall the corresponding question of Glasner and Megrelishvili for actions of abelian groups.

5.6. **Beyond NIP.** Chaotic iteration leads beyond the hierarchy, to sets of computations with the independence property: for some feature and on suitable inputs, such computations realize every finite pattern of high and low values. We close the section with examples of this phenomenon: Newton's method on the Riemann sphere and, more generally, every rational map of degree at least 2 on the Riemann sphere, the doubling map of the circle, and the logistic map beyond the Feigenbaum parameter. A last example of a different nature, the shift on the Thue–Morse subshift, arises from a substitution rule.

Newton's method on the Riemann sphere. For a complex polynomial with at least two distinct roots, the Newton map is a rational map of degree at least 2, chaotic on the Julia set of the Newton map, and the chaos is visible to the predicates of the CCS. We exhibit the independence in the simplest case, the square roots of 1.

Proposition 5.15. *Let $p(z) = z^2 - 1$, let $N(z) = \frac{1}{2}\big(z + \frac{1}{z}\big)$ be the Newton map of p on $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$, and let P_2 be the second coordinate of the inverse stereographic projection $\hat{\mathbb{C}} \to S^2$ of Section 4. The functions $P_2 \circ N^{3k}$, $k \in \mathbb{N}$, form an independent sequence: for all finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ there is $z \in \hat{\mathbb{C}}$ with $P_2(N^{3k}z) \geq \frac{1}{2}$ for $k \in I$ and $P_2(N^{3k}z) \leq -\frac{1}{2}$ for $k \in J$. In particular, the Newton CCS of p is not NIP.*

Proof. The Möbius transformation $\psi(z) = (z-1)/(z+1)$ conjugates N to the squaring map: $\psi(N(z)) = \psi(z)^2$. The map ψ sends the imaginary axis, together with ∞, onto the unit circle, with $\psi^{-1}(e^{i\theta}) = i\cot(\theta/2)$. Hence, for $z = i\cot(\theta/2)$, we have $N^n(z) = i\cot(2^n\theta/2)$ and

$$P_2\big(N^n(z)\big) = \frac{2\cot(2^{n-1}\theta)}{\cot^2(2^{n-1}\theta) + 1} = \sin(2^n\theta).$$

Writing $\theta = 2\pi \sum_{j \geq 1} x_j 2^{-j}$ with bits x_j, we find that the fractional part of $2^{3k}\theta/2\pi$ has binary expansion $0.x_{3k+1}x_{3k+2}x_{3k+3}\cdots$. If $(x_{3k+1}, x_{3k+2}, x_{3k+3}) = (0,1,0)$, this fractional part lies in $[\frac{1}{4}, \frac{3}{8}]$, and hence $\sin(2^{3k}\theta) \geq \sin\frac{3\pi}{4} > \frac{1}{2}$. If the block is $(1,1,0)$, the fractional part lies in $[\frac{3}{4}, \frac{7}{8}]$, whence $\sin(2^{3k}\theta) < -\frac{1}{2}$. Choosing the block $(0,1,0)$ for $k \in I$ and $(1,1,0)$ for $k \in J$ gives the required z. □

The proof also shows that the doubling map $x \mapsto 2x$ of the circle $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$, with the predicates $\cos 2\pi x$ and $\sin 2\pi x$, is not NIP: with $x = \theta/2\pi$, the functions $\sin(2\pi\, 2^{3k}x)$, $k \in \mathbb{N}$, form an independent sequence. The doubling map shifts the binary digits of x, and the independence comes from the freedom to choose these digits.

On the real projective line, by contrast, the same algorithm is tame. The Julia set of N, the imaginary axis together with ∞, meets $\mathbb{RP}^1$ only at ∞, and on $\mathbb{RP}^1$ the iterates of N converge to the deep computation of Section 4.3 for $a = 1$. By Proposition 5.2, the corresponding CCS is therefore NIP$_3$ (see Section 5.2). Whether Newton's method is tame is thus decided by the space of states on which the method acts, and not by the formula that defines a step of the method.

Rational maps of the sphere. The chaos exhibited in Proposition 5.15 is not peculiar to the square roots of 1. Chaos of this kind, and with it the independence property, is present on the Julia set of every rational map of degree at least 2. The proof of Proposition 5.16 below rests on two classical facts [Mil06, Sections 4 and 14] about the Julia set $\mathcal{J}_g$ of such a map g (see Section 4). The first is that $\mathcal{J}_g$ is a nonempty compact set without isolated points that satisfies $g^{-1}(\mathcal{J}_g) = \mathcal{J}_g$. The second is that, for every neighborhood U of a point of $\mathcal{J}_g$, the image $g^m(U)$ contains $\mathcal{J}_g$ for all sufficiently large m. This second fact is a consequence of Montel's theorem and of the density of repelling cycles in $\mathcal{J}_g$.

Proposition 5.16. *Let $g\colon \hat{\mathbb{C}} \to \hat{\mathbb{C}}$ be a rational map of degree at least 2, and consider the CCS with states $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$, the predicates P_1, P_2, P_3 of Section 4, and the semigroup of iterates of g. There are $j \in \{1,2,3\}$, a positive integer n and reals $a < b$ such that the functions $P_j \circ g^{nk}$, $k \in \mathbb{N}$, form an independent sequence: for all finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ there is $z \in \hat{\mathbb{C}}$ with $P_j(g^{nk}(z)) \le a$ for $k \in I$ and $P_j(g^{nk}(z)) \ge b$ for $k \in J$. In particular, the CCS is not NIP, and neither are the Newton CCSs for $q(z) = z^3 - 2z + 2$ and for $u(z) = z^3 - 1$.*

Proof. Since $\mathcal{J}_g$ has no isolated points and the map $z \mapsto (P_1(z), P_2(z), P_3(z))$ is injective, we may choose distinct points $z_0, z_1 \in \mathcal{J}_g$ and an index j with $P_j(z_0) \neq P_j(z_1)$, say $P_j(z_0) < P_j(z_1)$, and reals $a < b$ strictly between these two values. By continuity, the points z_0 and z_1 have closed neighborhoods U_0 and U_1 such that $P_j \le a$ on U_0 and $P_j \ge b$ on U_1, and we may choose n with $g^n(U_0) \supseteq \mathcal{J}_g$ and $g^n(U_1) \supseteq \mathcal{J}_g$. Let $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be finite and disjoint, and let m exceed all their elements. For $k \le m$, let $U^{(k)}$ be U_0 if $k \in I$ and U_1 otherwise. Let $C_m = U^{(m)} \cap \mathcal{J}_g$ and, for $k = m-1, \dots, 0$, let $C_k = U^{(k)} \cap \mathcal{J}_g \cap g^{-n}(C_{k+1})$. Each C_k is nonempty: since $g^n(U^{(k)}) \supseteq \mathcal{J}_g \supseteq C_{k+1}$, some point of $U^{(k)}$ is mapped by g^n into C_{k+1}, and that point lies in $\mathcal{J}_g$ because $g^{-1}(\mathcal{J}_g) = \mathcal{J}_g$. Every $z \in C_0$ satisfies $g^{nk}(z) \in U^{(k)}$ for $k \le m$, and hence $P_j(g^{nk}(z)) \le a$ for $k \in I$ and $P_j(g^{nk}(z)) \ge b$ for $k \in J$. For the last assertion, note that the Newton maps $N_q(z) = (2z^3 - 2)/(3z^2 - 2)$ and $N_u(z) = (2z^3 + 1)/(3z^2)$ of Section 4 have degree 3, since in each quotient the numerator and the denominator have no common zero. □

The logistic map at $r = 4$. The doubling map also governs the logistic map $f_4(x) = 4x(1-x)$ of Section 5.2, as Figure 9 illustrates.

Proposition 5.17. *The functions f_4^{3k}, $k \in \mathbb{N}$, form an independent sequence on $[0,1]$: for all finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ there is $x \in [0,1]$ with $f_4^{3k}(x) \ge \frac{3}{4}$ for $k \in I$ and $f_4^{3k}(x) \le \frac{1}{4}$ for $k \in J$. In particular, the logistic CCS for $r = 4$ is not NIP.*

Proof. Let $h(\theta) = \sin^2(\theta/2)$ for $\theta \in \mathbb{R}$, and note the identity $f_4(h(\theta)) = 4\sin^2(\theta/2)\cos^2(\theta/2) = \sin^2\theta = h(2\theta)$. Iterated, this identity yields $f_4^n(h(\theta)) = h(2^n\theta) = \sin^2(2^{n-1}\theta)$. Writing $\theta = 2\pi\sum_{j\ge1} x_j 2^{-j}$ with bits x_j, we find that the fractional part of $2^{3k}\theta/2\pi$ has binary expansion $0.x_{3k+1}x_{3k+2}x_{3k+3}\cdots$. Moreover, the angle $2^{3k-1}\theta$ differs from π times this fractional part by an integer multiple of π. If $(x_{3k+1}, x_{3k+2}, x_{3k+3}) = (0,1,1)$, this fractional part lies in $[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{1}{2}]$, and hence $f_4^{3k}(h(\theta)) = \sin^2(2^{3k-1}\theta) \ge \sin^2\frac{3\pi}{8} > \frac{3}{4}$. If the block is $(0,0,0)$, the fractional part lies in $[0, \frac{1}{8}]$, whence $f_4^{3k}(h(\theta)) \le \sin^2\frac{\pi}{8} < \frac{1}{4}$. Choosing the block $(0,1,1)$ for $k \in I$ and $(0,0,0)$ for $k \in J$, we obtain the required point $x = h(\theta)$. □

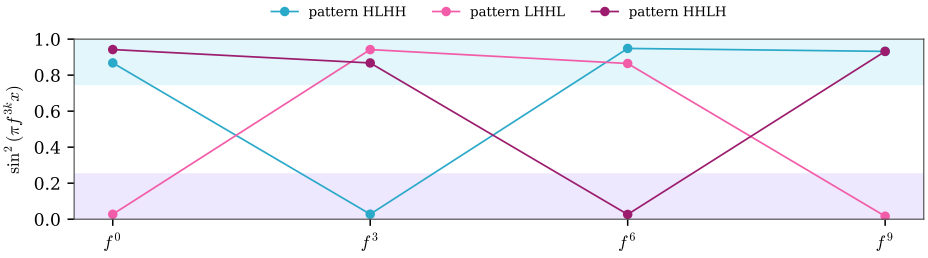


FIGURE 9. Independence for the doubling map $x \mapsto 2x$ of the circle and for the logistic map f_4: along an orbit of the doubling map, the values of $\sin^2(\pi x)$ at the times $0, 3, 6, 9$ follow any prescribed pattern of high (H, at least 3/4) and low (L, at most 1/4) values.

Thus the logistic family, which is stable for $0 < r \leq 1$ and NIP_3 but not stable for $1 < r \leq 3$ (see Proposition 5.4), lies outside the hierarchy at $r = 4$. The exit takes place at the Feigenbaum parameter $r_\infty \approx 3.5699$, the limit of the cascade of period doublings, and the family skips the intermediate levels. In the arguments below, the parameter r_∞ appears as the supremum of the parameters $r \in (0, 4]$ for which the period of every periodic point of f_r is a power of 2. Indeed, in Proposition 5.18 below we show that the family remains NIP_3 below r_∞ and has the independence property beyond r_∞, periodic windows included. Moreover, in Remark 5.19 we sketch the argument that the family is still NIP_3 at r_∞. The arguments rest on the kneading theory of Milnor and Thurston [MT88] and on the theory of interval maps all of whose periodic points have periods that are powers of 2 [BC92, dMvS93].

Proposition 5.18. *(i) For $3 < r < r_\infty$, the logistic CCS is NIP_3 but not stable.*
(ii) For $r_\infty < r \leq 4$, there are a positive integer n and reals $a < b$ such that the functions f_r^{nk}, $k \in \mathbb{N}$, form an independent sequence: for all finite disjoint sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ there is $x \in [0, 1]$ with $f_r^{nk}(x) \leq a$ for $k \in I$ and $f_r^{nk}(x) \geq b$ for $k \in J$. In particular, the logistic CCS is not NIP.

Proof. Writing f for f_r, we use three classical facts [MT88, BC92, dMvS93]. First, by the monotonicity of the kneading invariant in the logistic family, the period of every periodic point of f is a power of 2 if and only if $r \leq r_\infty$. Moreover, for $r < r_\infty$ only finitely many periods occur, whence f has only finitely many periodic points. Second, for $2 < r < 4$, every limit point of an orbit that starts in $(0, 1)$ lies in the interval $[f^2(\frac{1}{2}), f(\frac{1}{2})]$, which does not contain 0. Third, a continuous map of a compact interval with only finitely many periodic points has every orbit asymptotic to a periodic orbit [BC92].

(i) Suppose that $3 < r < r_\infty$, and let 2^s be the largest period of the periodic points of f; since all these periods are powers of 2, each of them divides 2^s. If the orbit of x is asymptotic to the periodic orbit $\mathcal{Q}$, then the sequence $(f^{2^s k}(x))_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ converges to a point of $\mathcal{Q}$. Indeed, the map f^{2^s} fixes $\mathcal{Q}$ pointwise, and by uniform continuity the point of $\mathcal{Q}$ nearest to $f^i(x)$ is eventually carried by f to the point of $\mathcal{Q}$ nearest to $f^{i+1}(x)$. Let $\ell_r(x)$ be the limit of the sequence $(f^{2^s k}(x))_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$. Then $f^{2^s k + i} \xrightarrow{k \to \infty} f^i \circ \ell_r$ pointwise for $0 \leq i < 2^s$, and every limit of the iterates along a nonprincipal ultrafilter on $\mathbb{N}$ is one of these 2^s maps. Each of the maps $f^i \circ \ell_r$ is of

Baire class 1, being the pointwise limit of a sequence of iterates. Hence $E([0,1],f)$ is countable and therefore metrizable, and by Proposition 5.1 the CCS is NIP_3. The map ℓ_r, which fixes 0 and maps $(0,1)$ into the interval $[f^2(\frac{1}{2}), f(\frac{1}{2})]$, is thus discontinuous at 0, and the CCS is not stable.

(ii) Suppose that $r_\infty < r \leq 4$; by the first fact, the map f then has a periodic point whose period is not a power of 2. Hence, by a theorem of Block and Coppel [BC92, Chapter II], some iterate f^n is strictly turbulent. Strict turbulence of f^n means that there are disjoint closed intervals H_0 and H_1, with H_0 to the left of H_1, such that $f^n(H_0)$ and $f^n(H_1)$ both contain $H_0 \cup H_1$. Let $a = \max H_0$ and $b = \min H_1$, let $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be finite and disjoint, and let m exceed all their elements. For $k \leq m$, let $H^{(k)}$ be H_0 if $k \in I$ and H_1 otherwise. Let $C_m = H^{(m)}$ and, for $k = m-1, \ldots, 0$, let $C_k = H^{(k)} \cap f^{-n}(C_{k+1})$. Each set C_k is nonempty, since $f^n(H^{(k)}) \supseteq C_{k+1}$. Every $x \in C_0$ satisfies $f^{nk}(x) \in H^{(k)}$ for $k \leq m$, and hence $f^{nk}(x) \leq a$ for $k \in I$ and $f^{nk}(x) \geq b$ for $k \in J$. □

Remark 5.19. At the Feigenbaum parameter itself the logistic CCS is again NIP_3 but not stable; we sketch the argument, which rests on the structure of infinitely renormalizable maps [BC92, dMvS93]. For $r = r_\infty$ and every $m \in \mathbb{N}$, the map $f = f_r$ has a cycle of 2^m pairwise disjoint closed intervals, permuted cyclically by f and contained in the intervals of the cycle of level $m-1$. Moreover, the lengths of the intervals of level m tend to 0 as m tends to infinity. Finally, every orbit that starts in $(0,1)$ either lands on a periodic orbit or enters the cycle of every level. Label the intervals of the cycle of level m by the residues modulo 2^m, in such a way that f adds 1 to the label. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be a nonprincipal ultrafilter on $\mathbb{N}$, and let ς be the limit of n along $\mathcal{U}$ in the ring $\mathbb{Z}_2$ of 2-adic integers. If the orbit of x lands on a periodic orbit, of period 2^m, then $f^n(x)$ is eventually determined by the residue of n modulo 2^m. Otherwise, for each m, the point $f^n(x)$ eventually lies in the interval of level m whose label differs from n by a certain residue modulo 2^m. This residue depends on x and m but not on n, and the intervals obtained for successive m shrink to a point. In either case, the points $f^n(x)$ converge along $\mathcal{U}$ to a limit $\ell^\varsigma(x)$ that depends only on ς. The map ℓ^ς is the pointwise limit of the iterates f^{n_j} along any sequence of natural numbers n_j that tends to infinity and converges to ς in $\mathbb{Z}_2$. Each map ℓ^ς is therefore of Baire class 1. Hence $E([0,1],f)$ consists of the iterates and the maps ℓ^ς, $\varsigma \in \mathbb{Z}_2$. The rational points of $[0,1]$ separate the members of $E([0,1],f)$: distinct iterates are continuous and differ at a rational point. Moreover, an iterate f^n and a map ℓ^ς differ at every rational point $x > 0$ so small that $f^n(x) < f^2(\frac{1}{2})$, since ℓ^ς maps $(0,1)$ into $[f^2(\frac{1}{2}), f(\frac{1}{2})]$. Finally, two maps ℓ^ς and $\ell^{\varsigma'}$ with $\varsigma \neq \varsigma'$ differ at $\frac{1}{2}$, whose orbit lands on no periodic orbit. Indeed, whenever $\varsigma \not\equiv \varsigma'$ modulo 2^m, the points $\ell^\varsigma(\frac{1}{2})$ and $\ell^{\varsigma'}(\frac{1}{2})$ lie in distinct intervals of level m. As in the proof of Proposition 3.4(i), the space $E([0,1],f)$ is therefore metrizable, and by Proposition 5.1 the CCS is NIP_3. The CCS is not stable, since each map ℓ^ς fixes 0 and is discontinuous there.

The Thue–Morse sequence. The last example of the section comes from a sequence produced by a substitution rule. The Thue–Morse sequence $(t_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$, in which t_n is the parity of the number of ones in the binary expansion of n, is the limit of the words obtained from 0 by the substitution $0 \mapsto 01$, $1 \mapsto 10$. The two-sided sequences all of whose finite blocks occur in (t_n) form the Thue–Morse

subshift $X_{TM} \subseteq 2^{\mathbb{Z}}$, on which the shift σ is a homeomorphism. Glasner and Megrelishvili observed that the Morse minimal system, which consists of the subshift X_{TM} and the action of $\mathbb{Z}$ generated by σ, is not tame [GM18]. In Appendix A we give a proof that is self-contained except for the structure theorem for tame minimal systems. We derive there that the CCS with states X_{TM}, the coordinate predicates and the group $\{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is not NIP, and that neither is the cascade CCS of σ, whose computations are only the iterates σ^n with $n \in \mathbb{N}$ (see Proposition A.1). For the cascade, the argument rests on the reversal of two-sided sequences, which maps X_{TM} onto itself and conjugates σ to σ^{-1}.

5.7. **Summary.** Table 2 collects the examples of this section. The Euclidean algorithm and free reduction are actions of groups with two generators, and the family $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ consists of elements of the first of these groups. Each of the remaining entries of the table is a single map iterated.

6. Randomized versions of NIP and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations

Replacing topology by measure, we dispense in this section with the countability of the set $\mathcal{P}$ of predicates. In Sections 3–5 we studied deep computations as *topological* limits of computations: for countable $\mathcal{P}$ and under the NIP, we showed that the restrictions of ultracomputations to the type shards are of the first Baire class, and that each of these restrictions is the pointwise limit of a sequence of extended computations on the type shard in question. That theory rests on the type shards being Polish, and hence on the countability of $\mathcal{P}$, which enters the proof of Theorem 3.1. In place of membership in the first Baire class, we now ask that a deep computation have an extension that is *universally measurable* on the type shards, that is, measurable with respect to every Radon probability measure on each type shard; by Luzin's theorem and the Stone–Weierstrass theorem, the output features of such an extension are then uniform limits of polynomials in the input features outside sets of arbitrarily small measure. We call such a deep computation *universally Monte Carlo computable* (see Definition 6.6). The role of the Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand theorem (see Theorem 1.4) is then taken by the measure-theoretic form of the theorem (see Theorem 6.5). The role of NIP is shared with *Talagrand stability*, a measure-theoretic condition due to Talagrand (see Definition 6.9).

The first main result of the section, Theorem 6.7, characterizes the NIP by the universal measurability of the restrictions of ultracomputations to the type shards. The theorem derives Monte Carlo computability from the NIP thus characterized; the second main result, Corollary 6.15, derives the same conclusion from universal Talagrand stability. By Theorem 6.18, these two hypotheses, the NIP and universal Talagrand stability, coincide for countable sets of computations (see Corollary 6.19).

6.1. **NIP and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations.** Of the two routes to universal Monte Carlo computability followed in this section, the first starts from the NIP and passes through universal measurability, which we introduce here. Universal measurability is the measure-theoretic counterpart of membership in the first Baire class. This first route leads to Theorem 6.7, by which the deep computations of a confined set of computations with the NIP on shards and features are universally Monte Carlo computable. By Fact 1.2, a function $f\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ on a

Level	Computation	Deep computations; source
stable	rotation of the circle	the circle group
	logistic map, $0 < r \leq 1$	iterates and one continuous limit; Prop. 5.4
NIP_3, not stable	power method	countable; Prop. 5.3
	Newton's method for $x^2 - a$ on $\mathbb{RP}^1$	countable; Prop. 5.2
	logistic map, $1 < r \leq r_\infty$	countable for $r < r_\infty$, metrizable for $r = r_\infty$; Props. 5.4, 5.18, Rem. 5.19
NIP_2, not NIP_3	Bresenham, plane (Sturmian shift)	isolated iterates and a double arrow circle; Thm. 5.5
NIP_1, not NIP_2	Bresenham, space (two Sturmian shifts)	isolated iterates and a copy of $\mathbb{D} \times \mathbb{D}$; contains $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$, not $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$; Thm. 5.8
	the family $\Delta_{\mathfrak{C}}$ in $\mathrm{PGL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$	a copy of $\hat{D}(2^{\mathbb{N}})$; Prop. 5.13
	a single map, with $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$	open; Question 7.3
NIP, not NIP_1	Euclidean algorithm: $\mathrm{PGL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ on $\mathbb{RP}^1$ (group)	contains $A(2^{\mathbb{N}})$, of exact equality tests, and $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$; Cor. 5.12, Prop. 5.13
	free reduction: F_2 on ∂F_2 (group)	not first countable; [GM22]
	a single map	open; Question 7.2
not NIP	doubling map of the circle	Prop. 5.15
	Newton's method for $z^2 - 1$ on $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$	Prop. 5.15
	Newton's method for q and u on $\hat{\mathbb{C}}$	Prop. 5.16
	logistic map, $r_\infty < r \leq 4$	Props. 5.17, 5.18
	Thue–Morse shift	Prop. A.1

TABLE 2. Computations at each level of the hierarchy and beyond it, with the cases left open.

perfectly normal space X is of Baire class 1 if and only if $f^{-1}[U]$ is an F_σ subset of X for every open $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. The following definition replaces the F_σ condition by measurability with respect to every Radon measure.

Definition 6.1. Let X be a Hausdorff space, and let (Y, Σ) be a measurable space. A map $f : X \to Y$ is *universally measurable* (with respect to Σ) if $f^{-1}(E)$ is μ-measurable for every Radon measure μ on X and every $E \in \Sigma$.

When $Y = \mathbb{R}$, we always take for Σ the Borel σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R})$ of $\mathbb{R}$. If X is a compact Hausdorff space, then Radon measures on X are finite, and every nonzero Radon measure on X becomes a probability measure after normalization. Moreover, the sets $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ whose preimages under a given function are μ-measurable

form a σ-algebra, and a σ-algebra that contains the open sets contains all Borel sets. Together, these two observations yield the following simplification of Definition 6.1 for compact spaces.

Remark 6.2. If X is compact, then a function $f : X \to \mathbb{R}$ is universally measurable if and only if $f^{-1}(U)$ is μ-measurable for every Radon probability measure μ on X and every open set $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$.

An account of universally measurable sets and functions may be found in the *Handbook of measure theory* [Pap02, Chapters 1 and 2].

Notation 6.3. Following Bourgain, Fremlin and Talagrand [BFT78], we denote by $M_r(X)$ the collection of all universally measurable real-valued functions on X. For a Radon measure μ on X, we further denote by $\mathscr{M}^0(X, \mu)$ the collection of all μ-measurable real-valued functions on X.

The maps that arise in the study of deep computations, transitions and deep computations themselves among them, send a state space $L \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ into $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$. The product space $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ carries two natural σ-algebras: the Borel σ-algebra, generated by the open subsets of $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$, and the cylinder σ-algebra. The latter, generated by the subbasic open sets $\pi_P^{-1}(U)$ with $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ open, is in general strictly smaller than the Borel σ-algebra, but the two σ-algebras coincide when $\mathcal{P}$ is countable. We use the cylinder σ-algebra to define universally measurable maps into $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$, because of the following characterization.

Proposition 6.4. *Let X be a Hausdorff space and $Y = \prod_{i \in I} Y_i$ be any product of measurable spaces (Y_i, Σ_i) for $i \in I$. Let Σ_Y be the cylinder σ-algebra generated by the measurable spaces (Y_i, Σ_i), and let $\pi_i \colon Y \to Y_i$ be the projections. The following are equivalent for $f : X \to Y$:*

(i) The map $f : X \to Y$ is universally measurable (with respect to Σ_Y).
(ii) The map $\pi_i \circ f : X \to Y_i$ is universally measurable (with respect to Σ_i) for all $i \in I$.

Proof. The implication (i)⇒(ii) holds because each projection π_i is measurable and $(\pi_i \circ f)^{-1}(E) = f^{-1}(\pi_i^{-1}(E))$ for every $E \in \Sigma_i$. To prove (ii)⇒(i), fix a Radon measure μ on X, and note that the sets $C \subseteq Y$ for which $f^{-1}(C)$ is μ-measurable form a σ-algebra. This σ-algebra contains every measurable cylinder $C = \prod_{i \in I} C_i$: if J is the finite set of indices $i \in I$ with $C_i \neq Y_i$, then $f^{-1}(C) = \bigcap_{i \in J} (\pi_i \circ f)^{-1}(C_i)$ is μ-measurable by (ii). Since the measurable cylinders generate Σ_Y, the set $f^{-1}(C)$ is μ-measurable for every $C \in \Sigma_Y$. □

By Proposition 6.4, the universal measurability of a map into $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ can be checked feature by feature, just as membership in the first Baire class can (see Proposition 1.8).

We saw in Section 1 that the NIP corresponds to relative compactness in the space of functions of Baire class 1 (see Theorems 1.4, 1.6 and 1.9). In Section 3 we saw, moreover, that this correspondence extends to deep computations when the set $\mathcal{P}$ of predicates is countable (see Theorem 3.1). The following theorem, which holds on every Hausdorff space, characterizes the NIP in terms of universal measurability. Applied to the type shards, the theorem therefore requires no countability of $\mathcal{P}$.

Theorem 6.5 (Bourgain–Fremlin–Talagrand [BFT78, Theorem 2F])**.** *Let X be a Hausdorff space, and let $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ be pointwise bounded. The following are equivalent:*

(i) The closure $\overline{A}$ is contained in $M_r(X)$.
(ii) For every compact $K \subseteq X$, the restriction $A|_K$ satisfies the NIP.
(iii) For every Radon measure μ on X, the set A is relatively countably compact in $\mathscr{M}^0(X,\mu)$.

In condition (iii), relative countable compactness of A in $\mathscr{M}^0(X,\mu)$ means that every countable subset of A has a limit point in $\mathscr{M}^0(X,\mu)$. Theorem 6.5 leads to a measure-theoretic counterpart of computability, the universal Monte Carlo computability of Definition 6.6 below, whose motivation lies in two classical facts.

(1) Littlewood's second principle, that every Lebesgue measurable function is "nearly continuous", is made precise by Luzin's theorem. Let (X,Σ,μ) be a finite Radon measure space, and let Y be a second-countable topological space (e.g., $Y = \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ with $\mathcal{P}$ countable), equipped with its Borel σ-algebra. Then a function $f\colon X \to Y$ is measurable if and only if, for every $E \in \Sigma$ and every $\varepsilon > 0$, there is a closed set $F \subseteq E$ such that the restriction $f|_F$ is continuous and $\mu(E \setminus F) < \varepsilon$.
(2) Computability of a transform is characterized by continuous extendibility of the transform to the space of types (see Section 2.3); this characterization is at the core of the first paper of this series [ADIW26].

Taken together, the two facts justify Definition 6.6 below. Indeed, suppose that an extension of a transform is universally measurable on a type shard, and fix a Radon probability measure on the shard. By Luzin's theorem, each output feature of the extension is then continuous on a closed subset of the shard whose measure is as close to 1 as desired. On this subset, by the Stone–Weierstrass theorem, the output feature in question is a uniform limit of polynomials in the features.

Definition 6.6. Let $(L,\mathcal{P},\Gamma)$ be a CCS, and let $\mathscr{R}$ be a collection of sizers. A transform $f\colon L \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ is *universally Monte Carlo computable on $\mathscr{R}$* if f has an extension $\tilde{f}\colon \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}} \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ such that, for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, there is a sizer $s_\bullet$ for which the restriction $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}\colon \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \to \mathcal{L}[s_\bullet]$ is universally measurable with respect to the cylinder σ-algebra.

For $P \in \mathcal{P}$, let $\pi_P\colon \mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}} \to \mathbb{R}$ be the projection onto the coordinate P. By Proposition 6.4, the condition in Definition 6.6 is a condition on each feature: for every Radon measure μ on $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ and every $P \in \mathcal{P}$, the map $\pi_P \circ \tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}\colon \mathcal{L}[r_\bullet] \to [-s_P, s_P]$ is required to be μ-measurable. Since each type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ is compact, Remark 6.2 shows that Radon probability measures suffice here, in place of general Radon measures. The deep computations of a set of computations confined by an exhaustive collection of sizers are transforms $L \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ (see Proposition 2.5). As in Lemma 2.7, for a set $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ we denote by $\tilde{\Delta}$ the set of the continuous extensions $\tilde{\gamma}\colon \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}} \to \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{sh}}$ of the computations $\gamma \in \Delta$.

Theorem 6.7. *Let $(L,\mathcal{P},\Gamma)$ be a CCS satisfying the Extendibility Axiom, let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers, and let $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be $\mathscr{R}$-confined. The following are equivalent:*

(i) for all $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and all $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the set $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$ satisfies the NIP;

(ii) for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, every member of $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$ is universally measurable, as a map into $\mathbb{R}^{\mathcal{P}}$ with the cylinder σ-algebra.

If these conditions hold, then every deep computation in $\overline{\Delta}$ is universally Monte Carlo computable on $\mathscr{R}$.

Proof. Fix $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$ and $P \in \mathcal{P}$, and write $K = \overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$, a compact subset of $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]^{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$, and $A_P = \pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$. By the Extendibility Axiom and confinement, the set A_P consists of continuous functions on the compact space $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ and is pointwise bounded. Moreover, since the map $g \mapsto \pi_P \circ g$ is continuous, the closure of A_P is the compact set $\{\pi_P \circ g : g \in K\}$. Assume first that (i) holds; then the restriction of A_P to $L[r_\bullet]$, namely $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$, has the NIP. Since $L[r_\bullet]$ is dense in $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$, Lemma 1.10 shows that the set A_P itself has the NIP, and so does its restriction to every compact subset of $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$. Theorem 6.5 then gives the inclusion $\overline{A_P} \subseteq M_r(\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet])$, that is, every member of $\overline{A_P}$ is universally measurable. Since P is arbitrary, Proposition 6.4 shows that every member of K is universally measurable, and (ii) follows. Conversely, if (ii) holds, then every member of $\overline{A_P}$ is universally measurable by Proposition 6.4. By the implication (i)⇒(ii) of Theorem 6.5, applied to the compact set $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ itself, the set A_P has the NIP. Consequently, so does its restriction $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$, and (i) holds. Finally, let $f \in \overline{\Delta}$, and let $\tilde{f}$ be the extension of Lemma 2.7. For every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the restriction $\tilde{f}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ belongs to $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$, and it is therefore universally measurable when (ii) holds. Since $\tilde{f}$ maps $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$ into itself, the deep computation f satisfies Definition 6.6 with $s_\bullet = r_\bullet$ for every $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$. □

Remark 6.8. Condition (ii) of Theorem 6.7 concerns all the members of the sets $\overline{\tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}}$, that is, the restrictions of ultracomputations to the type shards. By contrast, the equivalence of the theorem fails if (ii) is weakened to the universal Monte Carlo computability of every deep computation, which requires only that some extension be universally measurable. To see this, let $L = \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \subseteq \mathbb{T}$ carry the predicates $\cos 2\pi x$ and $\sin 2\pi x$, and let Γ consist of the iterates of the doubling map $x \mapsto 2x$. The space of types is the circle $\mathbb{T}$, and each computation extends to the continuous map $x \mapsto 2^n x$ of $\mathbb{T}$. Thus the Extendibility Axiom holds, and the single sizer with both bounds equal to 1 forms an exhaustive collection that confines Γ. By the paragraph that follows Proposition 5.15, the iterates of the doubling map of $\mathbb{T}$ do not have the NIP; by Lemma 1.10, neither do their restrictions to the dense set L. Every deep computation $f\colon L \to \mathbb{T}$, however, extends to the map that agrees with f on L and takes the value 0 on $\mathbb{T} \setminus L$. Since L is countable, this extension is Borel, whence every deep computation is universally Monte Carlo computable.

6.2. **Talagrand stability and Monte Carlo computability of deep computations.** The second route to universal Monte Carlo computability starts from Talagrand stability, a notion that Talagrand introduced in his study of Pettis integration [Tal84] and that is closely related to the NIP. We follow this route here and compare the two routes at the end of the subsection. Let X be a compact Hausdorff space, let $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ be a set of functions, and let μ be a Radon probability measure on X. For a μ-measurable set $E \subseteq X$, a positive integer k and real numbers $a < b$, we write the points of E^{2k} as $x = (x_0, \dots, x_{2k-1})$ and define

$$D_k(A, E, a, b) = \bigcup_{f \in A} \{x \in E^{2k} : f(x_{2i}) \le a,\ f(x_{2i+1}) \ge b \ \text{ for all } i < k\}.$$

Definition 6.9. The set A is *Talagrand μ-stable* if, for every μ-measurable set $E \subseteq X$ of positive measure and all reals $a < b$, there is an integer $k \geq 1$ such that

$$(\mu^{2k})^*(D_k(A, E, a, b)) < (\mu(E))^{2k}.$$

The outer measure $(\mu^{2k})^*$ associated with the product measure μ^{2k} on X^{2k} is needed in Definition 6.9 because the set $D_k(A, E, a, b)$ need not be measurable. The set $D_k(A, E, a, b)$ is measurable when A is a countable set of μ-measurable functions, since $D_k(A, E, a, b)$ is then a countable union of measurable sets.

Remarks 6.10. Let X, μ, $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ and $E \subseteq X$ be as above, and let $k \geq 1$ be an integer and $a < b$ be reals. The following hold.

(1) If $A \subseteq B \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$, then

$$D_k(A, E, a, b) \subseteq D_k(B, E, a, b).$$

(2) If $a < a' < b' < b$, then

$$D_k(\overline{A}, E, a, b) \subseteq D_k(A, E, a', b').$$

[*Proof*: If $x \in D_k(\overline{A}, E, a, b)$, then there is $f \in \overline{A}$ such that $f(x_{2i}) \leq a < a'$ and $f(x_{2i+1}) \geq b > b'$ for all $i < k$. By the definition of the topology of pointwise convergence, there is $g \in A$ such that $g(x_{2i}) < a'$ and $g(x_{2i+1}) > b'$ for all $i < k$; hence $x \in D_k(A, E, a', b')$.]

(3) Every subset of a Talagrand μ-stable set is Talagrand μ-stable, by (1).

(4) If A is Talagrand μ-stable, then so is $\overline{A}$, by (2).

In Corollary 6.15 below we consider a confined set Δ of computations such that, for every feature P and every type shard $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$, the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ is Talagrand μ-stable for every Radon probability measure μ on $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$, that is, universally Talagrand stable in the sense of Definition 6.13 below. We show there that the deep computations of every such set are universally Monte Carlo computable. The proof of the corollary rests on Lemma 6.12, by which the pointwise closure of a Talagrand μ-stable set consists of μ-measurable functions. The lemma, in turn, rests on the following characterization of measurable functions (compare Fact 1.2).

Fact 6.11 ([Fre03, Lemma 413G])**.** *Let (X, Σ, μ) be a measure space, and let $\mathcal{K} \subseteq \Sigma$ be a collection of measurable sets such that the following conditions hold:*

- *The measure space (X, Σ, μ) is complete, i.e., for all $E \in \Sigma$ with $\mu(E) = 0$ and $F \subseteq E$ we have $F \in \Sigma$.*
- *The measure space is semi-finite, i.e., for all $E \in \Sigma$ with $\mu(E) = \infty$ there exists $F \subseteq E$ such that $F \in \Sigma$ and $0 < \mu(F) < \infty$.*
- *The measure space is saturated, i.e., a set $E \subseteq X$ belongs to Σ if and only if $E \cap F \in \Sigma$ for all $F \in \Sigma$ with $\mu(F) < \infty$.*
- *The measure space is inner regular with respect to $\mathcal{K}$, i.e., for all $E \in \Sigma$*

$$\mu(E) = \sup\{\mu(K) : K \in \mathcal{K} \text{ and } K \subseteq E\}.$$

Then a function $f\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ is measurable if and only if, for every $K \in \mathcal{K}$ with $0 < \mu(K) < \infty$ and all reals $a < b$, either $\mu^*(K_{\leq a}) < \mu(K)$ or $\mu^*(K_{\geq b}) < \mu(K)$, where $K_{\leq a} = \{x \in K : f(x) \leq a\}$ and $K_{\geq b} = \{x \in K : f(x) \geq b\}$.

The four conditions of Fact 6.11 hold, in particular, when X is a compact Hausdorff space, μ is a Radon probability measure on X, Σ is the completion by μ of the Borel σ-algebra of X, and $\mathcal{K}$ is the collection of compact subsets of X. In this

setting we first show that Talagrand stability passes to the pointwise closure and forces measurability.

Lemma 6.12. *Let X be a compact Hausdorff space, let μ be a Radon probability measure on X, and let $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ be a set of functions. If A is Talagrand μ-stable, then $\overline{A}$ is also Talagrand μ-stable and $\overline{A} \subseteq \mathscr{M}^0(X,\mu)$.*

Proof. By Remarks 6.10, the closure $\overline{A}$ is Talagrand μ-stable, and hence so is $\{f\}$ for every $f \in \overline{A}$. It therefore suffices to show that if $\{f\}$ is Talagrand μ-stable, then f is μ-measurable. Suppose that f is not μ-measurable. Then Fact 6.11 gives a compact set E of positive measure and reals $a < b$ with $\mu^*(E_{\leq a}) = \mu^*(E_{\geq b}) = \mu(E)$, where $E_{\leq a} = \{x \in E : f(x) \leq a\}$ and $E_{\geq b} = \{x \in E : f(x) \geq b\}$. For every $k \geq 1$ we have $(E_{\leq a} \times E_{\geq b})^k \subseteq D_k(\{f\}, E, a, b)$, and this product has outer measure $(\mu(E))^{2k}$ (see [Tal84]); hence $\{f\}$ is not Talagrand μ-stable. □

Definition 6.13. Let X be a compact Hausdorff space. A set $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^X$ is *universally Talagrand stable* if it is Talagrand μ-stable for every Radon probability measure μ on X.

For pointwise bounded sets of continuous functions on a compact space, universal Talagrand stability implies the NIP.

Proposition 6.14. *Let X be a compact Hausdorff space, and let $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ be pointwise bounded. If A is universally Talagrand stable, then A satisfies the NIP.*

Proof. By Lemma 6.12, the closure $\overline{A}$ is contained in $\mathscr{M}^0(X,\mu)$ for every Radon probability measure μ on X, that is, $\overline{A} \subseteq M_r(X)$. By the implication (i)⇒(ii) of Theorem 6.5, applied with $K = X$, the set A satisfies the NIP. □

Corollary 6.15. *Let $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ be a CCS satisfying the Extendibility Axiom, let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers, and let $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be $\mathscr{R}$-confined. If $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ is universally Talagrand stable for all $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and all $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, then every deep computation in $\overline{\Delta}$ is universally Monte Carlo computable on $\mathscr{R}$.*

Proof. Let $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$ be given. By the Extendibility Axiom and confinement, the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ is a pointwise bounded family of continuous functions on the compact space $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$. Proposition 6.14 therefore shows that this set has the NIP, and hence so does its restriction $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$. Theorem 6.7 now completes the proof. □

In the context of deep computations we have thus found two routes to universal Monte Carlo computability, the NIP and universal Talagrand stability, and the second hypothesis implies the first (see Proposition 6.14). For countable sets of measurable functions, the following two results show that the converse implication, from the NIP to universal Talagrand stability, is not decided by the usual axioms of set theory. On the one hand, it is consistent with the Zermelo–Fraenkel axioms of set theory with the axiom of choice (ZFC) that, for such sets, the NIP implies universal Talagrand stability.

Theorem 6.16 (Talagrand [Tal84, Theorem 9-3-1(a)])**.** *Let X be a compact Hausdorff space, and let $A \subseteq M_r(X)$ be countable and pointwise bounded. Assume that $[0,1]$ is not the union of fewer than $2^{\aleph_0}$ closed sets of Lebesgue measure zero. If A satisfies the NIP, then A is universally Talagrand stable.*

(The hypothesis on $[0,1]$ follows, for example, from the Continuum Hypothesis.)

On the other hand, for Lebesgue measure, the failure of this implication is also consistent.

Theorem 6.17 (Fremlin and Shelah [FS93])**.** *It is consistent with ZFC that there exists a countable pointwise bounded set of Lebesgue measurable functions with the NIP that is not Talagrand stable with respect to Lebesgue measure.*

Both results concern countable sets of measurable functions. For countable sets of *continuous* functions on a compact space, by contrast, the NIP implies universal Talagrand stability in ZFC, without any further set-theoretic hypothesis (see Theorem 6.18 below). Consequently, since the Extendibility Axiom makes computations continuous on the type shards, the two routes to universal Monte Carlo computability coincide for countable sets of computations. After a reduction to a compact metrizable space, this implication for countable sets of continuous functions can be derived from two results on the Glivenko–Cantelli property of a family of functions. The Glivenko–Cantelli property is the almost sure convergence of empirical means to expectations, uniformly over the family. The first result is a theorem of van Handel [vH13, Theorem 1.3], which concerns separable, uniformly bounded families of measurable functions on a standard Borel space. According to this theorem, such a family has the Glivenko–Cantelli property for every probability measure if and only if it contains no Boolean σ-independent sequence. The second result is a theorem of Talagrand [Tal87], which identifies, among uniformly bounded families, the Glivenko–Cantelli families for a measure μ with the Talagrand μ-stable ones (see also [Fre03, §465]). We give instead a direct proof, which reduces the question to a compact metrizable space and then applies Fact 1.2 to a cluster point of the reduced family.

Theorem 6.18. *Let X be a compact Hausdorff space, and let $A \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(X)$ be countable and pointwise bounded. If A satisfies the NIP, then A is universally Talagrand stable.*

Proof. Suppose that A satisfies the NIP, and let μ be a Radon probability measure on X. Towards a contradiction, suppose further that A is not Talagrand μ-stable. Then there are a μ-measurable set $E \subseteq X$ of positive measure and reals $a < b$ such that $\mu^{2k}(D_k(A, E, a, b)) = (\mu(E))^{2k}$ for every $k \geq 1$. The sets $D_k(A, E, a, b)$ are measurable, since A is countable and its members are continuous. We first transfer the situation to a compact metrizable space. The map $\Psi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}^A$ given by $\Psi(x) = (f(x))_{f\in A}$ is continuous, and its image $Y = \Psi(X)$ is compact and metrizable because A is countable. Moreover, each $f \in A$ factors as $f = \hat{f} \circ \Psi$, where $\hat{f}\colon Y \to \mathbb{R}$ is the restriction of the coordinate projection. The set $\hat{A} = \{\hat{f} : f \in A\} \subseteq \mathrm{C_p}(Y)$ is pointwise bounded, and it satisfies the NIP, because $Y^{\hat{f}_I}_{\leq a'} \cap Y^{\hat{f}_J}_{\geq b'} = \Psi(X^{f_I}_{\leq a'} \cap X^{f_J}_{\geq b'})$ for every sequence $(f_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ in A, all finite sets $I, J \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ and all reals $a' < b'$. Let ν be the Borel probability measure on Y given by $\nu(B) = \mu(E \cap \Psi^{-1}(B))/\mu(E)$. Since $D_k(A, E, a, b) = E^{2k} \cap (\Psi^{2k})^{-1}(D_k(\hat{A}, Y, a, b))$, where Ψ^{2k} applies Ψ to each coordinate, we obtain $\nu^{2k}(D_k(\hat{A}, Y, a, b)) = 1$ for every $k \geq 1$.

Now consider the product measure $\nu^{\mathbb{N}}$ on $Y^{\mathbb{N}}$, under which the coordinates y_n of a sequence $(y_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ are independent, each with distribution ν. Let Z denote the support of ν, which is a nonempty closed, and hence Polish, subspace of Y.

For each $k \geq 1$, almost every sequence admits some $\hat{f} \in \hat{A}$ with $\hat{f}(y_{2i}) \leq a$ and $\hat{f}(y_{2i+1}) \geq b$ for all $i < k$, since this event has probability $\nu^{2k}(D_k(\hat{A}, Y, a, b)) = 1$. Moreover, since Y has a countable base and every basic open set that meets Z has positive measure, both $\{y_{2i} : i \in \mathbb{N}\}$ and $\{y_{2i+1} : i \in \mathbb{N}\}$ are dense subsets of Z for almost every sequence. Fix a sequence (y_n) with all these properties, and, for each $k \geq 1$, choose $\hat{f}_k \in \hat{A}$ with $\hat{f}_k(y_{2i}) \leq a$ and $\hat{f}_k(y_{2i+1}) \geq b$ for all $i < k$. Since $\hat{A}$ is pointwise bounded, the sequence $(\hat{f}_k)$ has a cluster point g in $\mathbb{R}^Y$, and $g \in \mathrm{B}_1(Y)$ by Theorem 1.6. For every i, the inequalities $\hat{f}_k(y_{2i}) \leq a$ and $\hat{f}_k(y_{2i+1}) \geq b$ hold for all $k > i$, and therefore $g(y_{2i}) \leq a$ and $g(y_{2i+1}) \geq b$. By condition (3) of Fact 1.2, applied to the Polish space Y and its closed subset Z, the restriction $g|_Z$ has a point of continuity z. Every neighborhood of z in Z, however, contains points y_{2i} with $g(y_{2i}) \leq a$ and points y_{2i+1} with $g(y_{2i+1}) \geq b$; this contradicts the continuity of $g|_Z$ at z. □

Corollary 6.19. *Let $(L, \mathcal{P}, \Gamma)$ be a CCS satisfying the Extendibility Axiom, let $\mathscr{R}$ be an exhaustive collection of sizers, and let $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be countable and $\mathscr{R}$-confined. For all $P \in \mathcal{P}$ and $r_\bullet \in \mathscr{R}$, the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ is universally Talagrand stable if and only if $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$ satisfies the NIP.*

Proof. By the Extendibility Axiom and confinement, the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$ is a countable, pointwise bounded family of continuous functions on the compact space $\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]$, in which $L[r_\bullet]$ is dense. If this set is universally Talagrand stable, it has the NIP by Proposition 6.14, and so does its restriction to $L[r_\bullet]$. Conversely, suppose that $\pi_P \circ \Delta|_{L[r_\bullet]}$ has the NIP. By Lemma 1.10, so does the set $\pi_P \circ \tilde{\Delta}|_{\mathcal{L}[r_\bullet]}$, to which Theorem 6.18 therefore applies. □

For countable sets of computations, Theorem 6.18 thus supersedes Theorem 6.16 and its set-theoretic hypothesis. Accordingly, the example of Fremlin and Shelah, a set of measurable functions, has no counterpart among countable sets of computations.

7. Open questions

We close with the questions that remain open, in the order in which they arise from the sections of the paper. The first concerns the hierarchy of Section 3.2, whose levels were defined through the topology of the space of deep computations. Proposition 3.4 describes these levels by the number of tests needed to tell deep computations apart, but the descriptions so obtained still involve infinitely many tests.

Question 7.1. Is there a finitary, combinatorial characterization of NIP_1, NIP_2 and NIP_3, in the spirit of the characterization of NIP by finite patterns in Theorem 3.1?

In Section 5 we place a single iterated map at every level of the hierarchy except one. The exception is the level NIP but not NIP_1, at which both of our examples are actions of groups with two generators (see Section 5.5).

Question 7.2. Is there a cascade CCS that is NIP but not NIP_1? Equivalently, is there a continuous map γ of a compact metrizable space L such that (L, γ) is tame and $E(L, \gamma)$ is not first countable?

For actions of $\mathbb{Z}$, and more generally of abelian groups, the analogous question, whether some tame metrizable system has an enveloping semigroup that is not first countable, is Question 6.8 of Glasner and Megrelishvili [GM22]; to our knowledge, Question 6.8 remains open.

At the level NIP_1 but not NIP_2, the deep computations of the three-dimensional Bresenham algorithm contain a copy of $\hat{D}(S(2^{\mathbb{N}}))$ and none of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$ (see Theorem 5.8). By contrast, the countable family $\Delta_{\mathcal{C}}$ of elements of the group generated by the steps of the Euclidean algorithm realizes the other alternative of Todorčević's trichotomy (see Proposition 5.13).

Question 7.3. Is there a cascade CCS that is NIP_1 but not NIP_2 and whose space of deep computations contains a copy of $D(2^{\mathbb{N}})$?

Appendix A. The Thue–Morse system is not tame

In this appendix we prove that the shift on the Thue–Morse subshift generates an action of $\mathbb{Z}$ that is not tame, a fact observed by Glasner and Megrelishvili [GM18]. From this fact we derive that the two dynamical CCSs defined by the shift, which we use in Section 5.6 as examples beyond the hierarchy, are not NIP. Our proof is self-contained except for the structure theorem for tame minimal systems under actions of abelian groups, due to Huang, to Kerr and Li, and to Glasner. We recall the structure theorem below; an elementary computation of the correlations of the Thue–Morse sequence then shows that the Thue–Morse subshift violates the conclusion of the theorem.

We first recall the objects involved. The Thue–Morse sequence $(t_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ is defined by letting t_n be the parity of the number of ones in the binary expansion of n, whence $t_{2k} = t_k$ and $t_{2k+1} = 1 - t_k$ for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$. The same sequence is the limit of the words W_m, for $m \in \mathbb{N}$, obtained from 0 by m applications of the substitution $0 \mapsto 01$, $1 \mapsto 10$. The two-sided sequences all of whose finite blocks occur in (t_n) form the Thue–Morse subshift $X_{TM} \subseteq 2^{\mathbb{Z}}$, a closed subset of the compact metrizable space $2^{\mathbb{Z}}$. On this subshift the shift σ, defined by $\sigma(x)_n = x_{n+1}$, is a homeomorphism. As in Section 5.1, a system (L, Γ) consists of a compact metrizable space L and a countable semigroup Γ of continuous maps $L \to L$. Such a system is *tame* if for every continuous function $f\colon L \to \mathbb{R}$ the family $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ has the NIP of Definition 1.5. We call a sequence $(f \circ \gamma_k)_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$ of members of the family $\{f \circ \gamma : \gamma \in \Gamma\}$ *independent* if, for some reals $a < b$, the sequence witnesses the finitary independence property of Definition 1.5. Hence the system (L, Γ) is tame exactly when no independent sequence exists. The CCS with states X_{TM}, the coordinate predicates $x \mapsto x_n$ for $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and the group $\{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is a dynamical CCS in the sense of Section 5.1. The cascade CCS of σ, in turn, is the dynamical CCS with the same states and predicates but with the semigroup $\{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$. By Proposition 5.1, each of these two CCSs is NIP if and only if the corresponding dynamical system is tame.

That the dynamics of σ on X_{TM} is wild follows from the structure theory of tame minimal systems under actions of abelian groups. Huang [Hua06] and, independently, Kerr and Li [KL07] proved that every metrizable minimal tame system under an action of an abelian group is uniquely ergodic. Unique ergodicity means that the system carries exactly one invariant Borel probability measure. The same authors proved, in addition, that such a system is an almost one-to-one extension of its maximal equicontinuous factor. Glasner [Gla07] showed, moreover, that

the factor map onto that factor is an isomorphism of measure-preserving systems. For a minimal homeomorphism, the maximal equicontinuous factor is a rotation $y \mapsto y + \alpha$ of a compact abelian group Y in which the multiples of α are dense, equipped with its Haar measure. The characters of Y are eigenfunctions of this rotation and span a dense subspace of the space of square-integrable functions on Y. Consider now a minimal system given by a homeomorphism σ that generates a tame action. The Koopman operator of this system sends each function that is square-integrable with respect to the invariant measure to its composite with σ. By the results just recalled, every such function is a limit in mean square of linear combinations of eigenfunctions of the Koopman operator. The Thue–Morse subshift fails this test, because the correlations of the Thue–Morse sequence are, on average, too small.

Proposition A.1. *Let $X_{TM} \subseteq 2^{\mathbb{Z}}$ be the Thue–Morse subshift, and let σ be the shift on X_{TM}. The action of $\mathbb{Z}$ on X_{TM} generated by σ is not tame. Consequently, neither the CCS with states X_{TM}, the coordinate predicates and the group $\{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ nor the cascade CCS of σ is NIP.*

Proof. We first show that X_{TM} is minimal. Every finite block w of (t_n) occurs in some word W_m. If $\overline{W}_m$ denotes the word obtained from 1 by m applications of the substitution, then the words $W_{m+1} = W_m\overline{W}_m$ and $\overline{W}_{m+1} = \overline{W}_m W_m$ both contain W_m. Moreover, since $t_{2k} = t_k$ and $t_{2k+1} = 1-t_k$, the block of (t_n) of length 2^{m+1} that begins at the index $2^{m+1}j$ is W_{m+1} or $\overline{W}_{m+1}$ according as t_j is 0 or 1. Hence the block w occurs in every block of length 2^{m+2} of (t_n), and therefore in every point of X_{TM}; every orbit of σ is thus dense in X_{TM}.

Suppose now that the action of $\mathbb{Z}$ generated by σ is tame. By the structure theorem recalled above, the subshift X_{TM} carries a unique σ-invariant Borel probability measure μ. The eigenfunctions of the unitary operator V on $L^2(\mu)$ that sends each function to its composite with σ span, by the same theorem, a dense subspace of $L^2(\mu)$. Let $\vartheta(x) = (-1)^{x_0}$ for $x \in X_{TM}$, and let $c(n) = \int \vartheta \cdot (\vartheta \circ \sigma^n)\, d\mu$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$. By minimality and compactness, the subshift X_{TM} contains a point x with $x_j = t_j$ for every $j \geq 0$. Every weak* limit of the measures $\frac{1}{K}\sum_{k<K} \delta_{\sigma^k x}$ is σ-invariant and hence equal to μ, whence

$$c(n) = \lim_{K\to\infty} \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k<K} (-1)^{t_k + t_{k+n}}.$$

Splitting the sum according to the parity of k and using $t_{2k} = t_k$ and $t_{2k+1} = 1 - t_k$, we obtain $c(2n) = c(n)$ and $c(2n+1) = -\frac{1}{2}\big(c(n) + c(n+1)\big)$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and in particular $c(1) = -\frac{1}{3}$. For $K \geq 1$, let $A(K) = \sum_{n<K} c(n)^2$ and $B(K) = \sum_{n<K} c(n)c(n+1)$. For every $K \geq 1$, the recursions yield the identities and inequalities

$$B(2K) = -\tfrac{1}{2} \sum_{n<K} \big(c(n) + c(n+1)\big)^2 \leq 0,$$

$$A(2K) = A(K) + \tfrac{1}{4} \sum_{n<K} \big(c(n) + c(n+1)\big)^2 \leq \tfrac{3}{2}A(K) + \tfrac{1}{2}B(K),$$

where the last inequality follows by expanding the squares, because $c(0) = 1 \geq c(K)^2$. Hence we have $A(4K) \leq \frac{3}{2}A(2K)$ for every $K \geq 1$, and, since $A(2) = 1 + c(1)^2 \leq 2$, it follows that $A(2^k) \leq 2\big(\frac{3}{2}\big)^{k-1}$ for every $k \geq 1$. Since the function A

is nondecreasing, we conclude that $A(K)/K \to 0$ as $K \to \infty$ (see Figure 10). Now let λ be a complex number of modulus 1, and let Π_λ be the orthogonal projection of $L^2(\mu)$ onto the kernel of $V - \lambda I$. This kernel consists of the eigenfunctions of V with eigenvalue λ and the function 0. By von Neumann's mean ergodic theorem, applied to the unitary operator $\bar{\lambda}V$, the averages $\frac{1}{K}\sum_{n<K} \bar{\lambda}^n\, \vartheta \circ \sigma^n$ converge to $\Pi_\lambda \vartheta$ in $L^2(\mu)$. Consequently, since $c(n)$ is the inner product of $\vartheta \circ \sigma^n$ and ϑ, the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality yields

$$\|\Pi_\lambda \vartheta\|^2 = \lim_{K\to\infty} \Big|\frac{1}{K}\sum_{n<K} \bar{\lambda}^n c(n)\Big| \le \lim_{K\to\infty} \Big(\frac{A(K)}{K}\Big)^{1/2} = 0.$$

Thus the function ϑ is orthogonal to every eigenfunction of V, and therefore to every function in $L^2(\mu)$, since these eigenfunctions span a dense subspace of $L^2(\mu)$. This conclusion is absurd, since $|\vartheta| = 1$. The action is therefore not tame, and, by Proposition 5.1, the CCS with the group $\{\sigma^n : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is not NIP.

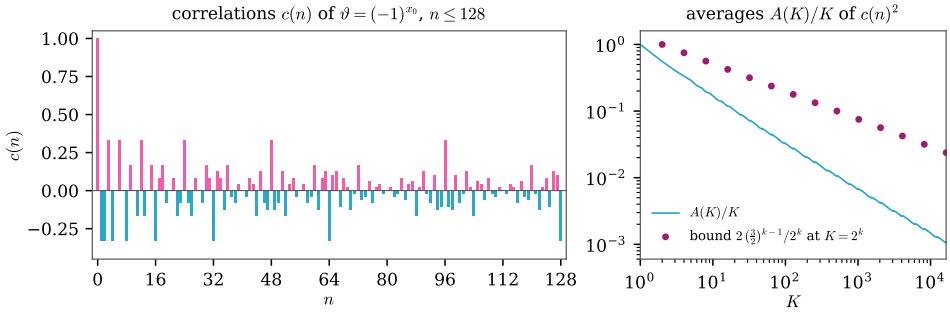


FIGURE 10. The correlations $c(n)$ of the function $\vartheta(x) = (-1)^{x_0}$ on the Thue–Morse subshift for $0 \le n \le 128$ (left), and, on logarithmic scales, the averages $A(K)/K$ for $K \le 2^{14}$, where $A(K) = \sum_{n<K} c(n)^2$, with dots at the bound $2\left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^{k-1}/2^k$ on $A(2^k)/2^k$ (right).

For the cascade CCS of σ, we use a symmetry of the Thue–Morse sequence. The words W_{2m} are palindromes, and every finite block of (t_n) occurs in one of them. Consequently, the reversal ι of two-sided sequences, defined by $\iota(x)_n = x_{-n}$, maps X_{TM} onto itself and satisfies $\iota \circ \sigma = \sigma^{-1} \circ \iota$. Since the action of $\mathbb{Z}$ is not tame, there are a continuous function $f\colon X_{TM} \to \mathbb{R}$ and pairwise distinct integers n_k such that the sequence $(f \circ \sigma^{n_k})_k$ is independent. Moreover, infinitely many of the indices n_k have the same sign. If these indices are positive, the corresponding terms already form an independent sequence in the cascade. If these indices are negative, the functions $f \circ \sigma^{n_k} \circ \iota = (f \circ \iota) \circ \sigma^{-n_k}$ form an independent sequence with positive exponents, because the reversal ι is a bijection of X_{TM}. In either case the cascade of σ is not tame, and, by Proposition 5.1, its CCS is not NIP. □

REFERENCES

[ADIW26] Samson Alva, Eduardo Dueñez, José Iovino, and Claire Walton, *Approximability of deep computations*, Mathematical Structures in Computer Science (2026), To appear; arXiv:2409.06064.

[ADK08] Spiros A. Argyros, Pandelis Dodos, and Vassilis Kanellopoulos, *A classification of separable Rosenthal compacta and its applications*, Dissertationes Mathematicae **449** (2008), 1–55.

[Ark92] A. V. Arkhangel'skii, *Topological function spaces*, Mathematics and its Applications (Soviet Series), vol. 78, Kluwer Academic Publishers Group, Dordrecht, 1992, Translated from the Russian by R. A. M. Hoksbergen. MR 1144519

[Bai99] René Baire, *Sur les fonctions de variables réelles*, Annali di Matematica Pura ed Applicata (3) **3** (1899), 1–123.

[BC92] Louis S. Block and William A. Coppel, *Dynamics in one dimension*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, vol. 1513, Springer, Berlin, 1992.

[BEHW89] Anselm Blumer, Andrzej Ehrenfeucht, David Haussler, and Manfred K. Warmuth, *Learnability and the Vapnik–Chervonenkis dimension*, J. Assoc. Comput. Mach. **36** (1989), no. 4, 929–965.

[BFB16] Richard L. Burden, J. Douglas Faires, and Annette M. Burden, *Numerical analysis*, 10th ed., Cengage Learning, Boston, MA, 2016.

[BFT78] J. Bourgain, D. H. Fremlin, and M. Talagrand, *Pointwise compact sets of Baire-measurable functions*, American Journal of Mathematics **100** (1978), no. 4, 845–886.

[BKK] Shaojie Bai, J. Zico Kolter, and Vladlen Koltun, *Deep equilibrium models*, Preprint. https://arxiv.org/abs/1909.01377, https://implicit-layers-tutorial.org/.

[Bre65] Jack E. Bresenham, *Algorithm for computer control of a digital plotter*, IBM Systems Journal **4** (1965), no. 1, 25–30.

[CRBD] Ricky T. Q. Chen, Yulia Rubanova, Jesse Bettencourt, and David Duvenaud, *Neural ordinary differential equations*, Preprint. https://arxiv.org/abs/1806.07366.

[Deb13] Gabriel Debs, *Descriptive aspects of Rosenthal compacta*, Recent Progress in General Topology III, Springer, 2013, pp. 205–227.

[dMvS93] Welington de Melo and Sebastian van Strien, *One-dimensional dynamics*, Ergebnisse der Mathematik und ihrer Grenzgebiete (3), vol. 25, Springer, Berlin, 1993.

[DnI17] Eduardo Dueñez and José N. Iovino, *Model theory and metric convergence I: Metastability and dominated convergence*, Beyond First Order Model Theory, Volume I, CRC Press, Boca Raton, FL, 2017, pp. 131–187. MR 3729326

[Ell93] Robert Ellis, *The enveloping semigroup of projective flows*, Ergodic Theory and Dynamical Systems **13** (1993), no. 4, 635–660.

[Eng89] Ryszard Engelking, *General topology*, second ed., Sigma Series in Pure Mathematics, vol. 6, Heldermann Verlag, Berlin, 1989, Translated from the Polish by the author. MR MR1039321 (91c:54001)

[Fre03] David H. Fremlin, *Measure theory, volume 4: Topological measure spaces*, Torres Fremlin, Colchester, UK, 2003.

[FS93] David H. Fremlin and Saharon Shelah, *Pointwise compact and stable sets of measurable functions*, Journal of Symbolic Logic **58** (1993), no. 2, 435–455.

[Gal00] A. Galántai, *The theory of Newton's method*, Journal of Computational and Applied Mathematics **124** (2000), no. 1, 25–44, Numerical Analysis 2000. Vol. IV: Optimization and Nonlinear Equations.

[Gla06] Eli Glasner, *On tame dynamical systems*, Colloquium Mathematicum **105** (2006), no. 2, 283–295.

[Gla07] ———, *The structure of tame minimal dynamical systems*, Ergodic Theory and Dynamical Systems **27** (2007), no. 6, 1819–1837.

[GM18] Eli Glasner and Michael Megrelishvili, *More on tame dynamical systems*, Ergodic theory and dynamical systems in their interactions with arithmetics and combinatorics, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, vol. 2213, Springer, Cham, 2018, pp. 351–392. MR 3821724

[GM22] ———, *Todorčević' trichotomy and a hierarchy in the class of tame dynamical systems*, Transactions of the American Mathematical Society **375** (2022), no. 7, 4513–4548.

[God80] Gilles Godefroy, *Compacts de Rosenthal*, Pacific J. Math. **91** (1980), no. 2, 293–306. MR 615679

[Gro52] A. Grothendieck, *Critères de compacité dans les espaces fonctionnels généraux*, Amer. J. Math. **74** (1952), 168–186. MR 47313

[HT19] Haim Horowitz and Stevo Todorcevic, *Compact sets of baire class one functions and maximal almost disjoint families*, 2019.

[Hua06] Wen Huang, *Tame systems and scrambled pairs under an abelian group action*, Ergodic Theory and Dynamical Systems **26** (2006), no. 5, 1549–1567.

[Kec95] Alexander S. Kechris, *Classical descriptive set theory*, Graduate Texts in Mathematics, vol. 156, Springer-Verlag, 1995.

[Kei23] H. Jerome Keisler, *Model theory for real-valued structures*, Beyond First Order Model Theory, Volume II (José Iovino, ed.), CRC Press, Boca Raton, FL, 2023.

[KL07] David Kerr and Hanfeng Li, *Independence in topological and C^*-dynamics*, Mathematische Annalen **338** (2007), no. 4, 869–926.

[KM81] Jean-Louis Krivine and Bernard Maurey, *Espaces de Banach stables*, Israel J. Math. **39** (1981), no. 4, 273–295. MR 83a:46030

[Köh95] Angela Köhler, *Enveloping semigroups for flows*, Proceedings of the Royal Irish Academy. Section A **95A** (1995), no. 2, 179–191.

[Kri72] J.-L. Krivine, *Théorie des modèles et espaces L^p*, C. R. Acad. Sci. Paris Sér. A-B **275** (1972), A1207–A1210. MR 46 #7879

[Kri74] ———, *Langages à valeurs réelles et applications*, Fund. Math. **81** (1974), 213–253, Collection of articles dedicated to Andrzej Mostowski on the occasion of his sixtieth birthday, III. MR 50 #1873

[Leb04] Henri Lebesgue, *Une propriété caractéristique des fonctions de classe 1*, Bulletin de la Société Mathématique de France **32** (1904), 229–242.

[Lot02] M. Lothaire, *Algebraic combinatorics on words*, Encyclopedia of Mathematics and its Applications, vol. 90, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2002.

[MH40] Marston Morse and Gustav A. Hedlund, *Symbolic dynamics II. Sturmian trajectories*, American Journal of Mathematics **62** (1940), 1–42.

[Mil06] John Milnor, *Dynamics in one complex variable*, third ed., Annals of Mathematics Studies, vol. 160, Princeton University Press, Princeton, NJ, 2006.

[MT88] John Milnor and William Thurston, *On iterated maps of the interval*, Dynamical Systems (College Park, MD, 1986–87), Lecture Notes in Mathematics, vol. 1342, Springer, Berlin, 1988, pp. 465–563.

[Pap02] E. Pap (ed.), *Handbook of measure theory. Vol. I, II*, North-Holland, Amsterdam, 2002. MR 1953489

[Ros74] Haskell P. Rosenthal, *A characterization of Banach spaces containing l^1*, Proc. Nat. Acad. Sci. U.S.A. **71** (1974), 2411–2413. MR 358307

[Ros77] ———, *Point-wise compact subsets of the first Baire class*, Amer. J. Math. **99** (1977), no. 2, 362–378.

[RPK19] M. Raissi, P. Perdikaris, and G. E. Karniadakis, *Physics-informed neural networks: a deep learning framework for solving forward and inverse problems involving nonlinear partial differential equations*, J. Comput. Phys. **378** (2019), 686–707. MR 3881695

[Sau72] N. Sauer, *On the density of families of sets*, J. Combinatorial Theory Ser. A **13** (1972), 145–147. MR 307902

[She71] Saharon Shelah, *Stability, the f.c.p., and superstability; model theoretic properties of formulas in first order theory*, Ann. Math. Logic **3** (1971), no. 3, 271–362. MR 317926

[She72] ———, *A combinatorial problem; stability and order for models and theories in infinitary languages*, Pacific J. Math. **41** (1972), 247–261. MR 307903

[She90] ———, *Classification theory and the number of nonisomorphic models*, second ed., Studies in Logic and the Foundations of Mathematics, vol. 92, North-Holland Publishing Co., Amsterdam, 1990.

[Sim15] Pierre Simon, *A guide to nip theories*, Lecture Notes in Logic, vol. 44, Cambridge University Press, 2015.

[SSBD14] Shai Shalev-Shwartz and Shai Ben-David, *Understanding machine learning: From theory to algorithms*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2014.

[Tal84] Michel Talagrand, *Pettis integral and measure theory*, Memoirs of the American Mathematical Society, vol. 51, American Mathematical Society, Providence, RI, USA, 1984, Includes bibliography (pp. 220–224) and index.

[Tal87] ———, *The Glivenko-Cantelli problem*, The Annals of Probability **15** (1987), no. 3, 837–870.

[Tka11] Vladimir V. Tkachuk, *A C_p-theory problem book: Topological and function spaces*, Problem Books in Mathematics, Springer, 2011.

[Tod97] Stevo Todorčević, *Topics in topology*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, vol. 1652, Springer Berlin, Heidelberg, 1997.

[Tod99] Stevo Todorčević, *Compact subsets of the first Baire class*, Journal of the American Mathematical Society **12** (1999), no. 4, 1179–1212.

[Tod23] ———, *Dense metrizability*, Annals of Pure and Applied Logic **175** (2023), 103327.

[Val84] Leslie G. Valiant, *A theory of the learnable*, Communications of the ACM **27** (1984), no. 11, 1134–1142.

[VC68] Vladimir N. Vapnik and Alexey Ya. Chervonenkis, *The uniform convergence of frequencies of the appearance of events to their probabilities*, Dokl. Akad. Nauk SSSR **181** (1968), no. 4, 781–783, In Russian; English translation in Soviet Math. Dokl. **9** (1968), 915–918.

[VC71] Vladimir N Vapnik and Alexey Ya Chervonenkis, *On the uniform convergence of relative frequencies of events to their probabilities*, Theory of Probability & Its Applications **16** (1971), no. 2, 264–280.

[VC74] ———, *Theory of pattern recognition*, Nauka, Moscow, 1974, German Translation: Theorie der Zeichenerkennung, Akademie-Verlag, Berlin, 1979.

[vH13] Ramon van Handel, *The universal Glivenko–Cantelli property*, Probability Theory and Related Fields **155** (2013), no. 3–4, 911–934, arXiv:1009.4434.